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painted under the overpass, letters a yard tall:

NOTHING IS BEYOND OUR REACH

A solo wargame of civilian resistance in the years after the Fracture

Rules version 0.1 — LEAF SEASON

Design & development: the Uwharrie table

System: the REACH system — action-point tactics, the Warden solo opposition engine **Setting:** the Blue Ridge–Uwharrie corridor, four years after the Fracture

Set in a fictional near-future. Factions, agencies, and events are invented. The setting is deliberately non-partisan: the Authority has no party, and neither does the valley.

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Playtesting acknowledgment: every rule in this book was fired for effect before it shipped.

WELCOME TO THE FALL

*From an ECA District 9 stability assessment, October of the fourth year: "Rural population compliance nominal. Insurgent capability assessed negligible — no heavy weapons, no air support, no secure communications, no professional cadre." Beneath it, in pencil, in a careful hand: They counted everything we don't have. Nobody counted the hollows. Nobody counted the deer rifles, or who strings their wire, hauls their fuel, fixes their trucks, and digs their graves — and remembers where all of it lives. Fresh paint on the Route 9 water tower this morning, letters a yard tall, facing the checkpoint: **NOTHING IS BEYOND OUR REACH.***

THE FALL

Four years ago the Fracture broke the federal government — a constitutional crisis, not a bomb or a plague. Nobody nuked anybody. The lights went out anyway, east of the mountains, everywhere except the enclaves where the Emergency Continuity Authority kept them on for itself.

The Authority — the ECA — began as continuity of government and became an occupation that never noticed the difference. Its professional core is real: career soldiers and federal officers who stayed at their posts. Around that core it recruited the Civil Order Corps, local collaborator militia, poorly trained and numerous, and above both it fields SRT — special reaction teams, the ones you hope arrive late. The Authority runs checkpoints, census sweeps, drone surveillance, and requisitions. It holds the towns, the fuel, and the airwaves.

It does not hold the hollows. The valley has other neighbors too: the Compact, county militias federated into a protection racket; the Ferryman, a smuggling network that is sometimes a vendor and sometimes a target; and marauders, transient predators who answer to nothing.

And it has you. The Crew you command are not commandos parachuted into someone else's war. They are the valley's own — veterans, hunters, line

workers, drivers, medics, a preacher — doing small, precise, dangerous things in the dark. The motto is theirs, not the Authority's: painted under overpasses, on water towers, on the backs of Authority signs. It is a promise about the valley's people and their reach into every hollow, shop floor, and radio room the Authority thinks it holds. Every mission in this book quietly proves it.

The campaign is called **LEAF SEASON**: the Uwharrie–Blue Ridge corridor of the western Carolinas, October into November. Hunting season puts armed people on the roads with an alibi. The leaves come down scene by scene, and the sightlines get longer. Then first frost, and the passes close.

WHAT THIS GAME IS

NOTHING IS BEYOND OUR REACH is a solo tabletop wargame. One player — you — runs the Crew, figure by figure, on a gridded map. Everything that hunts you is run by **the Warden**: not an app and not an opponent's imagination, but a system of dice, tables, Doctrine scripts, and a deck of Directive cards. The Warden's forces patrol, investigate, flank, radio for help, and break, all by procedure. Your half of the bargain is to run those procedures sharply and honestly (**The Good-Faith Clause** (p. 4)).

It is a heavy game. It tracks which way a figure faces, how much noise your crew has made, where the machine-gun fire is beating the ground, and how fast a friend is bleeding. It is also a lethal game: there are no hit points to whittle. A single aimed rifle shot fired well ends a fight more often than not — in both directions.

A mission runs 60 to 120 minutes at the table, typically six to ten game turns. A turn is about thirty seconds of fiction; a square is about a meter and a half; a standard board is 30 by 24 squares. Missions chain into a campaign in which your people carry their wounds, their reputations, and their dead from one to the next.

EXAMPLE

One exchange, whole. Turn three of a raid. Reyna Vasquez — 82nd Airborne once, the valley's now — is prone at the corner of a stock fence with her carbine, unspotted. An ECA Rifleman breaks from a shed toward a stone wall twelve squares out, well inside the carbine's Effective Range of 20 squares, and makes it. The wall is Cover, so Vasquez is shooting against the second of the two numbers printed on her card: Shoot 10/12.

She has not moved this activation, and she takes the time for an Aimed Shot. She rolls two d10: a 7 and a 6, total 13. That clears her Cover TN. A hit.

The trooper is an OPFOR figure, so there is no wound bookkeeping — one roll of the Casualty Die. She rolls a d10: a 5, plus the carbine's Damage Rating of 3, minus his Armor of 1, for a total of 7. Read it off the table: Dead.

Two rolls, one dead trooper — and one unsuppressed gunshot. The shot is Noise, Noise climbs the Alert Ladder, and the fence corner is now a Known position. Somewhere behind that shed a Team Leader is reaching for his radio, and the next ninety seconds are about whether he gets to use it.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

This game is heavy on purpose. It tracks facing, noise, blood, and battery life because the fantasy on offer is competence under pressure, and competence is made of details. But every subsystem funnels into the same two ten-siders against a target number, and the lethality does the pacing for us: firefights stay short because the math makes them short. Respect for that arithmetic is the game's real difficulty setting.

WHAT YOU NEED

- **This book.** Rules in the front, the enemy system and campaign in the middle, scenarios and reference in the back.
- **Dice.** A standard polyhedral set: two ten-sided dice, one six-sided, one eight-sided, one twenty-sided. Each die type has one fixed job in this game and never does another's; the jobs are laid out in **One Die, One Job** (p. 5).
- **The printed set** (in the release/ files, print-ready on US Letter): the **cards** — Crew, gear, OPFOR units, the Warden's Directive deck, events and dilemmas; the **tokens** — crew, OPFOR, Blips,

vehicles, drones, and status markers; the **maps** — six scenario boards, tiled for home printing; the **play sheets** — crew roster, campaign log, and network tracker; and the **quick reference**.

- **A pencil.** The campaign log expects to be written on, and so do the margins of your maps.
- **Table space** for a 30-by-24-square board and a card rail beside it.

Nothing else. There is no app, no internet lookup, and nothing to charge.

HOW TO READ THIS BOOK

Three conventions carry the whole book. First: **a rule is stated once**, in the chapter that owns it, and everywhere else a cross-reference points at that statement with a page number. If two passages ever seem to disagree, the owning chapter is right. Second: **a capitalized term is a rules term**, defined in the glossary — when you read Shaken, Known, or Noise with a capital letter, it is machinery, not mood. Third: **the fenced boxes have fixed jobs**. Fiction lives only in chapter openers like the one above and in flavor margins. An *example* box is a rule performed with real dice, worth playing along with. A *designer's note* explains why a rule exists. A *sidebar* is optional or advanced material — skip every sidebar on your first read and lose nothing.

The chapters run in learning order. Chapters 2 through 4 are the machine: Core Concepts covers the dice, tests, the map, line of sight, and cover; Actions and the Turn covers action points, the turn sequence, and the Interrupt Die; Fieldcraft covers noise, stealth, and hidden contacts. Chapters 5 through 8 are the fight: Ranged Combat, Close Quarters, Wounds and Recovery, and The Human Factor. Chapters 9 through 11 are the heavy equipment: Crew-Served Weapons, Vehicles, and Drones and Electronic Warfare. Chapters 12 and 13 are the enemy: The Enemy System — the Warden's doctrines and directives in full — and Forces of the Fall. Chapters 14 and 15 cover missions and the campaign: Running Missions and The Long War. Chapter 16 is Pineland Burning, the six linked LEAF SEASON scenarios. Chapter 17, Mission Architect, is the toolkit for building your own. The appendices

collect every table, the complete arsenal, and the index.

Read chapters 2 through 4 with the quick reference beside you, skim 5 through 8, and go play. Come back for the heavy-equipment chapters when a scenario puts a machine gun or a drone in your hands. Read chapter 12 when you start wondering why the Warden does what it does — the scenarios run correctly before you understand them.

If you have played other wargames, four habits to unlearn. There are no hit points: a hit on your people rolls location and severity, and one bad number ends a character's war (**Wounds & Recovery** (p. 36)). Cover is never a die modifier: every attack prints two target numbers, Open and Cover, and you simply use the right one (**Open or In Cover** (p. 9)). Activating your whole force in one safe block is not free: the Interrupt Die taxes greed (**The Interrupt Die** (p. 13)). And an enemy that has not acted yet is not safe to cross — unspent action points wait as Reaction Fire (**Reaction Fire** (p. 14)).

THE SPIRIT OF PLAY

You hold both jobs at this table: the Crew's commander and the Warden's operator. Keep them separate. When you command the Crew, be cunning, cautious, and unfair. When you operate the Warden, be exact.

Expect to lose things. Missions get scrubbed, crews come home carrying someone, and a withdrawal with everyone alive is a win — the campaign rules in **The Long War** (p. 84) treat it as one. The dead stay dead; the campaign log keeps a memorial page, and it will not stay empty.

Civilians are present in this world and they are not props. The rules never ask you to be good; they make it expensive to be careless, through the Rapport the valley extends or withdraws (**The Long War** (p. 84)). Protecting people is not the sentimental choice. It is the sound one.

Last: this game is deliberately ideology-free. Nobody in the valley says left or right, and neither does this book. The Authority is what continuity

of government becomes when it never gives anything back. The Crew are the neighbors who decided that was not an ending. That is the whole politics of it.

THE GOOD-FAITH CLAUSE

This is a rule, not advice. It governs every ruling you make on the Warden's behalf, from your first turn to your last.

When a Doctrine script, a Directive, or any Warden procedure is ambiguous, resolve it in the most tactically sensible way *against* the Crew. When two readings are exactly equal, take the one less favorable to you. Break every tie against the player. **You are the Warden's hands, not its lawyer.** Do not look for the reading that spares your people; look for the one a competent enemy would take, and take it.

The clause is reprinted beside the Doctrine scripts in **The Enemy System** (p. 66), where you will use it most.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Solo games die of the benefit of the doubt — a generous line-of-sight call here, a sentry who investigates a little slowly there, until the opposition is a scarecrow and winning stops meaning anything. The Good-Faith Clause is the vaccine, and it cuts both ways: play the Warden as hard as it can legally be played, and every mission you survive is one you actually earned.

YOUR FIRST MISSION

When you have read chapters 2 through 4 and skimmed the fight chapters, go straight to the first scenario of **Pineland Burning** (p. 93). It is built as a teaching mission: a small crew, a quiet start, and a decision about when the shooting starts that belongs to you. Its briefing lists the exact cards, tokens, and map tiles to bring to the table. Keep the quick reference at your elbow, play the Warden in good faith, and get everyone to the Exfil.

The valley is waiting to find out what you can reach.

CORE CONCEPTS

Deacon didn't start us on shooting. He walked us up the fire road above Dutton's orchard, put us on line facing the valley, and gave us an hour of silence. Then came the questions. What covers you from the church tower? Where does the creek bend out of sight of the road? How long to cross Tolley's pasture at a dead run — and who is watching while you do it? Write it down, he said. The ground is the only honest thing left in this county. Learn to read it faster than they can, and nothing down there is beyond our reach.

This chapter is the grammar of the REACH system: which die does what, how a test works, how to read a card, and how the game sees space — squares outdoors, Zones indoors, line of sight, cover, and facing. Every other chapter builds its sentences from these parts. The Warden — the system of dice, tables, and Directive cards that runs everything you are fighting — is introduced in **Welcome to the Fall** (p. 2) and fully specified in **The Enemy System** (p. 66); here you only need to know that when a rule says “the Warden rolls,” you roll, on its behalf and in good faith (**The Good-Faith Clause** (p. 4)).

Read this chapter once, play a turn or two, then come back for whatever you skimmed.

ONE DIE, ONE JOB

The game uses a standard polyhedral set: two ten-sided dice, plus one each of the d8, d6, and d20. Each die type has exactly one job, and the jobs never mix. This is deliberate. The shape of the die in your hand tells you what kind of question the game is asking before you read a word of the rule.

DICE	JOB
2d10 (sum)	Every skill test and every attack. Roll both dice, sum them, add modifiers, and compare the total to a Target Number (TN). Results bell-curve from 2 to 20 around a midpoint of 11.
1d10	Every resolution table: the Casualty Die, Hit Location, Severity, the Contact Table, Doctrine fallback lines, and the Interrupt Die. One die, one lookup, done.
1d8	Scatter and drift direction — eight compass points, with a result of 1 pointing away from the thrower (or north of the template) and the rest counting clockwise.
1d6	Distances and clocks: scatter distance, QRF arrival, bleed-out, and ammo or battery dice.
1d20	Campaign-layer tables only — events, dilemmas, and injury recovery between missions. The d20 never appears in

DICE	JOB
	tactical play.

Roll the two d10s where both faces can be seen, because natural results are read from the faces, not the sum: a natural 20 is *both dice showing 10*, a natural 2 is *both dice showing 1* (**Natural 20, Natural 2** (p. 6)). The pair is always summed — never read as a percentile roll — and the two dice do not need to match or be distinguishable from each other.

The 2d10 curve matters more than it looks. Because two dice sum, results cluster around 11 and every point of TN near the middle swings your odds by roughly ten percentage points. A one-point improvement — a Braced position, an elevated perch — is never cosmetic. This is why the modifier list (**The Test** (p. 5)) is short and why every entry on it is worth fighting for.

Two conventions apply everywhere in the game:

- **Round halves up.** Whenever a rule halves AP, Speed, distance, or anything else, round the result up.
- **One reroll, ever.** A die may never be rerolled more than once, no matter how many effects would allow it. The second effect is wasted.

THE TEST

Every question of skill or violence in the REACH system resolves the same way.

1. Roll 2d10 and sum the dice.
2. Add every situational modifier that applies.
3. Compare the total to the TN. Equal or higher: success. Lower: failure.

That is the whole engine: $2d10 + \text{modifiers} \geq \text{TN}$.

Not everything is a test. Walking, opening an unlocked door, going prone, climbing into a truck — routine actions simply cost AP and happen (**Action Points** (p. 13)). The game rolls dice only where the fiction is contested or dangerous: shots, throws, morale, first aid, driving through a fence at speed. If no rule calls for a test, do not invent one; the AP cost is the resolution.

TNs live on cards wherever possible. Your figure's Shoot line is a TN. Its Grit is a TN. A vehicle's

a card — a grenade throw, a climb, a scenario task — the rule that calls for the test states the number.

Two TNs, no cover math. Every attack profile prints a pair of numbers, written **Open/Cover** — for example, **9/11**. Use the Cover TN when the target qualifies for cover or concealment under the four conditions in **Open or In Cover** (p. 9); otherwise use the Open TN. Cover is never a modifier. You will not add for it, argue about degrees of it, or stack it. You will pick one of two printed numbers and roll.

Everything else that can legally change a roll is on this list:

TABLE: ATTACK & TEST MODIFIERS (COMPLETE LIST)

SITUATION	MODIFIER
Snap Shot (2 AP)	+3 TN
Reaction Fire (always a Snap Shot)	+3 TN total
Shooter is Shaken	+2 TN
Target Sprinting (this or its last activation)	+2 TN
Beyond Effective Range (up to 2x)	+2 TN
Beyond 2x Effective Range	no shot (Scoped: +4 TN)
Smoke / heavy rain / darkness without lights	+2 TN
Braced (Aimed, no movement, supported)	-1 TN
Elevated shooter	-1 TN
Point Blank (adjacent square or same Zone)	-2 TN

There are no other tactical modifiers. Maximum net +6 / -3. Cover is never a modifier — use the printed Cover TN.

This list is closed. If a situation is not on it, it does not modify the roll — no matter how vivid the fiction. Scenarios and house instinct add nothing to it; the only additions anywhere in this book ride on the weapon itself — a trait or class rule with a printed TN adjustment, like the Bolt tax on Snap Shots (**Weapon Traits** (p. 24)) or the long-gun penalty inside a Zone (**Fighting Inside a Zone** (p. 31)). When every modifier is accounted for, clamp the net total to the printed maximum before rolling.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Cover could have been a +2 like everything else. It isn't, for two reasons. First, arithmetic: cover applies to more shots than any other condition in the game, so printing both TNs on the cardface moves the single most common addition off the table entirely. Second, honesty: a binary Open-or-Cover call — four conditions, no stacking — resolves in seconds and kills the “my wall plus his smoke plus my crouch” negotiation before it starts. The modifier list stays short precisely because cover never visits it.

NATURAL 20, NATURAL 2

The REACH system has no critical-hit charts, no confirmation rolls, and no random-event deck ticking away behind the fight. Extreme results on the 2d10 are the game's only random-event trigger during resolution — the dice you already rolled *are* the event.

Natural 20 — both dice show 10. *Catastrophic success*. On an attack, the hit ignores Armor and adds +3 Severity (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)). On any other test, you succeed and gain the bonus effect stated by that rule, if it states one.

Natural 2 — both dice show 1. *Complication*. The test fails, and the acting figure suffers the complication listed for that action — a weapon jam, a stumble, a dropped item. If the action lists no complication, the default applies: +1 Noise (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)) and the figure is Shaken (**Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40)).

Each arrives one time in a hundred rolls. Across a mission's worth of tests that means the spectacular happens about once or twice a night — often enough to dread and hope for, never often enough to plan around. When a natural 2 costs you a rifle at the worst moment, that is not the game interrupting the story. That is the story.

READING A CARD

Every Crew figure is one card, and every card has the same five fields:

- **Shoot** **Open/Cover** — the figure's attack TNs with the weapon class it carries. Left number against targets in the open, right number against targets in Cover.
- **Grit** — the TN for morale, fear, and self-control tests (**The Human Factor** (p. 42)). Lower is

steadier.

- **AP** — Action Points per activation: 8 standard, 7 if the card says Slow, 9 if it says Fast. Spending them is the subject of **Action Points** (p. 13); AP you do not spend waits as Overwatch (**Overwatch** (p. 14)).
- **Skills** — background abilities, each a short, complete rules text printed on the card. There is nothing to memorize; if a skill matters, the card says how.
- **Gear** — the figure's weapon, armor, and two slots of kit.

Two of those fields deserve a closer look before you play.

A weapon line carries two numbers of its own. **Damage Rating (DR)** is its punch — DR is added to the Casualty Die against the enemy (**The Enemy's Ledger: the Casualty Die** (p. 40)) and to the Severity roll against your own people (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)). **Effective Range**, in squares, is the distance inside which the printed TNs hold; past it, the range modifiers on the list above take over.

Armor, meanwhile, is worn in pieces, not as a number for the whole body: plates protect the torso, a helmet protects the head, and limbs go bare. Where a hit lands therefore decides what armor counts — the full procedure is the wound chapter's (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)). Enemy cards simplify this to a single flat Armor value; that asymmetry is deliberate, and **Wounds & Recovery** (p. 36) explains what it buys.

Crew Shoot lines come in four broad tiers. The spread below is the reference — individual cards vary by a point where their story earns it:

TABLE: CREW SKILL TIERS (REFERENCE)

TIER	SHOOT OPEN/COVER	GRIT	WHO
SOF vet	8/10	8	one or two per campaign roster
Service vet / trained	10/12	10	infantry vets, deputies
Skilled civilian	11/13	11	hunters, competent shooters
Green	13/15	12	most starting civilians

Notice what the table implies. The valley does not field commandos. Most of your roster shoots like what they are — hunters, linemen, paramedics — and the one or two genuine professionals you

have are irreplaceable. The system prices skill honestly: on the 2d10 curve, the gap between a Green shooter and a service veteran is the difference between a coin flip and a near-certainty.

Here is a card in full:

REYNA VASQUEZ	
TIER	Service vet
SHOOT	10/12
GRIT	10
AP	8
BIO	Led an 82nd Airborne fireteam. Came home to bury her father; stayed for the valley.

Read it top to bottom. Reyna Vasquez shoots at 10/12 — a service veteran's line. Her Grit of 10 means she passes a morale test more often than not even on a bad night. She has 8 AP, the standard allowance. Her Leader skill lets her Rally Shaken neighbors (**Rally** (p. 43)); Fire Discipline quiets the shooting around her — which matters because Noise is a currency (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). Her carbine hits at DR 3 out to an Effective Range of 20 squares, and her chest rig speeds her reloads. Everything she can do is on this card or in the universal action list (**Action Points** (p. 13)).

Enemy cards read the same way but leaner — a Shoot line, Grit, Armor, a Doctrine, and one special rule. The Warden's people do not get biographies. What they get instead is a script, and the script is the subject of **The Enemy System** (p. 66).

THE SCALE OF THE FIGHT

A square is 1.5 meters — about five feet. A game turn is roughly 30 seconds of fiction. The standard board is 30 by 24 squares: forty-five meters by thirty-six, a farmyard and its outbuildings, a road junction and its ditches, one block of a county seat. A typical mission runs six to ten turns. Hold that math in your head: an entire mission is under five minutes of violence, and most of your figures' 30-second turns are spent moving, watching, and breathing — not shooting.

The turn is a slice, not a sequence. Within one turn, everything is understood to be happening at roughly the same time; the order in which figures activate (**The Turn Sequence** (p. 12)) is a

pretending otherwise. When a rule speaks of an activation, it means one figure spending its AP; when it speaks of a turn, it means the full slice — Crew Phase, Warden Phase, End Phase.

Distances in this book are always in squares, counted the shortest legal way. Ranges, blast radii, Rally reach, spotting distances — squares, every time. Nothing in the tactical game is measured in anything else.

THE OUTDOOR GRID

Outdoors, the world is a grid of squares, and every square is exactly one terrain type. Movement is square to adjacent square, orthogonal or diagonal; a diagonal step is a legal step and costs the same as an orthogonal one, but a move may never cut the corner of a wall or a Block square — go around. What each step costs in AP is the business of **Action Points** (p. 13); what the square *is* is the business of this section.

Clear. Pasture, road, farmyard, cut field. No effect on movement, sight, or fire. Clear ground is where people die; the whole tactical game is about how much of it you must cross and who is looking when you do.

Cover (low). Stone walls, rock piles, ditches, vehicles, machinery — anything a figure ducks behind that would actually stop or deflect a bullet. Cover terrain never blocks line of sight. What it does is trigger the Cover TN for figures fighting from behind it (**Open or In Cover** (p. 9)).

Concealment. Brush, crops, standing timber — things that hide a body without protecting it. Concealment triggers the Cover TN exactly as Cover does: the shot is hard because the shooter cannot see you, not because you are protected. Concealment also feeds the quiet game — figures inside it are far harder to detect (**Spotting** (p. 19), **The Quiet Game** (p. 20)). Two seasonal notes for the Leaf Season campaign: autumn hardwoods count as Concealment while the leaves hold (each scenario sheet says when they have dropped), and conifer stands are Concealment that additionally blocks LOS beyond 2 squares into the stand (**Line of Sight** (p. 8)).

Block. Buildings, rock faces, silos. Block terrain stops movement and stops line of sight. You do not

fight through Block; you go around it, or you go *inside* — through a Portal, into the Zone rules (**Indoors: Zones and Portals** (p. 10)).

Rough. Streambeds, deadfall, scree, plowed clay. Each square of Rough costs 2 AP to enter on foot. Rough is the terrain of the deliberate route: slower, and usually smarter.

Water. Creeks, ponds, the river. Impassable except at fords and bridges, unless the scenario says otherwise.

That is the complete outdoor list. A scenario map may dress these six in any fiction it likes — a burned-out checkpoint is Cover, a kudzu bank is Concealment, a chicken house is Block — but every square on the board is one of the six, and its type answers every rules question about it. Terrain types do not combine or stack within a square; when a real-world feature straddles the categories, the map key's call is final, and where the map is silent, read the square the way it would read to the people standing in it — brush hides, walls stop bullets, buildings stop everything.

ELEVATION: GROUND AND HIGH

Outdoor boards use two elevation levels: **Ground** and **High** — ridgelines, roofs, upper floors, the water tower. The map marks which is which.

Height is an edge, and the game pays it plainly. A shooter on High firing at a target on Ground takes the Elevated shooter modifier from the list in **The Test** (p. 5), and ignores the target's cover from low terrain — use the Open TN — unless the target is adjacent to its cover. Looking down flattens the world's walls; only the figure actually hugging one keeps its protection.

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-SCATTER-ELEVATION.SVG]

Elevation also stretches what you can see and, for thrown and dropped things, complicates where they land — the scatter interactions ride with the grenade rules in **Grenades & Explosives** (p. 27).

LINE OF SIGHT

To shoot at, Spot, or react to a target, a figure needs line of sight.

Trace a straight line from the center of the acting figure's square to the center of the target's square. The line is blocked by:

- **Block terrain** and closed doors;
- **more than 2 squares of conifer stand or heavy brush** counted along the line.

The line is **not** blocked by Cover terrain, low walls, smoke, or figures — friendly, enemy, or Down. (Smoke and darkness make the shot harder, not impossible; they live on the modifier list, not in the LOS rule.) If the line is blocked, there is no shot and no Spot. There is no partial or degraded LOS: the line is clear or it is not, and everything conditional about the shot is handled by the Open/Cover call and the modifier list.

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-LOS-COVER.SVG]

Indoors the rule compresses: LOS enters and leaves a Zone only through its Portals, and only for figures Posted at them (**Indoors: Zones and Portals** (p. 10)).

OPEN OR IN COVER

Every attack asks one binary question about the target: Open, or in Cover? The answer picks which of the profile's two printed TNs you roll against — and it is the *whole* of the game's cover system.

Use the **Cover TN** when any one of these four conditions is true:

1. **The LOS line crosses or touches a Cover or Concealment square adjacent to the target.**
The classic case: shooting at someone behind a wall, a truck, a ditch lip.
2. **The target is prone at 3 or more squares' distance.** A body flat on the ground is a sliver of a target at any real range. (A Crawling figure is prone.)
3. **The target is Posted at a Portal (Indoors: Zones and Portals (p. 10)).** A doorway shooter shows you one shoulder and half a face.
4. **The target is in Concealment.** You are shooting at where the brush moved.

Otherwise, use the **Open TN**.

One condition is enough, and four conditions are no better than one. There is no stacking, no "heavy cover," no cumulative bonus for pressing deeper into the woodline. A target is either Open or in Cover — never both, never doubly.

Ask the question per shot, from the shooter's square: the same figure can be in Cover from the road and stark Open to the ridge above it. That asymmetry — being covered from one direction and naked to another — is most of what maneuvering in this game is *for*. Remember also the exception that height buys: an Elevated shooter can strip condition 1 entirely (**Elevation: Ground and High** (p. 8)).

EXAMPLE

Reading the ground, then rolling. Turn 3, a farm lane below Sugar Creek. Reyna Vasquez kneels at the corner of the barn. A Civil Order Corps militiaman stands 14 squares off, at the edge of a brush line.

The call. Vasquez traces LOS center-to-center: the line is clear of Block, but it touches a Concealment square adjacent to the militiaman — condition 1. He is in Cover. Her card reads Shoot 10/12, so she needs the right-hand number: 12. He is inside her carbine's Effective Range of 20 squares and no other line item on the modifier list applies, so 12 it stays. She spends the AP for an Aimed Shot at the printed TN and rolls 2d10: **8 and 5 — 13**. A hit. The Warden rolls the Casualty Die (**The Enemy's Ledger: the Casualty Die** (p. 40)): d10 = 6, plus the carbine's DR 3, minus his Armor of 0 — total 9. Dead. (Had her dice come up 10 and 10 — a natural 20 — the hit would have ignored Armor entirely and struck at +3 Severity.)

The stack. The dead man's partner bolts — a Sprint across the open farmyard toward a wrecked truck. Birdy Sizemore, watching from a ditch with AP still unspent (**Overwatch** (p. 14)), takes Reaction Fire, which resolves mid-move (**Reaction Fire** (p. 14)). Her Shoot is 13/15. The runner is upright in Clear terrain: Open TN 13. Reaction Fire is +3; a Sprinting target is +2. Net +5 — under the +6 cap — for a final TN of 18. She rolls **9 and 6 — 15**. A miss; the runner makes the truck.

The floor. Next turn a third militiaman leans out of the machine-shed doorway — Posted at a Portal, condition 3, so Cover TN. Vasquez snaps a shot: her 12, +3 for the Snap, TN 15. The dice come up **1 and 1 — natural 2**. The shot fails and its complication lands with it: a jam, per the ranged attack procedure (**The Attack Procedure** (p. 23)). Her rifle is a club until she clears it.

INDOORS: ZONES AND PORTALS

Buildings are where the grid stops. Interiors are not gridded square by square. Instead, a building is divided into **Zones**: a room is one Zone, and a large open floor — a barn bay, a church nave, a warehouse — is several Zones of roughly 4×4 squares each. The scenario map draws the boundaries.

Zones connect to one another, and to the outdoor grid, through **Portals**: doors, windows, and breach holes. A Portal is the only way sight, fire, or bodies

pass a Zone boundary. Moving through one costs AP like any other action (**Action Points** (p. 13)).

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-ZONES-PORTALS.SVG]

Inside a Zone, exact position does not exist. Every figure in a Zone is in one of two states, declared by whoever controls it:

- **Posted** — at one named Portal. The figure sees and shoots through that Portal, and only that one. It counts as in Cover against fire from outside (**Open or In Cover** (p. 9), condition 3), and it may take Reaction Fire through its Portal (**Reaction Fire** (p. 14)).
- **Deep** — somewhere inside, away from the openings. No LOS in, no LOS out. A Deep figure cannot be seen or shot from outside the Zone, and cannot see, shoot, or react out of it. Deep is safe, and Deep is blind.

Figures in the same Zone are all at Point Blank to one another (**Fighting Inside a Zone** (p. 31)) — the modifier list already prices what a room fight is.

That is the entire spatial model for interiors, and these definitions are all this chapter owns. What happens when somebody comes *through* the door — entry fights, who fires first, breaching, flashbangs, grenades through Portals — is the business of **Close Quarters & Breaching** (p. 31), beginning at **The Entry Fight** (p. 31). It is most of why this game gets played.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

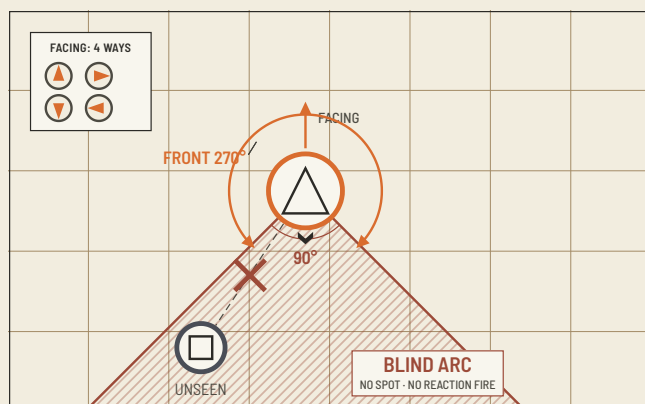
Squares outside, Zones inside. Outdoors the questions are metric — how far, how exposed, how many seconds in the open — and a grid answers them cheaply. Indoors the questions are almost never metric: fights at door distance are decided by who controls the opening, who is stunned, and who comes in second. Gridding a farmhouse kitchen would buy precision about a decision nobody is making. The Zone model spends its resolution where the decisions actually live — at the Portal.

FACING AND THE BLIND ARC

Every figure faces one of the four orthogonal directions. Facing changes are free: turn a figure as often as you like at any point while it is

spending AP. When its activation ends, it keeps its final facing until it activates again — and that parting choice is a real decision, because of what follows.

The **Blind Arc** is the 90° quadrant directly behind a figure. Precisely: a square is in the Blind Arc when it lies behind the figure along its facing axis and its distance behind is greater than or equal to its sideways offset — the rear diagonals split the difference and count as Blind. A figure cannot see into, Spot into, or take Reaction Fire into its Blind Arc. Everything else — the frontal 270° — it watches.



The Blind Arc cuts both ways. It is how your people close on a sentry (**The Quiet Game** (p. 20)), and it is the seam you leave the Warden every time

a figure ends its activation careless of what is behind it. An enemy with AP in hand is a loaded trap (**Reaction Fire** (p. 14)) — but only across the arc it can see.

Vehicles and drones have no Blind Arc: mirrors, cameras, and a rotor's-eye view. Neither does anyone indoors — a Zone is close chaos, and every aware figure in it counts as inside every other's frontal arc (**Fighting Inside a Zone** (p. 31)). Vehicle weapons use their own fire arcs, which are a different mechanism entirely (**Vehicles** (p. 52)).

Margin note, Deacon's hand: "Check your six" is a lie — you can't, not while you're working. That's what a buddy is. Pair up and quarter opposite ways; two people offset have no Blind Arc between them. Watch how their sentries stand. When the Authority posts them lazy, both men facing the road — that's not a post, that's a door. Walk through it.

You now hold the grammar: five dice jobs, one test, one card anatomy, one map. **Actions & the Turn** (p. 12) puts it in motion — the turn sequence, spending AP, and the Interrupt Die that keeps your bold plans honest. After that, **Fieldcraft** (p. 17) teaches the discipline that decides more missions than any gunfight: Noise, and who has heard you.

ACTIONS & THE TURN

A mimeographed drill sheet, pinned inside the feed-store office door, Deacon's block capitals: "A firefight is thirty seconds of decisions, and you make them in advance or not at all. Move one at a time. One gun watching, always — a rifle that is not firing is still working, holding every yard its muzzle covers." Beneath it, in pencil, different hands from different weeks: timed the low bridge fight after. eight seconds of shooting. felt like a year. — the sentry that got Royce never took a step. didn't have to. Royce moved. — greedy is what gets a whole line killed.

THE TURN SEQUENCE

A mission plays out in game turns, each about thirty seconds of fiction. Every turn is the same machine run once: your Crew spends its effort, the Warden answers, and the books are balanced. The order never varies.

1. Crew Phase. Activate your Crew figures one at a time, in any order, each at most once per turn. Finish each figure's activation completely before beginning the next. After the second Crew activation of the turn ends — and after every Crew activation after that — roll the Interrupt Die (**The Interrupt Die** (p. 13)).

2. Warden Phase. Resolve five steps, in order:

- **(a) Noise and Alert bookkeeping.** Total the Noise the turn has generated and check it against the Alert thresholds (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)).
- **(b) Directive.** If the OPFOR is Alerted or worse, draw one Directive card (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)).
- **© Blips move.** Every unresolved Blip moves by its rules (**Blips** (p. 18)).
- **(d) Revealed elements act.** Every revealed OPFOR element acts by its Doctrine (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)).
- **(e) Clocks tick.** Advance every running clock: QRF arrival, bleed-out (**Bleed** (p. 37)), fires, drone batteries.

3. End Phase. In order: mark Bleed for every Bleeding figure (**Bleed** (p. 37)); remove Shaken from figures that neither activated nor were shot at this

turn (**Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40)); remove expired effects; advance the Turn marker.

THE CREW PHASE

An activation is one figure spending its Action Points (**Action Points** (p. 13)). Choose the next figure only when the last is finished — nothing commits you to an order in advance, and the enemy's reactions will make you glad of that. A figure's activation ends when you declare it over; any AP it has not spent stays with the figure as Overwatch (**Overwatch** (p. 14)). An ended activation cannot be reopened.

You are not required to activate everyone. A figure you leave alone this turn keeps whatever AP it is already holding, remains available for Reaction Fire, and — if it is Shaken and nobody shoots at it — recovers in the End Phase. Sitting a figure out is often the play: fewer activations mean fewer Interrupt Die rolls, and a rifle already lying in a good position with a deep pool of AP is doing its job by watching.

THE WARDEN PHASE

You run this phase too, and you run it exactly (**The Good-Faith Clause** (p. 4)). Steps (a), ©, and (e) are pure bookkeeping — resolve them without editorializing. Step (b) hands the whole enemy force its order for the turn. In step (d), run each revealed element's Doctrine script as printed; the scripts live in **The Enemy System** (p. 66). Elements hold back AP where their script says to. That held AP is their Overwatch, and it is loaded — your figures cross it at the same peril the Warden's figures cross yours (**Reaction Fire** (p. 14)).

An element that acted early on an Interrupt still acts normally in this phase. The Interrupt was a bonus, not an advance.

THE END PHASE

The turn exhales. Bleed is the price of business left unfinished (**Bleed** (p. 37)); Shaken recovery rewards the figures you kept out of the fight; expired effects — smoke drifting off, a stun wearing through — come off the board. Then the Turn marker advances, and the Turn marker is never idle bookkeeping: scenarios carry deadlines,

check-in timers, and an Exfil that does not wait (**Running Missions** (p. 81)).

ACTION POINTS

Action Points are the turn's currency. A standard Crew figure activates with 8 AP; a card that says Slow prints 7, a card that says Fast prints 9 — the number on the card is final. OPFOR figures activate with 8 AP as well, but the Warden spends theirs by script, most often as movement plus an attack, with a reserve held back for Reaction Fire wherever the Doctrine says so.

Spend AP in any order and any legal mix — move, shoot, move again, go prone, shoot once more. An action may be taken more than once in an activation if the figure can pay for it and no rule on its card or in its description says otherwise. The universal actions and their costs:

TABLE: UNIVERSAL ACTION POINT COSTS

ACTION	AP	NOTES
Walk 1 square	1	quiet
Sprint (3 squares, at most 1 turn point)	2	+1 Noise per activation; Sprinting target +2 TN to hit
Crawl 1 square (prone)	2	counts as Cover vs shots from 3+ squares
Go prone / stand	1	
Snap Shot	2	+3 TN
Aimed Shot	4	printed TN
Braced Shot	5	-1 TN; no movement this activation
Reload	2	3 for crew-served
Throw grenade	3	
Open door / climb window	1 / 2	
Kick breach	2	+2 Noise
Enter or exit a Zone through a Portal	2	
Buddy Aid	4	Medicine test; EMT 3 AP
Rally (Leader trait or Grit 9 or less, radius 3)	2	
Spot (resolve a Blip in LOS / search)	2	
Mount / dismount vehicle	2	
Interact (cut wire, plant charge, grab cache...)	2	unless scenario states otherwise

Facing changes are free while spending AP. Unspent AP remains for Reaction Fire (Overwatch).

Facing is free. A figure may turn to face any of the four directions at any point while it is spending AP, as often as you like. When its activation ends, it keeps its final facing until it next spends AP — choose that last facing deliberately, because it fixes the frontal arc the figure can see and react into (**Facing and the Blind Arc** (p. 10)).

This list is universal and closed. The specialist chapters add actions of their own — deploying a machine gun (**Crew-Served Weapons** (p. 46)), driving (**Vehicles** (p. 52)), flying a drone (**Drones & Electronic Warfare** (p. 59)) — but no rule in this book changes the costs printed here.

Whatever a figure does not spend, it keeps. Unspent AP persists between activations as Overwatch (**Overwatch** (p. 14)), and holding some back is not waste — it is the entire defensive half of the game.

THE INTERRUPT DIE

The Crew Phase is yours, but it is not free. Every activation past your second gives the Warden a lengthening chance to cut in.

After your second Crew activation of the turn ends, roll a d10. On a 10, the Warden takes an **Interrupt**. After your third activation the Interrupt comes on 9 or better; after your fourth, 8 or better — the threshold falls by one with each subsequent activation. Nothing modifies this roll.

TABLE: THE INTERRUPT DIE (d10)

AFTER CREW ACTIVATION NUMBER...	WARDEN INTERRUPTS ON
2nd	10
3rd	9+
4th	8+
5th	7+
6th	6+
7th	5+
8th	4+

Max one Interrupt per turn — the nearest revealed element (Alerted first) acts with 4 AP. It still acts in the Warden Phase.

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-INTERRUPT-DIE.SVG]

When an Interrupt comes, the single revealed OPFOR element nearest to any Crew figure —

Alerted elements first — acts immediately with 4 AP, running its Doctrine script as if the Warden Phase had arrived early. When the Warden must choose between candidates, an element with contact outranks one without, the nearer outranks the farther, and any remaining tie breaks against you (**The Good-Faith Clause** (p. 4)).

Only revealed elements can Interrupt. If nothing is revealed — the whole enemy force still face-down Blips — make the roll and nothing happens; Blips never Interrupt.

The Interrupt is a short but entirely real activation. The element makes Noise, takes and triggers Reaction Fire, and tests morale, all as normal. It loses nothing for the privilege: it still acts in the Warden Phase this turn.

Maximum one Interrupt per turn. Once one has resolved, stop rolling the Interrupt Die for the rest of the Crew Phase.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

The Interrupt Die taxes a specific greed. In most solo games you sequence your entire force in perfect safety, then hand the enemy a turn; every plan is a lecture the opposition politely waits out. Here, running all eight of your people before the Warden answers should feel like sprinting a ridgeline — across a six-to-eight activation Crew Phase the die averages about one Interrupt per turn, so the question “who can afford to move last?” never leaves the table. Fielding a small crew and keeping the phase short is a legitimate answer. That is not an exploit. That is the lesson.

OVERWATCH

Overwatch is not an action, a stance, or a marker you place. It is the name for AP a figure holds while it is not its activation. When a figure's activation ends, its unspent AP stays with it until its next activation begins, and while it holds at least 2 AP it remains a live threat — held AP is what pays for Reaction Fire (**Reaction Fire** (p. 14)).

At the start of a figure's next activation, its pool resets to the full printed value. Overwatch AP never stacks onto the new allowance; hoarding across turns buys nothing beyond the watching itself.

A figure on Overwatch watches from where and how its activation left it: its position, its posture,

and its final facing are fixed until it next spends AP. Facing changes are free only *while spending AP* — between activations, a figure cannot turn, shift, or adjust. Its guard is its frontal 270°, everything except the Blind Arc behind it (**Facing and the Blind Arc** (p. 10)).

Both sides keep Overwatch. The Warden's Doctrine scripts state how much AP each element holds back — typically enough for one reaction — and OPFOR held AP obeys every rule yours does.

The last two AP. Veterans of this system develop a closing ritual for every activation: end behind something (**Open or In Cover** (p. 9)), end prone if staying, end facing the threat, and end holding pairs — 2 AP is one reaction, 4 AP is two. Movement in pairs of figures follows from it: one moves while one watches, then they trade — the leapfrog the example below performs. The habit costs nothing and it is the difference between a crew and a queue of targets.

REACTION FIRE

Reaction Fire is a Snap Shot taken out of turn, and it is the reason movement under an enemy's gun is a gamble even when that enemy has already acted — or has not acted at all.

Requirements. A figure may take Reaction Fire when all of the following are true:

- it has at least 2 AP remaining;
- it is not Shaken or Pinned (**Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40));
- it has reacted fewer than two times since its own last activation ended;
- an enemy figure inside its frontal 270° arc (**Facing and the Blind Arc** (p. 10)) and its LOS (**Line of Sight** (p. 8)) performs a trigger.

Triggers. Any of the following by an enemy figure: moves from one square to another, or from one Zone to another; stands; Sprints; fires; breaches.

Procedure. Pay the Snap Shot's cost from the reacting figure's held AP and resolve one shot at the triggering figure by the normal attack procedure (**The Attack Procedure** (p. 23)). Reaction Fire carries a single flat +3 TN — this *replaces* the Snap Shot penalty, never stacks with it. Every other modifier applies as usual; in particular, a Sprinting target adds its +2 on top, for +5 total.

Read Open or Cover TN off the target's situation at the moment of the shot, exactly as for any attack (**Open or In Cover** (p. 9)).

Timing. Against movement, the reaction resolves mid-move: after the triggering square, before the next one. A target still standing simply keeps moving — and every further square it enters is a fresh trigger, so a watcher holding 4 AP may react twice to the same crossing. Against a shot, the reaction resolves simultaneously with the trigger: resolve the triggering shot, then the reaction, and apply both results — a reacting figure that is hit still gets its round off, and a triggering shooter cut down still finishes firing.

Any phase, both sides. Reactions occur whenever a trigger does: OPFOR figures react to your movement in the Crew Phase, your figures react to OPFOR movement and fire in the Warden Phase and during Interrupts. OPFOR figures use exactly this rule — the Warden's scripts leave AP unspent on purpose, and each Doctrine listing states how much — with one asymmetry: **the Warden reacts only to Known Crew figures**. Like every trigger the Warden owns, Reaction Fire needs a Known target (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)); a shape the force does not Know can cross a watched field untouched. Your figures carry no such law — you

react to anything you can see. A Reaction Fire shot is itself fire, so it can trigger Reaction Fire in return from any eligible figure that has it in arc. Defenders Posted at Portals react through them; the entry fight this creates inside buildings is resolved in **The Entry Fight** (p. 31).

Limits. Each figure reacts at most twice between one activation of its own and the next, pays the Snap Shot cost each time, and may never react while Shaken or Pinned. That last clause is suppression's whole purpose (**Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40)): the way across a watched field starts with making the watcher flinch.

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-REACTION-FIRE.SVG]

ECA SENTRY

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	12/14
GRIT	10
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	Holding
WEAPON	carbine
SPECIAL	Fixed post with landline - ALARM attempt is automatic if Alerted at post.
ELEMENT	pair at scripted positions

EXAMPLE

Leapfrog at the hedgerow. Turn five, and the mission has been loud for two of them: the OPFOR is Alerted. A hedgerow crosses the pasture with one cut gap, three squares wide, and the far field is where Reyna Vasquez and Birdy Sizemore need to be. Ten squares beyond the gap, behind a sandbagged post, a revealed ECA Sentry faces it. His Holding script left him 4 AP in Overwatch — enough for two reactions. The gap sits inside his frontal arc, inside his LOS, and well inside his carbine's Effective Range of 20 squares — and both women are Known (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)), marked since they shot their way off the last field without ever breaking contact. Somebody is going to get shot at.

Vasquez (8 AP) activates first. She walks 3 squares along her side of the hedgerow to the gap's near corner (3 AP), goes prone (1 AP), and turns to face the post — facing is free. She ends her activation there holding 4 AP: two Reaction Fires' worth. Hers is the first Crew activation of the turn, so no Interrupt Die yet.

Birdy (9 AP — Fast) activates. She walks 2 squares to the mouth of the gap (2 AP), then Sprints the 3 open squares (2 AP, +1 Noise, and she now counts as a Sprinting target). One square into the open, the Warden reacts.

The Sentry's side of the ledger: he holds 2 AP, he is not Shaken, and a Known figure entering a square is a trigger inside his arc and LOS. He pays 2 AP — everything he has — for the Snap Shot. Birdy is mid-gap in the open, so he shoots against the first of the two numbers of his Shoot 12/14: Open TN 12, +3 for Reaction Fire (the flat reaction penalty — not a Snap penalty stacked on top), +2 for a Sprinting target. TN 17. The Warden rolls 2d10: a 6 and a 5, total 11. A miss by 6 — too wide even for an automatic weapon's near-miss effect (**The Attack Procedure** (p. 23)). The reaction resolved mid-move, so Birdy runs on. Her last two squares are two more triggers — but the post has no AP left to answer with.

The muzzle flash is a trigger of its own. The Sentry fired inside Vasquez's frontal arc and LOS; she is not Shaken, holds 4 AP, and has not reacted since her activation ended. She pays 2 AP and takes Reaction Fire, resolving simultaneously with his shot. The sandbags put him in Cover, so she shoots against the second number of her Shoot 10/12: Cover TN 12, +3 for Reaction Fire. TN 15. She rolls a 9 and an 8: 17. A hit. One Casualty Die: the d10 comes up 4, plus the carbine's DR of 3, minus his Armor of 1 — total 6. **Down.** The post goes quiet.

Count what the AP bought. The Warden held 2: one reaction, and his script spent it on the hardest shot on offer — a sprinter at +5. Vasquez banked 4: she has spent 2, still holds 2, and has one of her two reactions left, so anything else that moves in that gap before her next activation eats a Snap Shot at TN 15. Birdy finishes the crossing with 5 AP in hand and drops prone against the far bank (1 AP), holding 4 and facing the far field — the leapfrog inverts, and now she watches while Vasquez crosses. Had that post held an MG team keeping 4 AP instead of a lone sentry keeping 2, Birdy's three open squares would have been three triggers against two paid reactions. The arithmetic, not the hedge, is what makes a gap wide.

Bookkeeping owed to the later phases: Birdy's Sprint is +1 Noise, and two unsuppressed gunshots would be +2 each but gunfire caps at +3 Noise per turn — +4 Noise total (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). And Birdy's was the second Crew activation to end, so the Interrupt Die is rolled, needing a 10: it comes up 6. No Interrupt. This turn, the tempo held.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Reaction Fire is symmetric on purpose, and the symmetry is the doctrine lesson smuggled into the rules: *an unactivated enemy is never safe to cross* — and neither are your people, which is why the Warden's scripts hold AP the way a trained unit holds security. The flat +3 keeps reactions meaningfully worse than deliberate fire, so a watched gap is a cost, not a wall. The game wants you answering held guns the way professionals do — smoke, suppression, a better angle, or a partner whose own held AP makes the enemy's shot the last mistake it takes.

FIELD CRAFT

From the crew's night-movement standing order, typed on the back of a co-op seed invoice, in Deacon's block capitals: "SPEED IS A PURCHASE AND THE CURRENCY IS SOUND. WALK WHEN YOU CAN. CRAWL WHEN YOU MUST. RUN WHEN IT NO LONGER MATTERS. THE VALLEY HEARS EVERYTHING ONCE — WHAT COUNTS IS WHAT IT HEARS TWICE." Beneath that, penciled in Ledford's slope: a sentry is a man doing the most boring work on earth. he watches the road because the road is the only thing that ever brought him anything. come from the direction nothing ever came from. And a third hand, small, at the bottom margin: cutters buried at the third fencepost past the ford. you know which ford.

The chapters before this one move figures and spend dice. This chapter is about the game the Warden is playing while you do it — a game kept in ledgers, not in line of sight. What has the enemy *heard*? What is actually *out there*? What has it *seen*? What does it *know*? Those four questions have four mechanisms — Noise, Blips, spotting, and the Known marker — and most missions are decided in them before the first Aimed Shot. The whole discipline reduces to one sentence you should hold onto for the rest of the book: the quiet game is Noise arithmetic against an alert ladder, the mission will probably go loud anyway, and fieldcraft is how you choose *on whose terms*.

GAITS AND STANCES

Your figures move at three gaits. Their costs live in the universal action list (**Action Points** (p. 13)) and nothing in this chapter changes them; what follows is what each gait means to the quiet game.

Walk. The default, and the quiet one. A walking figure adds no Noise — ever, over any distance, on any surface. When the mission is silent, it is silent at a walk.

Sprint. Fast, and a purchase: every activation in which a figure Sprints feeds the Noise pool (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). A Sprinting figure is harder to hit — the modifier list prices it (**The Test** (p. 5)) — but the pool does not care whether anyone was shooting. You pay in sound either way.

Crawl. Prone movement: slow, silent, and small. A prone figure at three or more squares reads as in

Cover to anyone shooting at it (**Open or In Cover** (p. 9)), and a crawling figure is prone by definition. The Crawl is the stalker's gait — the way a body crosses the last of the open without becoming a silhouette.

A figure's stance is standing or prone, and the transition is its own action on the universal list. Prone buys the range-cover above and keeps a figure under the sightlines that matter; it costs tempo, because everything useful except crawling and shooting starts with standing back up.

Route selection does the rest. Concealment hides the mover and shortens every enemy eye that might find it (**Spotting** (p. 19)); conifer stands go further and cut LOS itself (**Line of Sight** (p. 8)); and every enemy figure drags a Blind Arc behind it that no rule lets it watch (**Facing and the Blind Arc** (p. 10)). The quiet approach is rarely the short one. It is the one stitched from brush, dead ground, and the direction nobody is facing.

THE NOISE POOL

Noise is a single shared pool for the whole mission — not per figure, not per place. One track, one number. It starts at the scenario's printed value, usually zero. Add to it the moment a source occurs, whoever caused it — your gunfire and the Warden's pour into the same pool, and so does the engine of the truck you stole. **Noise never decreases.** There is no waiting it out, no all-clear, no rule that forgives. Quiet spent early is the only quiet you get.

TABLE: NOISE SOURCES

SOURCE	NOISE
Unsuppressed gunshot	+2 (max +3 per turn from gunfire)
Suppressed shot	+1 (max +1 per turn)
Sprint	+1 per figure-activation
Kick breach	+2
Explosion / crash	+3
Vehicle engine moving on board	+2 per turn
Crew drone aloft	+1 per turn
Body discovered	+3; at least Suspicious - Alerted if found by a revealed element

Noise never decreases during a mission.

Read the caps carefully. Gunfire is capped *per turn*, not *per figure*: no matter how many unsuppressed weapons fire in a turn, they add at most the printed maximum, and suppressed fire adds at most its own smaller maximum. Everything else stacks as it happens — three figures Sprinting in one turn is three separate points. Scenario sheets add listed sources of their own: a generator kicked over, a dog pen, a church bell.

Track the pool face up. You are the Warden's hands (**The Good-Faith Clause** (p. 4)), and the Warden's hearing is procedural, not psychic: it knows exactly the number on the track and nothing more. Noise carries no direction and no author — the pool does not remember which shot came from which hedgerow; that is what the Known rules are for (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)). What the pool buys the enemy is posture, and posture only.

Mark Noise the moment it happens; the ladder moves during the Warden Phase's bookkeeping step (**The Turn Sequence** (p. 12)). Each scenario prints the two thresholds its garrison wakes at — a sleepy fuel depot and a jumpy checkpoint are different numbers — and certain events move the ladder directly, without waiting on the pool; those triggers, and the Warden's full behavior at each rung, belong to **The Enemy System** (p. 66). What this chapter owes you is the view from your side of the board:

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-NOISE-LADDER.SVG]

Unaware. The board runs on rails. Posts stand where the briefing said, patrol Blips walk their printed loops, nothing is drawn from the Directive deck. Every minute of Unaware is yours: the tempo, the routes, the choice of when it ends.

Suspicious. Someone comes to look. The nearest element walks toward the newest Noise source, and every Blip on the map stops patrolling and starts drifting toward sound (**Blips** (p. 18)). Nothing is hunting you yet — but the geometry you scouted is already out of date.

Alerted. The Warden starts fighting. It draws a Directive every Warden Phase, and its elements

run their Doctrines against Known positions (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)). From here on the enemy maneuvers, suppresses, and flanks — the machinery of **The Enemy System** (p. 66) at full turn.

ALARM. The outside world is coming: a QRF clock starts, Contact rolls sharpen, enemy drones go up, lights come on where the scenario has them. But mark this — **ALARM is a human act, not a threshold.** The pool cannot send it. Somebody with rank has to reach working comms and get the call out, which is why leaders die first, landlines get cut, and jammers exist (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)). Deny the call, and Alerted is as bad as your night gets — until the scenario's missed check-in timer runs out and the silence itself becomes the message.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

The pool never drains because it is not modeling sound — sound decays; suspicion accumulates. Every point of Noise is an entry in some duty log, a corporal who heard *something*, a dog that would not settle, and the ratchet is what makes the chapter's one sentence true: you cannot claw quiet back, so the decision that matters is not “how do we stay silent forever” but “what do we spend the silence on.” Printing the thresholds per scenario, rather than fixing them, lets scenario design tune exactly how long that question stays open.

BLIPS

The enemy arrives on your board in two forms, and the difference between them is the spine of the scouting game.

Scripted sentries are placed openly at setup: real figures, at printed posts, visible across the board from turn one. You can count them, time them, and plan around them before a die is rolled. They are revealed elements like any other — the Warden runs them by their Doctrine (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)) — and their eyes are governed by the spotting rule (**Spotting** (p. 19)).

Blips are everything else: numbered markers, face down, placed by the scenario. A Blip is a *contact*, not a unit. It might be a fireteam. It might be a dog. Until it resolves, it has no figures, no facing, no weapon — and no eyes. A Blip never spots, never shoots, never reacts. It threatens you in exactly two ways: where it is, and what it turns out to be.

Blips move in the Warden Phase (**The Turn Sequence** (p. 12)). While the force is Unaware, each Blip walks its printed patrol route at 2 squares a turn — on rails, and therefore on a clock you can read. From Suspicious up, every Blip moves 3 squares a turn toward the newest Noise source or the most recent Known or last-Known Crew position, whichever the Warden learned of last; when the choice is arguable, it goes the Warden's way (**The Good-Faith Clause** (p. 4)).

Resolving. A Blip resolves — turns face up into whatever it is — the moment any of the following is true:

- a Crew figure has LOS to it within 12 squares (6 if the Blip is in Concealment);
- it is under a Crew drone's Sweep, at any distance (**Drones & Electronic Warfare** (p. 59));
- a Crew figure pays to Spot it (**Spotting** (p. 19));
- it would end its move within 6 squares of a Crew figure it can detect (see below) — it resolves at that point of the move;
- it moves adjacent to a Crew figure it can detect — **surprise**, below.

To resolve, roll d10 on the scenario's Contact Table; under ALARM, add the table's printed modifier. The default:

TABLE: DEFAULT CONTACT TABLE (RESOLVING A BLIP) (d10)

D10	CONTACT
1-2	Nothing — a dog, wind, refugees moving through. Remove the Blip
3-5	Patrol pair (2 figures, standing Doctrine: Sweep)
6-7	Fireteam (4 figures with Leader, Doctrine: per scenario)
8	Sentry post + MMG team (Doctrine: Holding / Base-of-Fire)
9	Drone team (operator + RTO; launches recon quad next Warden Phase)
10	Special — see scenario

Under ALARM add +2. Scenarios may replace this table.

On *Nothing*, remove the marker — the shape in the treeline was wind, a dog, refugees who want no part of this. On anything else, place the contact's figures on and adjacent to the Blip's square, postures and facings chosen to the Warden's best advantage (**The Good-Faith Clause** (p. 4)). From that moment they are a revealed element and act by Doctrine (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)).

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-BLIP-RESOLVE.SVG]

Surprise. A Blip that moves adjacent to a Crew figure it can detect resolves *with surprise*: its figures deploy before anything else happens — before Reaction Fire, before your figure can lift a weapon — and the Crew figure tests Grit at once for surprise Point Blank contact (**Nerve Under Fire** (p. 42)). Letting an unresolved contact walk into arm's reach is how a quiet night ends worst.

Concealment is Blip-proof. A Crew figure in Concealment that holds its fire cannot be detected by Blips at all: the two proximity triggers above simply do not apply to it, and a patrol Blip can pass within a spade's length of the laurel it is lying in. Firing ends the guarantee — not because the Blip hears, but because the shot makes you Known (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)) and puts you on every ledger at once.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Why the hybrid? All-Blips would make the stealth game a guessing exercise — you cannot stalk a probability cloud, and takedowns, timing, and approach routes need fixed problems to be worth planning against. All-visible would kill the dread that makes scouting worth AP. So the scenario splits the difference the way real intelligence does: the posts you knew about going in are on the map, and everything your sources could not pin down is a numbered marker moving on a schedule. The sentries are the chess problem. The Blips are the weather.

SPOTTING

Two kinds of eyes work the board: yours and theirs.

Yours: the Spot action. Spot (**Action Points** (p. 13)) does one of two things. Aimed at a Blip in your LOS — at any distance, provided the line is clean (**Line of Sight** (p. 8)) — it resolves that Blip immediately, on your clock: you stop, you glass the shape, you find out *now*, from ground you chose, instead of at 12 squares with your crew halfway across a field. Aimed at the ground, it is a search: where a scenario hides something findable — a cache, a tripwire, papers on a body — the scenario says what a search turns up and from

how close. You cannot Spot into your own Blind Arc (**Facing and the Blind Arc** (p. 10)).

Theirs: the sentry's eyes. At the start of each Warden Phase, every scripted sentry checks its watch: any Crew figure inside its frontal arc (**Facing and the Blind Arc** (p. 10)), in its LOS, within 12 squares is spotted. If the figure is in Concealment, or the board is dark, that reach is 6 squares — either condition alone does it, and they do not stack further, though some cards and kit shrink the distance again. Spotting needs no roll and offers no save: **the force is immediately Alerted, and the spotted figure is Known (Known and Unknown** (p. 20)). One lazy silhouette at the wrong moment skips the whole ladder.

The timing is the rest of the rule. Sentries check when the Warden Phase *begins*, not when you move. Whatever happens inside your own phase — the rush across the last of the yard, the knife — is never seen unless a sentry survives to the check. Fieldcraft against a manned post is therefore an exercise in phase arithmetic: end every turn outside the reach of every living eye, and make sure the activation that finally crosses inside it is the one that finishes the job.

Patrols and other revealed elements are not sentries; their noticing, like everything else they do, is written into their Doctrine scripts (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)).

KNOWN AND UNKNOWN

The Warden shoots at, and maneuvers against, **Known** Crew positions — and only Known ones. This is the whole of the enemy's targeting law, and it governs every trigger the Warden owns: Doctrine fire, Directives, and Reaction Fire alike. A Crew figure that is not Known is a shape in a field. Elements do not fire at shapes; scripts with no Known target search, hold, or sweep instead (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)).

A Crew figure becomes Known — mark it — when any of the following happens:

- **it fires.** The square it fired from is marked along with it. A suppressor changes the Noise, not the marking: muzzle flash and impact tell direction even when the report is a cough.
- **a sentry spots it (Spotting** (p. 19)), or an element's script says so (**The Enemy System** (p.

66)).

- **an enemy drone sweeps it (Drones & Electronic Warfare** (p. 59)).

Known is kept **per figure**. One spotted rifleman does not reveal the crew: the figure that fired is Known, and the four lying silent in the ditch beside it are not, even though the Warden's rounds are cracking a body's length over their heads. This is why a crew splits its jobs — one gun that is Known and moving is a fact the Warden must chase; five that are Known is a firing solution.

A Known figure becomes **Unknown** again by disappearing properly: move at least 3 squares with no OPFOR figure holding LOS to you at any point along the way, and at the end of that move, remove your Known marker. The place you went dark from persists in the Warden's memory as the **last Known position**: Blips drift toward it, Doctrines search toward it (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)). It ages; you move. The gap between where you are and where the Warden is still looking is the maneuver space this whole chapter exists to buy.

Make the loop a habit before the shooting chapters make it doctrine: fire, then move — three squares and a screen of anything solid, and the return fire arrives where you were. A crew that shoots twice from the same wall has told the Warden everything it needs.

THE QUIET GAME

Everything above assembles into a toolkit, and this is it, whole:

- **Walk and Crawl.** The silent gaits (**Gaits and Stances** (p. 17)). The pool only hears what you spend.
- **Concealment.** Shortens sentry eyes, blinds Blips entirely while you hold fire, and reads as Cover when the shooting starts (**Open or In Cover** (p. 9)).
- **Darkness.** Shortens sentry eyes the same way, and thickens every shot fired without lights (**The Test** (p. 5)). The scenario says when the board is dark, and whose gear ignores it.
- **The Blind Arc.** Every enemy figure drags a blind quadrant behind it (**Facing and the Blind Arc** (p. 10)). Approach routes are built out of them.

squares, count turns, and the gap in the coverage is yours to schedule.

- **Suppressed weapons.** Quiet on the pool — the smaller cap on the Noise table — but quiet is all they buy. Firing still makes you Known (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)), and a shot fired at an enemy who lives to understand it, or in view of another enemy element, is clear contact: the force is Alerted, suppressor or none (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)). A suppressor is arithmetic, not absolution. Shoot the watcher no one is watching, kill with the first round, and the pool barely stirs; miss, and the report was never the problem.
- **Cut comms.** A landline is an Interact away from being slack wire, and dead comms is the difference between a garrison that is Alerted and a garrison that has told someone (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17), **The Enemy System** (p. 66)).

TAKEDOWNS

While the enemy force is Unaware (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)), a Crew figure carrying a blade may take down an adjacent enemy figure. Spend an Interact (**Action Points** (p. 13)): the target is **Down** — automatically. No test, no attack roll, no Noise. In practice the target is a scripted sentry, because while the force is Unaware, sentries are usually all that stands revealed.

The conditions are the entire difficulty. *Adjacent* means you crossed every spotting distance on the board and were standing at his shoulder when your activation gave you the AP (**Spotting** (p. 19)). *Unaware* means the window closes on its own: once the force is Suspicious or worse, nobody on that board is Unaware enough, and the knife goes back to being a tool. The approach — Blind Arc, Concealment, the phase arithmetic of the sentry check — is the skill being tested. The Interact is just the receipt.

A takedown is silent, not tidy. The man is Down, not vanished — lootable, restrainable, and findable. Which brings us to the oldest problem in this line of work.

BODIES

Every quiet kill leaves a body, and a body is Noise waiting to be counted. A Blip, or a revealed OPFOR figure with LOS outside its Blind Arc, that moves within 3 squares of a body **discovers** it: add +3 Noise immediately. If the finder is a revealed element, the discovery is also clear contact — the force is Alerted at once (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)). If the finder is a Blip, the force becomes at least Suspicious, whatever the pool reads, and the Blip walks on, unresolved; somewhere out there, something has started barking.

You can spend sweat against the clock. Move a body as you would carry a Down crew member — both hands, half AP (**Wounds & Recovery** (p. 36)). A body dragged into Concealment or water, or laid Deep inside a Zone (**Indoors: Zones and Portals** (p. 10)), is discovered only by a Blip or figure entering its square or an adjacent one. There is no hiding a man forever: posts get relieved and radio checks come due, and the scenario's fallback timer is how the Warden's patience runs out (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)). Hiding the work buys turns, not absolution — but turns are the only currency this chapter deals in.

Margin note, Ledford's hand: *sentry work is three clocks. his relief, his partner, his phase. the relief you get from the scenario sheet. the partner you find before you commit — posts are pairs, and the second man is the one that kills you. the phase you already own: he looks when the Warden's turn starts, not when you move, so the last stretch is free if — IF — the knife finishes before the phase does. count your AP twice on the way in. and put the far one down first if you can reach him with a quiet rifle. the near one you can always reach with your hands.*

JUNIOR LEDFORD

TIER	Skilled civilian
SHOOT	11/13
GRIT	11
AP	8
BIO	Bear hunter out of Sugar Creek. Counts wind in his sleep.

EXAMPLE

The landline shack. Turn 3 of a night raid; the sheet prints Alert thresholds of Suspicious 3 and Alerted 7, and the pool sits at 2 from two Sprints during insertion. The force is Unaware. Where the landline crosses the creek stands a shack with a sentry pair: Sentry A behind sandbags at the road gate, facing north up the road; Sentry B at the east wall, facing the treeline. Their post's fixed line means ALARM is automatic if they are ever Alerted at it — the wire is the mission. Blip 4 walks a road loop behind the spur, out of everyone's LOS. Junior Ledford and Reyna Vasquez are in the hardwoods 9 squares east; her carbine wears the crew's one suppressor.

Distances first. A sentry spots at 12 squares — 6 with the Concealment and the dark, either one enough. Ledford's Stalker skill cuts that to 3, and prone in his ghillie he cannot be spotted past 2. Vasquez has no such card: she holds at 7 squares, one outside the sentries' reach.

Turn 3. Ledford (8 AP) walks 5 squares through the brush (5 AP) to its edge, 4 from Sentry B, and goes prone (1 AP), holding 2. Vasquez (8 AP) shifts 2 squares (2 AP) to a deadfall with an angle on the gate. Second activation ends: the Interrupt Die (**The Interrupt Die** (p. 13)) comes up 4 — nothing. Warden Phase: the pool reads 2, still Unaware; both sentries check — Ledford is prone-ghillie at 4 squares, past his 2; Vasquez at 7, past her 6 — nothing. Blip 4 walks its printed loop 2 squares, behind the spur.

Turn 4. Ledford stands (1 AP) and crosses the yard, 3 squares (3 AP) — inside the 6 the dark allows, but sentries check when the Warden Phase starts, and B does not have one coming. Nor can B's held AP answer the movement: Reaction Fire, like every Warden trigger, needs a Known target, and Ledford is not Known (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)). Interact (2 AP): automatic Down. No roll, no Noise. He ends behind the shack, its Block breaking LOS to the gate. Vasquez has not moved this activation and is rested on the deadfall: a Braced Shot (5 AP). Sentry A's sandbags clip her line — Cover, so the second number of her Shoot 10/12: TN 12, +2 for darkness without lights, -1 Braced. TN 13. She rolls 2d10: **9 and 6** — 15. Hit. Casualty Die: **d10 = 5**, plus the carbine's DR 3, minus his Armor 1 — 7. **Dead.** The suppressed shot adds +1 Noise — pool 3 — and marks Vasquez Known at her fired-from square. No living enemy saw any of it: no clear contact. The Interrupt Die is rolled and means nothing — no revealed element left standing, and Blips never Interrupt. Warden Phase: pool 3 — **Suspicious**. Blip

4 stops patrolling and moves 3 squares toward the newest Noise source: the shack.

Turn 5. Ledford cuts the landline (Interact, 2 AP), then drags Sentry B — both hands, half AP — 2 squares into the creek-ditch laurel (4 AP) and goes prone (1 AP). One AP left; Sentry A stays where he fell. Thirty seconds is thirty seconds. Vasquez displaces 4 squares back through the timber, no OPFOR figure holding LOS at any point: **Unknown** — her old square lingers as the Warden's last Known position, aging. Warden Phase: Blip 4 rounds the spur 11 squares from Ledford, in his LOS — it resolves. **d10 = 4** on the Contact Table: a patrol pair. Next turn they reach the gate and find Sentry A: +3 Noise — pool 6 — and a body found by a revealed element is clear contact. **Alerted**, one point shy of the threshold anyway.

Count what the fieldcraft bought. The Warden is Alerted with no Known target on the board, its Directives start a turn late, and its only line out of the valley ends in slack wire. The mission has gone loud — on the crew's terms.

The next chapter is for the moment the terms are set and the argument starts: **Ranged Combat** (p. 23), where the shooting is deliberate and the arithmetic you have been banking — Noise, position, Known and Unknown — gets paid out in TNs.

RANGED COMBAT

The first morning at the gravel pit, Deacon set one silhouette at a hundred meters and gave each of us five rounds. Nobody impressed anybody. Then he stood the target behind a culvert pipe and gave us five more. Two hits, fourteen shooters. That's the whole war, he said. Any fool can kill a man in the open — the world will rarely sell you one. You'll pay for every clean look with sweat and angles, and when the look comes, your rifle had better already be up. We policed our brass in silence. Every case, he said. We're not the ones with a factory.

This is the gun chapter. **Core Concepts** (p. 5) taught you the test, the Open-or-Cover call, and line of sight; **Actions & the Turn** (p. 12) taught you what a shot costs and when one happens out of turn. This chapter assembles those parts into the complete firing procedure, then walks the armory: what Effective Range means at the table, what every weapon trait does, which guns your people actually carry, and how grenades, smoke, and fire behave. What a hit does to a human being is deliberately not here — that is the business of **Wounds & Recovery** (p. 36), and this chapter hands off to it at the moment the round lands.

THE ATTACK PROCEDURE

Every shot in the game runs the same six steps — Aimed, Snap, Braced, or Reaction Fire, your rifle or the Warden's. Learn it once; nothing later in this book replaces it, only feeds it.

1. **Declare.** Name the shooter, the target figure, and the kind of shot — Snap, Aimed, or Braced (**Action Points** (p. 13)). Confirm the shot is legal: the target is inside the shooter's frontal arc (**Facing and the Blind Arc** (p. 10)), the LOS line is clear (**Line of Sight** (p. 8)), and the target is inside the weapon's range envelope (**Range and the Envelope** (p. 24)). If any of the three fails, there is no shot to take.
2. **Pay.** Spend the shot's AP from the shooter's pool. Reaction Fire pays the Snap Shot's cost from held AP (**Reaction Fire** (p. 14)).
3. **Pick one number.** Ask the binary question of **Open or In Cover** (p. 9): is the target Open or in Cover? Take the matching TN from the shooter's

Shoot line. This is the only thing cover ever does to a shot.

4. **Modify.** Apply every line of the closed modifier list that is true — the shot type, the range band, smoke or darkness, a Shaken shooter, a Sprinting target, elevation, Point Blank (**The Test** (p. 5)). Nothing off the list touches the roll. Clamp the net total to the printed maximum before rolling.

5. **Roll.** 2d10, summed, against the final TN. Equal or higher hits. A natural 20 is a catastrophic success: the hit ignores Armor and adds +3 Severity (**Core Concepts** (p. 5)). A natural 2 fails and jams the weapon — see below.

6. **Resolve.** On a hit, route by target type and leave this chapter:

- **Crew figure** → the wound procedure: Hit Location, then Severity (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)).
- **OPFOR figure** → one Casualty Die (**The Enemy's Ledger: the Casualty Die** (p. 40)).
- **Support unit** (a driver, a porter) → the Casualty Die at -1 (**The Enemy's Ledger: the Casualty Die** (p. 40)).
- **Vehicle** → the vehicle hit-and-damage procedure (**Vehicles** (p. 52)).
- **Drone** → the drone rules (**Drones & Electronic Warfare** (p. 59)).

On a miss, check one thing before moving on: the near miss — an Automatic weapon's closest failures can still Shake a target in the open. The near-miss rule is owned by the hit-resolution procedure (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)); every other miss is simply a miss.

Finally, book the shot's Noise (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). Fire is the loudest thing most missions ever do, and the Warden is listening.

Jams. A natural 2 on any shot is the standard firing complication: the weapon jams. A jammed weapon cannot fire again until its bearer clears it with a Reload action (**Action Points** (p. 13)). The jam replaces the natural 2's default complication — the shooter is not also Shaken.

One trigger, one target. A shot attacks a single declared figure. The only ways this game puts one

roll against several bodies are the Blast weapons later in this chapter (**Grenades & Explosives** (p. 27)) and Sustained Fire's Beaten Zone (**Crew-Served Weapons** (p. 46)).

RANGE AND THE ENVELOPE

Every weapon prints an **Effective Range** in squares. It is not a maximum; it is the distance inside which the weapon's user shoots at the printed TNs. From there the envelope has three bands, priced by the modifier list (**The Test** (p. 5)):

- **Point Blank** — an adjacent square, or any target in the same Zone (**Indoors: Zones and Portals** (p. 10)): -2 TN. Close is easy, for everyone, in both directions.
- **Inside Effective Range** — the printed TNs, unmodified by distance.
- **Beyond Effective, up to twice Effective** — +2 TN. The weapon still reaches; the shooter is working.
- **Beyond twice Effective** — no shot. A Scoped weapon alone may take it, at +4 TN in place of the ban (**Weapon Traits** (p. 24)).

Measure in squares by the shortest legal count, like every distance in the game.

What the numbers mean on a standard 30×24 board: a Pistol's 8 and a Hunting Shotgun's 6 squares make them fighting tools for yards, doorways, and Zones; the Submachine Gun's 12 covers a farmyard; the Carbine's 20 covers most of a board; the Battle Rifle's 30 and the Scoped Hunting Rifle's 40 mean that outdoors, distance alone will almost never protect anyone from either. Past the shortest barrels, the practical limit on rifle fire in this valley is not range — it is LOS, brush, and the Cover TN. That is a Leaf Season fact with a mechanical edge: as the hardwoods drop and Concealment thins scenario by scenario, the long guns' envelopes stop being theoretical.

WEAPON TRAITS

A weapon card carries its numbers — DR, Pen, Effective Range — and a short list of **traits**. A trait is a standing rule, always on, never optional. This glossary is the owning definition of every trait in the game except the four crew-served traits at the end.

Automatic. The weapon fires bursts, and its misses have a fringe: it can inflict the **near miss** — a close miss that Shakes a target in the open. The rule itself is owned by the hit-resolution procedure (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)); what the trait marks is which weapons get it. This single rule is the game's hasty suppression, and it is worth building around (**Suppressive Intent** (p. 26)).

Scoped. The weapon may fire beyond twice its Effective Range at +4 TN, where other weapons have no shot at all (**Range and the Envelope** (p. 24)). The +2 band between one and two times Effective applies to it as normal.

Bolt. A manual action. Snap Shots with a Bolt weapon take an additional +1 TN on top of the Snap penalty (it counts inside the modifier cap), and a Bolt weapon is never Automatic — it cannot inflict the near miss. The gun rewards a shooter who takes the time it asks for.

Spread. A cone of shot: +1 DR against targets within 3 squares. Spread weapons are also the crew's best answer to small drones — the flat anti-drone TN lives with the drone rules (**Drones & Electronic Warfare** (p. 59)).

One-Handed. Fired from one hand at no penalty. A figure whose arm wound forces it to one hand keeps shooting a One-Handed weapon at its printed TNs, where a long gun pays the wound table's penalty (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)).

Compact. Short enough to fight indoors. A Compact weapon takes no long-gun penalty in Zone fighting; that penalty is defined with the Zone-fighting rules (**Fighting Inside a Zone** (p. 31)).

Heavy-Round. A full-power rifle cartridge. The trait marks the weapon as a threat to soft vehicles through its printed Pen — resolution belongs to **Vehicles** (p. 52).

Blast-1. The weapon does not attack a figure; it attacks a square, and everything within 1 square of the detonation — a nine-square footprint — takes the blast attack (**Grenades & Explosives** (p. 27)).

Backblast. The launch throws a cone of fire behind the shooter. A Backblast weapon may not be fired from inside a Zone.

Single-Shot. One round is all the figure carries. Once fired, the weapon is spent for the mission;

there is no Reload.

Thrown. Delivered by the Throw procedure (**Grenades & Explosives** (p. 27)). A Thrown weapon's Effective Range is its throwing range, and it does not take the over-Effective bands — 8 squares is the arm's limit, full stop.

Stun. No DR and no attack roll. When the weapon resolves, every figure in the target Zone — or within 1 square of the detonation square outdoors — is Shaken, no test. Stun weapons are the key that opens doors: they enable first-fire entry (**The Entry Fight** (p. 31)).

Placed. Not thrown. The figure sets the charge in its own or an adjacent square, or against a wall or object, for the AP cost on the card, and it detonates by command or timer as the card and scenario state.

Breach. Detonating against a wall blows a new Portal through it (**Breaching** (p. 32)).

Fire. The detonation leaves a fire marker in the impact square (**Fire** (p. 29)).

Triggered. The device detonates on a condition, not an order to throw: command wire, pressure plate, tripwire, per scenario. Both sides use Triggered weapons, and both sides walk carefully because of it.

Piloted. The attack is made with a Pilot test, not any figure's Shoot line. Piloted weapons belong to **Drones & Electronic Warfare** (p. 59).

Silent. Using the weapon generates no Noise (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). The blade's takedown procedure itself rides with the stealth rules (**The Quiet Game** (p. 20)).

The crew-served traits. Four traits — **Sustained**, **Crew-Served**, **Mounted**, and **Indirect** — mark the weapons that fight as a team's job rather than one figure's action: machine guns, mounted guns, mortars, the Beaten Zone. They are named here so the cards read; they are defined in **Crew-Served Weapons** (p. 46).

THE ARSENAL

Every weapon in the campaign is one card, read exactly like a Crew card's weapon line: DR, Pen, Effective Range, traits. The complete arsenal is printed in the appendix at the back of this book;

three cards carry most of the game's fights and repay a closer read.

CARBINE

CLASS	rifle
DR	3
PEN	0
EFF	20

The standard fighting rifle of every faction.

The Carbine is the war's common denominator — the ECA carries it, the Civil Order Corps carries it, and every one your Crew owns was probably theirs first. DR 3 kills at every range that matters, 20 squares of Effective Range covers nearly any board, and Automatic means even its misses do work against people in the open. When a rule in this book needs a default gun, this is the gun.

SCOPED HUNTING RIFLE

CLASS	rifle
DR	3
PEN	1
EFF	40

Scoped: may fire beyond 2x Effective at +4 TN. Bolt: no Automatic near-miss; Snap Shots +1 additional TN.

The Scoped Hunting Rifle is the valley's own answer, walked out of a thousand October deer camps. 40 squares of Effective Range and the Scoped trait give it reaches no carbine has; Bolt takes away the near miss and taxes hasty work. It is a deliberate shooter's weapon in every sense — in Junior Ledford's hands, with his Hunter skill flattening the range bands, it is the closest thing the Crew has to owning a piece of the horizon.

HUNTING SHOTGUN

CLASS	shotgun
DR	3
PEN	0
EFF	6

+1 DR within 3 squares. Best counter-drone weapon: 11 flat to hit drones within 6.

The Hunting Shotgun is short, common as fence wire, and inside 3 squares it hits harder than a rifle — Spread's +1 DR on top of DR 3. Its 6-square Effective Range makes it a doorway and barnyard weapon, which is where half this game is decided, and it is the tool the Crew reaches for when the

Authority's drones come low (**Drones & Electronic Warfare** (p. 59)).

Around these three: the Pistol, One-Handed, is the backup that keeps a wounded arm in the fight; the Submachine Gun is Compact volume for Zone work; the Battle Rifle trades handiness for reach and a Heavy-Round that worries trucks. The Medium and Heavy Machine Guns are not personal weapons at all — they are jobs, and **Crew-Served Weapons** (p. 46) is their chapter. The Rocket is a Single-Shot argument for use against vehicles and strongpoints, with a Backblast that forbids firing it from indoors.

SUPPRESSIVE INTENT

Read the Automatic near miss again, this time as a plan. A burst that misses by 1 or 2 Shakes an Open target — and Shaken is real damage: 4 AP gone, +2 TN on everything, no Reaction Fire (**Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40)). So an automatic weapon pointed at somebody in the open does not need to hit to be working, and a shooter who cannot buy a good TN can still buy fear. Snap Shots at long range, at sprinters, from Shaken hands — shots you would never take for the kill are worth taking

for the flinch. This is the poor man's suppression: no template, no team, just volume and intent, and your Green shooters can deliver it the mission they arrive.

Its limits are the point. The near miss only works against the Open — a target behind a wall cannot be scared this way, only hit — and a Snap Shot's Noise costs the same as a killing shot's (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). When the target is in Cover and must still be made to keep its head down, you have outgrown this section: real suppression is a machine gun's Sustained Fire and the Beaten Zone, and it lives in **Crew-Served Weapons** (p. 46).

DESIGNER'S NOTE

The near miss converts the fiction everyone already believes — automatic fire is scary before it is lethal — into one free check on a number you have already rolled. No suppression points, no pinning template, no extra dice. It also quietly grades the arsenal: at a hopeless TN 15, an Open target still eats a Shaken on a 13 or 14 — 15% of the curve doing work a miss would waste. And because the rule reads “miss by 1-2,” better shooters throw near misses more often too: the band rides just under wherever your TN sits. Skill improves even your failures.

EXAMPLE

The same shot, both ways. Turn two at the weighstation. Dale “Deacon” McAllister kneels at a stack of culvert pipe; an ECA Rifleman — Shoot 11/13, Armor 1, carbine — is 12 squares away, well inside Deacon’s own carbine’s 20. Deacon’s card reads Shoot 8/10 and 7 AP. Run his activation twice, same dice, and watch what one wall changes.

Take one — the Open. The Rifleman is caught crossing the lot between the office and the scale house: upright, Clear terrain, not Sprinting. Deacon steps one square clear of the pipe for the angle (1 AP) and takes an Aimed Shot (4 AP) at the left-hand number of his Shoot line: **Open TN 8**. Nothing on the modifier list applies. He rolls 2d10: **4 and 3 — 7**. A miss by 1 — but his carbine is Automatic and the target is Open, so the near miss lands: the Rifleman is **Shaken**. Deacon has 2 AP left and spends them on a Snap Shot: TN 8, +3 Snap, TN 11. He rolls **9 and 4 — 13**. A hit. Roll the Casualty Die (**The Enemy’s Ledger: the Casualty Die** (p. 40) — the table lives with the wound rules): d10 comes up 6, plus the carbine’s DR 3, minus Armor 1 — total **8. Dead**.

Take two — the Cover. Same range, but this time the Rifleman is firing over the scale-house windowsill: the LOS line touches a Cover square adjacent to him, so the right-hand number applies. Deacon doesn’t move — the pipe is a rest, so he opens with a Braced Shot (5 AP): **Cover TN 10, -1 Braced, TN 9**. Same dice: **4 and 3 — 7**. A miss by 2, and this time it buys nothing at all — the near miss needs an Open target. His last 2 AP go on the Snap Shot: TN 10, +3 Snap, TN 13. Same dice: **9 and 4 — 13**. A hit, with nothing to spare. Casualty Die: **6 + 3 - 1 = 8. Dead**.

Same dice, same corpse — but read the ledger. In the open, Deacon’s opener hit on a 79% and even its miss Shook the man; the finisher needed an 11 (about 55%). Behind the sill, the opener needed a supported position just to reach 72%, its miss was worthless, and the finisher was a coin toss he won on the exact number (13 hits on 36%). That roughly ten-points-per-TN arithmetic is what a wall *is* in this game. Both takes end the same uncomfortable way, too: 7 AP all spent, so Deacon holds nothing — no Reaction Fire until he activates again (**Overwatch** (p. 14)). And both takes owe the Warden Phase the same debt: two unsuppressed shots, capped at gunfire’s per-turn maximum (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)).

GRENADES & EXPLOSIVES

A grenade is not a fast gun. It is a slow, area-eating machine that attacks a *square*, ignores facing, and

resolves on a delay that both sides can spend against. Every Thrown explosive uses this procedure; the Placed and Triggered ones skip the throw and join it at the detonation.

THE THROW

Throwing costs 3 AP. Pick a target square within the weapon’s range — 8 squares for a Frag Grenade — that the thrower has LOS to. Low Cover along the line is never a bar to the throw, whatever it does to a shot — a grenade arcs over the wall a bullet has to beat. It cannot be thrown through Block or a closed door, and it always targets a square, never a figure.

Then make the **Throw test**: **2d10 ≥ 10**. There is no Cover TN for a throw — the target’s wall matters at detonation, not at release — but the modifier list applies as usual (a Shaken thrower is still +2). On a success, place the grenade marker in the target square. On a failure, the grenade **scatters**: roll d8 for direction — a 1 is directly away from the thrower, counting clockwise — and d6 halved (round up) for distance in squares: a 1–2 travels 1, a 3–4 travels 2, a 5–6 travels 3. **Walls stop scatter**: a scattering grenade that would cross a wall or Block edge stops in the last legal square in front of it. A natural 2 on the Throw test takes the default complication — the thrower is Shaken and marks +1 Noise — in addition to scattering.

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-GRENADE-SCATTER.SVG]

Throwing into buildings is the close-quarters chapter’s business: a grenade posted through an adjacent open Portal neither scatters nor needs a Throw test, and what it does to a Zone full of defenders — Posted, Deep, or stacked to enter — is resolved at **Grenades Into Zones** (p. 33).

END OF THE PHASE

A grenade marker does not detonate when it lands. **Every explosive marker resolves at the end of the current Phase** — throw during your Crew Phase, and it goes off when your Crew Phase ends; a Warden-thrown grenade goes off at the end of the Warden Phase. Those seconds belong to everyone.

Until the marker resolves, any figure — either side, Shaken or not — may pay **1 AP to dive away: go prone and move 1 square**, once per figure per detonation. A dive is not Reaction Fire and does not count against the reaction limit; the AP comes from whatever the figure holds, spent out of turn. Warden figures with held AP dive whenever it would help them (**The Good-Faith Clause** (p. 4)). When the Phase ends, resolve all waiting markers in the order they landed: dives first — Crew figures in an order you pick, Warden figures by good faith — then each blast.

THE BLAST

A detonating Blast-1 weapon makes the **blast attack: 2d10 vs 12/14, at the weapon’s DR, separately against every figure within 1 square of the marker** — the nine-square footprint. Judge Open or Cover per figure *from the marker’s square* (**Open or In Cover** (p. 9)): the same burst can catch one man Open and spare his neighbor behind the truck. Prone helps only by way of the dive that got you there — at blast distance, prone is not Cover — but a dive that carries a figure out of the footprint entirely is the best save the game sells. Each hit routes by target type exactly as step 6 of the attack procedure (**The Attack Procedure** (p. 23)); Blast hits roll Casualty Dice and Severity like any other hit, and Armor counts. Every detonation is an explosion for Noise purposes (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)).

The explosives themselves:

FRAG GRENADE

CLASS	explosive
DR	3
PEN	1
EFF	8

Attack 12/14 vs all figures within 1 square of impact. Resolves end of Phase (§6.6).

FLASHBANG

CLASS	explosive
DR	0
PEN	0
EFF	8

All figures in target Zone/square+1 are Shaken. Enables first-fire entry (§6.5).

DEMOLITION CHARGE

CLASS	explosive
DR	5
PEN	4
EFF	0

Placed (4 AP). Breaches walls into new Portals. Command or timed detonation.

MOLOTOV

CLASS	explosive
DR	2
PEN	0
EFF	6

Leaves a fire marker in the impact square (impassable; +1 Noise/turn while burning).

IED

CLASS	explosive
DR	6
PEN	4
EFF	0

Command- or victim-triggered per scenario. Both sides use these.

The **Frag Grenade** is the blast attack in its pure form, DR 3 against everything in the footprint. The **Flashbang** trades all of that for certainty: Stun, no roll, everyone in the Zone Shaken — the tool that decides an entry before it happens (**The Entry Fight** (p. 31)). The **Demolition Charge** is Placed, not thrown, and its Breach trait rewrites the map, opening Portals where the defender planned walls (**Breaching** (p. 32)); its DR 5 blast makes standing near the far side of that wall its own mistake. The **Molotov** is the poor man’s artillery — DR 2 and a fire marker that keeps working after the glass stops (**Fire** (p. 29)). The **IED**, Placed and Triggered, is DR 6 of patience; scenarios state its trigger, and both sides bury them.

EXAMPLE

Scatter at the machine shed. Crew Phase, turn four. Two Civil Order Corpsmen shelter behind a flatbed by the machine shed; Tanya Okafor is 6 squares off with a Frag Grenade. She pays 3 AP and targets the square between them — the flatbed is low Cover, which blocks neither her LOS nor her throw. Throw test $2d10 \geq 10$: she rolls **5 and 4** — **9**. Short. Scatter: d8 comes up **3** — clockwise from straight-away, that drifts the grenade right — and the d6 comes up **3**, halved and rounded up to **2 squares**. One square out, the shed wall is in the way: walls stop scatter, and the marker halts in the square against the wall — 1 square from one Corpسمan, out of footprint of the other. The Crew Phase ends and the marker cooks. The near Corpسمan's element held 2 AP, and the Warden spends 1 the sensible way: he dives, prone, 1 square along the wall — still inside the footprint, but now judged from the marker square he is behind the flatbed's corner: Cover. Blast attack at Cover TN 14: Okafor's dice come up **8 and 7** — **15**. A hit anyway. Casualty Die: d10 **4**, + DR 3, — Armor 0 = **7**. Dead where he lay. The far Corpسمan, outside the footprint, doesn't even roll — and the explosion's Noise goes on the ledger (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)).

Margin note, Deacon's hand: *The wait is the weapon. Nobody throws frags at soldiers — you throw them at choices. He can dive and be prone and useless, or stand his post and eat it. Either way the door is better than it was. And learn the wall rule cold: thrown short, a grenade rolls to the base of the wall — which is exactly where they put their backs.*

DESIGNER'S NOTE

End-of-Phase resolution is the load-bearing oddity here. A live grenade that resolved instantly would just be a better rifle; on a delay, it is a zone-denial argument that the enemy gets to answer with AP — which makes held AP, once again, the game's real currency. It also keeps the Warden honest and simple: no interrupt windows, no timing stack. Everything thrown this Phase cooks when the Phase does.

SMOKE**SMOKE GRENADES (PAIR)**

SLOT	1
EFFECT	Thrown (3 AP, range 8) — 2-square smoke cloud until end of next turn (+2 TN through, blocks spotting).
SUPPLY	1

A smoke grenade is thrown exactly like any Thrown weapon — 3 AP, range 8, Throw test at 10, scatter on a failure — but it is not an explosive: nothing dives from it, and it blooms the moment it lands rather than waiting for the Phase to end. Place a **smoke cloud** covering the landing square and one adjacent square of the thrower's choice. The cloud stands until the End Phase of the *following* turn, then drifts off.

Smoke never blocks LOS (**Line of Sight** (p. 8)). What it does is two things. Any shot whose LOS line crosses a smoke square takes the obscured modifier from the list (**The Test** (p. 5)) — in either direction; smoke has no friends. And smoke **blocks spotting**: sentries cannot spot through it, Blips do not resolve through it, and figures behind it are not Known by being seen there (**Spotting** (p. 19), **Blips** (p. 18)). Smoke is the only tool in the game that manufactures concealment on demand, in the open, in seconds — which is why crossing the kill zone in **Crew-Served Weapons** (p. 46)'s arithmetic so often begins with a can of it. Remember what it is not: it stops no bullets, and a burst fired blind through it can still find you — Shaken shooters and worse odds, but the Warden will still spend rounds on the last place you were Known.

FIRE

Fire markers enter play from Molotovs (**Grenades & Explosives** (p. 27)), from vehicles that burn (**Vehicles** (p. 52)), and from scenario events. A burning square is **impassable** — no figure may enter or end movement there — and the fire adds +1 Noise each turn it burns (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). A figure standing in a square when it catches fire is driven out: move it 1 square by the shortest legal path as the marker is placed, at no AP cost. Fire does not block LOS and is not Cover; it is simply ground nobody can use. A fire marker burns for the rest of the mission unless the scenario says otherwise; where a scenario wants fire to spread or die, its sheet says how, and the End Phase's clock step is when it happens (**The Turn Sequence** (p. 12)).

Used deliberately, fire is area denial that never gets tired: a burning doorway is a Portal nobody breaches, and a burning lane turns a cordon's map into your map. It is also permanent, loud, and

utterly indifferent to Rapport when it reaches something the valley needed — the campaign rules have a memory for that kind of thing (**The Long War** (p. 84)).

You now own the shot from declaration to the moment it lands, and the tools that attack squares instead of silhouettes. Two chapters extend this

one: **Close Quarters & Breaching** (p. 31) takes the procedure indoors, where every fight is Point Blank and the door decides who fires first — and **Crew-Served Weapons** (p. 46) scales it up to the guns that attack the ground itself. What the bullet does when it arrives — location, severity, blood, and the long cost — is waiting in **Wounds & Recovery** (p. 36).

CLOSE QUARTERS & BREACHING

The plywood house behind Herron's mill has no roof, one door, and chalk on every wall. Inside, penciled tallies from weeks of runs: who hesitated on the threshold, who crossed it flat-footed and took a chalk X on the chest for it. A doorway is a machine for killing the first one through, Deacon says before every run. You don't argue with a machine. You feed it something it chokes on — light, noise, a hole where it wasn't watching — and you come in second.

This chapter owns the fight at door distance: what shooting inside a Zone means, who fires first when a figure comes through a Portal, how to make the answer be you, and what the knife is for. Zones, Portals, and the Posted and Deep states are defined in **Indoors: Zones and Portals** (p. 10) and are not repeated here; attacks resolve by **The Attack Procedure** (p. 23), as always. Everything that follows happens inside five meters, in about three seconds, and is mostly decided before anyone steps through the door.

FIGHTING INSIDE A ZONE

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-ZONES-PORTALS.SVG]

Every fight between figures in the same Zone is a Point Blank fight: apply the Point Blank line of the modifier list (**The Test** (p. 5)) to every attack between them, gun or blade.

Inside a Zone there is no cover. The cover conditions of **Open or In Cover** (p. 9) read from the shooter's side of the wall: a Posted figure counts as in Cover against fire *from outside its Zone*, and only there. Between figures sharing a Zone, every target is Open — shoot the left-hand number. The one exception is the grenade, below.

Long guns hate rooms. **A rifle-class weapon, a shotgun, or a crew-served weapon fires at +1 TN while its shooter is inside a Zone** — a long barrel swung at room distance costs exactly one point, and it counts inside the modifier cap (**The Test** (p. 5)). Sidearms and Compact weapons are exempt; waiving this line is what the Compact trait is for (**Weapon Traits** (p. 24)).

Facing does not constrain a Zone fight either. A Zone is close chaos: every aware figure in it counts as inside every other's frontal arc — the Blind Arc (**Facing and the Blind Arc** (p. 10)) is an outdoor problem. Unaware figures are another chapter's matter (**The Quiet Game** (p. 20)).

Declare each figure's state — Posted at a named Portal, or Deep — when it enters a Zone, and change it freely at any point while the figure is spending AP, exactly as you change facing. A figure that ends its activation keeps its state until it next spends AP. The two states are the two jobs a room offers: a Posted figure is the room's wall, fighting the outside war through its one Portal; a Deep figure with held AP is the room's ambush, waiting for the inside one. A defense that is all wall can be stunned through its own doorway; one that is all ambush lets you pick when the door opens. The Warden's better elements post one and hide one, and so should you.

Entering or leaving a Zone through a Portal costs AP like any other action (**Action Points** (p. 13)). Entering an *empty* Zone is just movement. Entering an occupied one is the rest of this chapter.

THE ENTRY FIGHT

When your figure pays the entry cost and comes through a Portal into a Zone holding enemies, resolve the entry fight. The order of fire is the whole rule:

On a clean entry, all non-Shaken defenders Posted at the entry Portal, or covering it, resolve Reaction Fire against the entering figure first — then the entering figure acts.

A defender is at the Portal when it is Posted there, on its side of the opening. A defender covers the Portal when it is somewhere else with LOS to it and eligibility to react through it — Posted at an aligned Portal of the next room, or outside on the grid with the doorway in its arc. Deep figures neither hold a Portal nor cover one: Deep buys safety at the price of every first shot.

These first shots are ordinary Reaction Fire in every respect but timing (**Reaction Fire** (p. 14)):

costs 2 AP of held AP, counts against the two-reaction cap, is barred while Shaken or Pinned, and takes the flat reaction penalty. Read the target as it stands — inside the Zone, Open, Point Blank.

A defender neither at nor covering the Portal gets no shot at the moment of entry — it was watching the wrong opening. It may take ordinary Reaction Fire at the enterer's *subsequent* triggers — a shot fired, further movement — under the normal rules.

Each entering figure is its own entry fight. That arithmetic is why crews enter in a stream, not a trickle: reactions cost 2 AP apiece and cap at two, so the door that kills the first figure through is often empty-handed against the third.

Breaching first reverses the order. If the entry follows any of these *in the same Crew Phase*:

- a kicked breach with a grenade put through it,
- a flashbang into the Zone, or
- a demolition breach,

then mark every defender in the entered Zone **Shaken** first, and **the entering figure fires first** — resolve its first action before any defender's reaction, then proceed normally. Shaken defenders cannot react at all, so the room's answer usually never comes. A defender covering the Portal from beyond the blast keeps its nerve and its reactions — but even it fires only after the enterer has.

One skill bends the clean order without explosives: a figure with the SOF vet's **Point Man** skill fires first on clean entries, once per turn, exactly as its card states. It stuns nobody — the defenders' reactions still come, one action late, from defenders still steady.

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-ENTRY-FIGHT.SVG]

DESIGNER'S NOTE

The entry fight is the chapter in one rule, and it is deliberately lopsided. A defender Posted at a door shoots the first thing through it at Point Blank; the entering figure eats the wound chapter while the defender rolls one die. You are not supposed to beat that exchange. You are supposed to refuse it — take the fight away from the Portal with noise, light, or a new hole in the wall, and arrive after the decision is made. This is the door problem at Zone resolution: room fights are won in the second before entry, or not at all.

BREACHING

Getting in has four prices. Every one is on the universal cost list (**Action Points** (p. 13)) or a card — breaching adds no new dice.

The door. An unbarred door opens for 1 AP; climbing through a window costs 2. Opening a door is quiet and is not itself a reaction trigger — but an open Portal works both ways: a defender Posted there sees out, and anything crossing its line outside is fair game for reactions. A door the scenario marks locked or barred does not open for AP. Kick it or blow it.

The kick. A kicked breach costs 2 AP and +2 Noise, and the opening is a Portal from then on. Breaching is a Reaction Fire trigger (**Reaction Fire** (p. 14)): a defender Posted at that door may fire at the kicker as it gives way. The kick alone reverses nothing — entry after a bare kick is a clean entry into a warned room. It earns its keep as the first stroke of kick-and-frag: boot, grenade, figures, one Crew Phase.

The bang.

FLASHBANG

CLASS	explosive
DR	0
PEN	0
EFF	8

All figures in target Zone/square+1 are Shaken. Enables first-fire entry (§6.5).

Throw the flashbang like any grenade (3 AP, **Grenades & Explosives** (p. 27)); through an adjacent open Portal it cannot scatter and needs no roll. Every figure in the Zone is Shaken — no attack roll, no damage — and entry in the same Crew Phase is a breach entry: your figure fires

first. The bang is an explosion for Noise purposes (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). It is the tool that leaves survivors — yours, and, when you want prisoners, theirs.

The wall. The demolition charge is the Portal-maker. Place it against a wall (4 AP, per its card) and fire it: the wall gains a breach — a new Portal, exactly where the defense posted nobody — and the charge delivers its blast at DR 5 under the explosives rules (**Grenades & Explosives** (p. 27)). Entry through a demolition breach in the same Crew Phase is a breach entry. The explosion is +3 Noise, and a breach heard adjacent is clear contact — Alerted at once (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). That is the trade: a perfect door, announced to the county.

TABLE: GETTING THROUGH - DOORS, WINDOWS, BREACHES

METHOD	AP	NOISE	ENTRY ORDER
Open an unlocked door	1	0	Defenders fire first (clean entry)
Climb through a window	2	0	Defenders fire first (clean entry)
Kick a door	2	+2	Defenders fire first - the kick alone reverses nothing
Flashbang, then enter	3 (throw) + entry	+3	Defenders in the Zone Shaken; enterer fires first
Kick + frag, then enter	2 + 3 + entry	+2, +3	Defenders Shaken (and worse); enterer fires first
Demolition breach	4 (place) + entry	+3	New Portal anywhere in a wall; defenders Shaken; enterer fires first
Point Man (skill)	entry only	0	Enterer fires first on a clean entry, once per turn

Locked or barred doors (scenario-marked) do not open for 1 AP - kick or demo only.

GRENADES INTO ZONES

The throw itself — cost, range, scatter, the end-of-Phase timer, diving away — belongs to the grenade rules (**Grenades & Explosives** (p. 27)). Zones change two things:

- **An adjacent open Portal is a letterbox.** A grenade thrown through an open Portal from a square adjacent to it does not scatter and needs no Throw test: it lands in the Zone, full stop. From farther out, treat the Portal as the target square and throw normally — walls stop

scatter, so a wide throw drops at the frame or bounces back outside, never deeper into the building.

- **The blast owns the room.** A grenade that lands in a Zone attacks *every figure in that Zone* — position does not exist inside, and nowhere in a room is far from a grenade. Resolve its printed blast attack against each figure at its Open TN — except **Deep figures**, at its **Cover TN**. Deep is back corners and overturned furniture: the only cover a Zone has, and only against this.

MELEE & TAKEDOWNS

Close quarters ends closer than the gun. Against an **aware** enemy — adjacent on the grid, or sharing a Zone — a blade, a bayonet, or a swung rifle is not a subsystem: it is an attack. Pay the normal attack cost (**Action Points** (p. 13)), roll your Shoot line at Point Blank (**The Test** (p. 5)), and resolve a hit at DR 3. Its one distinction is the **Silent** trait: a blade makes no Noise, whatever it does — the only attack the Alert Ladder cannot hear (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)).

Understand what that buys. Against a watching enemy at arm's length, your rifle hits nearly the same Point Blank TN at the same DR — a blade is not *fired*, so inside a Zone the long barrel pays its +1 and the blade does not (**Fighting Inside a Zone** (p. 31)); beyond that point, the blade's only argument is silence. Draw it when the gun is empty, wrong, or loud.

Against the **Unaware**, the arithmetic changes species. The takedown of an Unaware adjacent sentry is not an attack at all — it is an Interact, it belongs to the quiet game, and its rules live with the rest of fieldcraft: **Takedowns** (p. 21).

DESIGNER'S NOTE

There is no dueling subsystem because there are no duels. At this scale a melee is one decision — who was ready — and the general rules already price it: readiness is the entry fight, surprise is the takedown, and everything between is an attack roll at Point Blank. A parry table would add pages to slow down the three seconds this game most wants fast.

Stack, breach, bang, flow. None of this is a rule; it is what the rules will teach you anyway, priced in blood, so take it here instead. **Stack** — the entry team goes flat against the wall beside the Portal, out of the line through the opening, before anyone touches the door; the ground in front of a watched doorway is the worst in the game. **Breach** — one figure owns the door: opens it, kicks it, or blows it, and does nothing else. **Bang** — something goes through the opening before anybody does: a flashbang if you want prisoners, a frag if you don't. **Flow** — the instant it works, everyone enters in the same Crew Phase, first figure to the deepest threat, each follower onto the next Portal, so no defender anywhere gets a second clean decision. Deacon's margin, under the tallies: *speed is not running. speed is no gaps.*

EXAMPLE

The Tolley farmhouse, run twice. Turn five, loud since turn two: the OPFOR is Alerted, everyone's first-fire Grit tests long paid, and the whole stack long since Known (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)) — the defenders' reactions have their lawful target. The kitchen is one Zone — a yard door, and an interior door to the front room. Two Civil Order Corpsmen hold it, one Posted at the yard door, one Deep, each holding 2 AP of reaction reserve: Shoot 13/15, Armor 0, carbines at DR 3. Stacked against the outside wall, out of the doorway's line: Hollis Grant at the door, Deacon behind him, Sana Haddad third.

Run one — the clean entry. Grant (8 AP) opens the door, 1 AP, and steps through, 2 AP. The Zone is occupied: entry fight. The Posted Corpsman is at that Portal and steady: his Reaction Fire resolves first, 2 AP. Grant stands inside the Zone — Open, Point Blank: Open TN 13, +3 Reaction Fire, -2 Point Blank, +1 for a carbine swung in a kitchen — 15. The Warden rolls **9 and 6** — 15. Hit. Grant takes a wound (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)): Hit Location d10 = 6, Torso, and he wears no plates. Severity d10 = 3, plus the carbine's DR 3, minus nothing: 6 — a Light wound. Shaken, Bleed 1, and 2 AP off the top: the 5 he still held becomes 3.

Then the entering figure acts. Grant can no longer afford the Aimed Shot, so he snaps the shotgun from the hip. His Shoot 11/13 gives Open 11, -3 Point Blank (his Deputy skill's better bargain), +3 Snap, +2 Shaken, +1 long gun in the Zone — TN 14. He rolls **8 and 6** — 14. Hit. Casualty Die (**The Enemy's Ledger: the Casualty Die** (p. 40)): d10 = 5, plus DR 3, +1 Spread this close, minus Armor 0: 9. **Dead.**

The Deep Corpsman had no shot at the entry — wrong opening — but Grant's muzzle flash is a trigger in their shared Zone, and he holds 2 AP. His reaction resolves simultaneously with Grant's shot: Open 13, +3, -2, +1 long gun — 15. He rolls **8 and 5** — 13. A miss by 2, automatic weapon, target in the Open: near miss, Shaken (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)). Grant is already Shaken. He is now **Pinned** (**Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40)) — 1 AP in hand, bleeding, hugging the wall of a room he half owns.

Deacon (7 AP) comes through next, 2 AP. The survivor is Deep and out of held AP: no entry fire. Deacon takes the Aimed Shot, 4 AP — his Shoot 8/10 gives Open 8, -2 Point Blank, +1 for his carbine in the Zone: TN 7. He rolls **5 and 3** — 8. Hit. Casualty Die: 6 + 3 - 0 = 9. **Dead.** The kitchen is clear. The bill: Grant Pinned and bleeding, Haddad's next

activation spent on Buddy Aid instead of the front room, and the whole crew a turn behind.

Run two — flashbang first. Rewind. This time the door belongs to Haddad (8 AP), because her whole job fits one activation. She steps to the frame, 1 AP, and opens the door, 1 AP, staying flat against the wall, out of the line through the opening — the Posted Corpsman has nothing to react to. Then the flashbang goes through the open Portal from her adjacent square: 3 AP, no scatter, no roll — it is in (**Grenades Into Zones** (p. 33)). Every figure in the kitchen is **Shaken**, and the entry order reverses.

Grant enters, 2 AP. Shaken defenders cannot react; the entering figure fires first. Unhurt, with 6 AP, he takes the Aimed Shot: Open 11, -3 Point Blank, +1 long gun — TN 9. He rolls **6 and 4 — 10**. Hit.

Casualty Die: $4 + 3 + 1$ Spread = 8. **Dead**. He ends his activation Posted at the interior door, 2 AP in hand: the front room shows empty through the opening.

Deacon follows, 2 AP, and puts an Aimed Shot on the Deep Corpsman before the stun wears through: TN 8, -2, +1 long gun — 7. He rolls **4 and 3 — 7**. Hit, exactly. Casualty Die: $2 + 3 = 5$. **Down** — alive. Next turn Grant will restrain him (his card's Interact; prisoners are worth more than bodies to the campaign). House clear.

Same kitchen, twice. Run two spent one flashbang and finished with nobody bleeding, a prisoner, the medic's hands free, and a gun on the next Portal. Count the Noise honestly, though: run one was gunfire only, +3 at the cap; run two was +3 for the bang *plus* the gunfire cap's +3. The flashbang does not buy quiet. It buys the room. One more line in the ledger: with Deacon first through instead of Grant, Point Man fires first on a *clean* entry once per turn — the reversal without the bang, for one figure, if you can spare him to the door.

The room is yours; now settle accounts. **Wounds & Recovery** (p. 36) owns what the bullets did on the way to it, and **The Human Factor** (p. 42) owns whether your people are steady enough to do this twice in one night. And if the building never needed to hear you at all — that argument is **Fieldcraft** (p. 17)'s, and it is usually right.

WOUNDS & RECOVERY

Handout from the Tuesday aid class in the church basement, typed on the back of a hymn insert, Casey Pham's block capitals: BLOOD IS TIME. A leg wound is not a story about pain. It is a story about minutes, and the minutes belong to whoever counts them first. You will want to shoot back. Wrong order. Somebody makes the shooter flinch. Somebody gets low. Somebody gets the bag open. Then you shoot back. Beneath it, ballpoint, added later in a different mood: Nobody is coming to fly your neighbor out of here. Whoever you carry in, you carry out. Practice the carry.

This chapter owns everything downstream of the attack roll: what a miss can still do, what a hit does to each kind of target, how your people bleed, how they are treated, carried, and lost, and what suppression — Shaken and Pinned — does to anyone on either side. The attack itself, from declaration to dice, belongs to **The Attack Procedure** (p. 23); morale, fear, and Rally belong to **The Human Factor** (p. 42); what wounds become between missions belongs to **The Long War** (p. 84). Everything in between is here.

RESOLVING A HIT

When an attack roll lands, resolve it in this order. The sequence is the same for every attack in the game — Aimed, Snap, Braced, Reaction Fire, a grenade's blast attack, the Warden's fire and yours.

- 1. Read the roll.** Total the 2d10, apply modifiers, and compare to the chosen TN (**The Attack Procedure** (p. 23)). Equal or higher is a hit — go to step 3. Lower is a miss — check step 2.
- 2. The near miss.** If the attack missed by 1 or 2, the weapon has the **Automatic** trait (**Weapon Traits** (p. 24)), and the target was in the open — the attack used the Open TN — the target is **Shaken** (**Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40)). Any other miss has no effect. This is the rule that makes automatic fire dangerous even when it is not accurate: a burst that cracks past your ear does its work on your nerve, not your body. It applies to every attack, including Reaction Fire, and to both sides.
- 3. Resolve the hit by target type.** What a hit is depends entirely on what it struck:

- **A Crew figure** — roll Hit Location, then Severity (**Crew Wounds** (p. 36), below).
- **An OPFOR figure** — one roll of the Casualty Die (**The Enemy's Ledger: the Casualty Die** (p. 40)).
- **A support unit** — a driver, porter, guide, or any other figure with a one-line stat, on either side — the Casualty Die at -1.
- **A vehicle** — the Vehicle Damage Die (**Vehicles** (p. 52)).
- **A drone** — drones do not roll damage; a hit downs them (**Drones & Electronic Warfare** (p. 59)).

A natural 20 on the attack roll rides through this whole procedure: the hit ignores Armor and, against a Crew figure, adds +3 to Severity (**Natural 20, Natural 2** (p. 6)); against an OPFOR figure it kills without a roll.

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-WOUND-PROCEDURE.SVG]

CREW WOUNDS

Your people do not have hit points. When one of them is hit, the game asks two questions the enemy never gets asked: *where*, and *how bad*. Answer them in order, with one d10 each.

Step 1 — Hit Location. Roll a d10:

TABLE: HIT LOCATION (CREW FIGURES) (d10)

D10	LOCATION	LOCATION EFFECT
1	Head	+2 Severity; helmet Armor 2 if worn
2	Weapon arm	on Light+: one-handed — long guns +3 TN
3	Off arm	on Light+: one-handed — long guns +3 TN
4-7	Torso	plates Armor 3 if worn
8-0	Legs	on Light+: no Sprint

Step 2 — Severity. Roll a d10, add the weapon's DR, and subtract the target's Armor at that location (**Armor Is Worn in Pieces** (p. 37)). A Head location adds +2 to the Severity total on top of everything else.

TABLE: WOUND SEVERITY (D10 + WEAPON DR - ARMOR AT LOCATION) (d10)

RESULT	WOUND	IMMEDIATE EFFECT
4 or less	Graze	Shaken
5-7	Light	Shaken; -2 max AP; Bleed 1; limb effects per location
8-10	Serious	Fall prone, Shaken; half AP; Bleed 2; Grit test each activation to act beyond Crawl/self-aid
11+	Critical	Down and Dying — bleed-out clock d6+2 turns; unconscious; second Critical = dead

Wounds stack — a second Light applies Serious effects; a second Serious applies Critical.

Step 3 — Apply the wound line immediately, together with the location effect. AP penalties bite at once, including AP the figure is still holding mid-activation — a wounded watcher may find its next reaction no longer affordable. A Light or worse wound to either arm puts the figure on one hand — long guns fire at +3 TN until the war is over or the mission is, whichever the recovery table decides (**The Long War** (p. 84)); a sidearm with the One-Handed trait does not care. A Light or worse leg wound forbids Sprinting. A Graze, at any location, is a flinch and a story: Shaken, nothing lasting.

Step 4 — Mark the wound on the roster sheet, by location and level. Wounds do not come off during a mission. Aid stops dying; it does not heal (**Buddy Aid** (p. 38)).

Note what a Serious wound actually does before you ever roll one: the figure falls prone where it stands, is Shaken, operates on half AP, bleeds at 2, and — this is the part players forget — must pass a Grit test at the start of each of its activations to do anything at all beyond Crawling or self-aid. A Serious casualty is not a weaker soldier. It is a neighbor on the ground, and the question of who goes and gets them is now the tactical problem.

ARMOR IS WORN IN PIECES

Crew armor is not a number for the whole body; it is equipment covering the part it covers. Rifle Plates print **Armor 3 (Torso only)**. A Ballistic Helmet prints **Armor 2 (Head only)**. Limbs are almost never armored, and the tables assume they are bare.

Subtract armor from the Severity roll only when the Hit Location is the location the armor covers.

Plates make a torso hit survivable more often than not; a helmet takes the edge off the Head location's +2 without removing the fear of it; a leg is a leg. A natural 20 on the attack ignores armor entirely (**Natural 20, Natural 2** (p. 6)).

OPFOR figures compress all of this into the single flat Armor value on their card, already built into the Casualty Die (**The Enemy's Ledger: the Casualty Die** (p. 40)).

WOUNDS STACK

Track every wound separately. A figure's **condition** — which effect line from the Severity table it currently suffers — is set by its worst wound, with one escalation: **a new wound at the same level as the figure's current condition worsens the condition one step**. A second Light puts the figure on the Serious line. A second Serious is Critical — Down and Dying. A second Critical is dead. A new wound *below* the current condition adds its location effect and nothing more; Grazes leave no lasting wound and never stack.

All location effects apply simultaneously — a one-armed figure that cannot Sprint is exactly as bad off as it sounds. Where two effects both change AP, halve first, then subtract flat penalties. The figure's Bleed rate is the rate printed on its current condition line, not the sum of its wounds (**Bleed** (p. 37)).

BLEED

Some wounds keep costing after the impact. A figure whose condition line prints a Bleed rating is **Bleeding**, at that rating.

In the **End Phase** of every turn — the first step of it (**The Turn Sequence** (p. 12)) — each Bleeding figure marks bleed points equal to its Bleed rating. Keep the marks beside the figure's card where you can see them, because the threshold is the whole rule: **at 3 accumulated marks, the wound worsens one step**. Apply the new condition line immediately and erase the marks; if the new line still prints a Bleed rating, the count starts again. A Serious wound that worsens becomes Critical: the figure goes Down and Dying right there in the End Phase, and you roll its bleed-out clock (**Down and Dying** (p. 39)).

Run the arithmetic once and you will never need reminding. Bleed 1 gives you three turns of grace. Bleed 2 gives you one full turn — the wound lands, the End Phase marks 2, and the next End Phase marks 2 more unless someone has reached the casualty and stopped it. Bleeding stops only through aid (**Buddy Aid** (p. 38)); when it stops, erase the accumulated marks. Down and Dying figures do not mark Bleed — their dying has its own clock, and it is faster.

BUDDY AID

Buddy Aid is the action that stops the arithmetic. A figure in a square adjacent to the casualty — or in the same Zone — spends 4 AP and makes a **Medicine test: 2d10 ≥ 11**. Aiding anyone other than yourself requires an Aid Bag: **Required for Buddy Aid beyond self-aid. 3 uses per mission**. Each attempt spends a use, success or failure — gauze does not go back in the wrapper.

On a success: the patient’s Bleed stops and its accumulated marks are erased, and the patient’s Shaken is removed. If the patient was Down and Dying, they are **stabilized** — the bleed-out clock stops (**Down and Dying** (p. 39)). **On a natural 20**, additionally downgrade the patient’s worst wound one step — a Serious becomes a Light, and the better line applies from now on. **On a natural 2**, the default complication applies (**Natural 20**, **Natural 2** (p. 6)): the medic is Shaken and the shouting is +1 Noise. On any other failure, nothing happens; you may try again if you can pay for it.

What aid is not: it is not healing. The wound, its AP penalties, its location effects, and its Grit gate all remain until the recovery tables between missions (**The Long War** (p. 84)). Aid converts *dying* into *wounded*. That is all, and it is everything.

Self-aid is the same action performed on yourself: same cost, same test, no Aid Bag required. A figure that is Down and Dying is unconscious and cannot self-aid — that casualty is now somebody else’s job. Self-aid is one of the actions a Serious figure may always take without passing its Grit gate, and one of the few things a Pinned figure may do at all (**Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40)).

Cards change this action. Medicine is a skill like any other, and the people who have it are on your roster, not in a rulebook. Casey Pham’s EMT background performs Buddy Aid at **3 AP against 2d10 ≥ 9**. Sana Haddad’s Combat Medic does it at 3 AP, can move 2 squares and still treat in one 4 AP action, and — her Under Fire skill — ignores the Shaken penalty while aiding, which is worth more than every other line on her card the night it matters. The Auxiliary Medic support unit aids at the standard cost and test. Read the card; the card wins.

CASEY PHAM

CALLSIGN	Doc
TIER	Skilled civilian
SHOOT	11/13
GRIT	10
AP	8
BIO	County paramedic. Has hauled more neighbors out of wrecks than the Authority ever will.

Margin note, Doc Pham’s hand: *The bag rides center of the stack — never on point, never trailing. If I go down, the bag is still in the middle of you. Count my uses out loud when you take one; three is a smaller number than it sounds. And learn the order: suppress, then move, then treat. A medic who runs to a casualty under an unbothered gun is the second casualty. The class where I make you say it back is the class that saves somebody.*

EXAMPLE

Blood and minutes. Turn 6 of a raid gone loud. Tanya Okafor is caught mid-yard when an ECA Rifleman takes an Aimed Shot at her — upright in Clear terrain, so against his Shoot of 11/13 he needs the Open number, 11. The Warden rolls **9 and 4** — 13. A hit, resolved by target type: she is Crew, so location and severity.

The wound. Hit Location d10: **9** — **Legs**. Severity: d10 = 6, plus the carbine's DR 3, minus armor at the location — legs are bare — total **9: Serious**. Apply the line at once. She falls prone where she stands. She is Shaken. Her 8 AP is halved to 4. She takes Bleed 2, and the leg adds its own tax: no Sprint. From now on she must pass Grit at the start of each activation to do anything beyond Crawling or self-aid.

End Phase, turn 6. Okafor marks her Bleed: 2 points accumulated. The arithmetic is public and merciless — at 3 marks the wound worsens a step, and Serious worsens to Critical. The next End Phase takes her there. Casey Pham has exactly one Crew Phase.

Turn 7. Pham activates first (8 AP), six squares away at the barn corner. She Sprints 3 squares into the yard (2 AP, +1 Noise — and she is a Sprinting target now). One square into the open, the Rifleman spends held AP on Reaction Fire (**Reaction Fire** (p. 14)) — Pham has been Known since she returned fire from the barn corner earlier in the fight, and the Warden reacts only to Known figures (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)): Open TN 11, +3 for Reaction Fire, +2 for a Sprinting target — TN 16. The Warden rolls **8 and 6** — 14. A miss by 2, from an Automatic weapon, against a target in the open: the near miss (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)) makes **Pham Shaken** — +2 TN on her tests from this instant, no Reaction Fire, and 4 AP owed against her next activation. She keeps going: 2 squares Walking (2 AP; 4 spent) puts her at Okafor's side. Her EMT skill makes Buddy Aid 3 AP against 2d10 ≥ 9 — but Shaken adds +2 TN, so tonight the number is 11. One use comes off her Aid Bag. She rolls **5 and 7** — 12. Success: Okafor's Bleed stops, the 2 marks are erased, and Okafor's Shaken is removed. The wound stays Serious — aid stops dying, not damage. (Double tens would have downgraded it to Light.) Pham spends her last AP going prone: 2+2+3+1 makes 8, and she holds nothing.

Okafor activates next. Start of activation, Serious: Grit test against her 10. She rolls **4 and 3** — 7. Failed — this activation is Crawl or self-aid only. She Crawls 2 squares, all 4 of her halved AP, into the ditch. That ends the second Crew activation of the

turn; the Interrupt Die needs a 10 and comes up 4 (**The Turn Sequence** (p. 12)). When the Warden Phase brings fire back across the yard it finds two prone shapes behind a ditch lip — Cover TN — and no hits.

End Phase, turn 7. Okafor is no longer Bleeding: no marks. Pham both activated and was shot at this turn, so her Shaken does not clear on its own (**Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40)). It rides into turn 8, where she activates with 8 – 4 = 4 AP, crawls in beside her patient, and is finally rid of it when that activation ends.

Now count the bill for one Serious wound and the *good* outcome: a Green figure on half AP who must still be walked to the Exfil, the crew's only medic Shaken and a turn behind, one of three Aid Bag uses gone, +1 Noise on the ladder. Had Pham arrived one turn later, the End Phase would have put Okafor's marks at 4: Critical — Down and Dying, a d6+2 clock, and somebody carrying her out with both hands full.

DOWN AND DYING

A Critical wound — rolled, stacked into, or bled into — puts a figure **Down and Dying**. The figure falls prone, drops what it holds, and is unconscious: no activations, no AP, no tests, no facing. It is out of the fight. It is not dead.

Roll the bleed-out clock immediately: d6+2 turns. Set the count in the open beside the figure. It ticks down in the Warden Phase's clocks step each turn (**The Turn Sequence** (p. 12)). If it reaches zero without aid, the figure is dead.

Dying figures cry out. Any Crew figure that starts its activation within 6 squares of a Down and Dying figure tests Grit; on a failure it is Shaken. Each figure tests at most once per turn, no matter how many of its neighbors are dying around it. This is a Grit test like any other, with everything a natural 2 implies (**Nerve Under Fire** (p. 42)). The sound is the mechanism: a casualty does not just subtract one gun from your line — it degrades every gun that can hear it.

Stabilizing. A successful Buddy Aid on a Dying figure stops the clock (**Buddy Aid** (p. 38)). A Trauma Kit is the blunt instrument: **One use - automatically stabilize one Dying figure (no test).** Pham's Triage skill can pause a clock from across the yard while she works her way over. A stabilized figure is still Down — unconscious, prone, out of the fight for the mission — but it has

stopped dying and stopped crying, and it will keep until you can move it. If a Down and Dying figure is hit again, resolve the hit normally; a second Critical result kills outright.

Dead is dead. There is no roll, no timer, and no chapter later in this book that walks it back. What the death costs the campaign — and what leaving the body costs — is accounted in **The Long War** (p. 84).

CARRYING THE FALLEN

A Down figure moves only if somebody moves it. Lifting a casualty onto your shoulders is an Interact (**Action Points** (p. 13)); setting one down gently is free.

While carrying, a figure has **half its AP** (round up) and **both hands full**: it may Walk and Crawl only — no Sprinting, no climbing, no attacks, no Reaction Fire, no Interacting with anything but the casualty. Marcus Boone’s Strong Back skill carries without the half-AP penalty, which is why the biggest man in the crew is not automatically the machine gunner. A Dying casualty’s clock keeps ticking on your back — stabilize first, or you are hauling a timer.

There is no CASEVAC. No helicopter, no ambulance exchange point, no rear. A Down crew member is either carried to the Exfil point before the mission ends, or they are lost — captured or dead, resolved with everything else you left behind (**Running Missions** (p. 81)).

DESIGNER'S NOTE

The carry rule is the campaign’s conscience, and it is deliberately expensive. Half AP with empty hands is the cost of the promise painted on the water tower — *we bring everyone home* — and the missions where you pay it are the missions this game is about. If losing a figure only cost you a card, retreat would be an accounting decision. Because someone must sling the body and someone else must cover the two of them across every open yard between here and the Exfil, retreat is a plan, made under fire, by people who are tired. That is the war this book is trying to put on your table.

THE ENEMY’S LEDGER: THE CASUALTY DIE

A hit on an OPFOR figure resolves with one roll and no bookkeeping: **d10 + the weapon’s DR – the**

target’s Armor, read off the table. Apply the result immediately.

TABLE: OPFOR CASUALTY DIE (D10 + WEAPON DR - ARMOR) (d10)

RESULT	EFFECT
3 or less	Staggered — Shaken; if already Shaken, Pinned
4-6	Down — out of the fight; may be stabilized for capture
7+	Dead

Natural 20 on the attack — Dead, no roll. Support units (drivers, porters) roll at -1.

Staggered uses the same suppression rules as everyone else (**Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40)): the figure is Shaken, and if it was already Shaken it is Pinned. **Down** figures are out of the fight — dying or incapacitated, the fiction’s choice — and they matter after the shooting: they can be looted, and they can be stabilized and taken as prisoners, with everything a prisoner is worth and costs (**Running Missions** (p. 81)). **Dead** is removed from the board. A natural 20 on the attack roll is Dead with no roll at all.

Support units — drivers, porters, guides, and any other figure with a one-line stat, on either side of the fight — resolve on the same table at -1 on the die. They are not soldiers, and the table knows it.

What a falling figure does to the survivors around it — yours and the Warden’s — is morale’s business, not this table’s (**Nerve Under Fire** (p. 42)).

DESIGNER'S NOTE

One die for their people, two tables and a bleed track for yours: the asymmetry is the point, and it is load-bearing. Detail is the game’s way of saying *this one has a name*. The Warden’s figures exist for thirty violent seconds, so a single roll answering “is it still shooting?” is all the fidelity the fight needs — and it keeps your solo turn fast on exactly the side of the table you care least about. Your people persist across a campaign, so their wounds get locations, rates, and consequences that follow them home. When the same rifle round is a d10 lookup for them and a femur for you, the rules are telling you whose story this is.

SHAKEN & PINNED

Suppression arrives from everywhere in this book — near misses (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)), wounds, failed Grit tests (**Nerve Under Fire** (p. 42)), blasts and flashbangs, the Beaten Zone (**Crew-Served Weapons** (p. 46)). Wherever it came from, the condition itself is owned here, and it works the

same for every figure in the game, yours and the Warden's.

Shaken. A Shaken figure:

- **loses 4 AP at its next activation** (to a minimum of 2);
- **takes +2 TN on its tests** — every 2d10 test it makes: attacks (this is the “Shooter is Shaken” line of the modifier list, not a second penalty on top of it), Grit, Medicine, Handling, all of it;
- **cannot take Reaction Fire.**

A figure Shaken during its own activation feels the TN penalty and the reaction ban immediately; the AP loss falls on the next activation it begins while still Shaken.

Shaken ends in exactly three ways:

1. **Automatically, at the end of the figure's next activation.** You pay the shortened, degraded activation, and come out the far side clean.
2. **By Rally** (Rally (p. 43)).
3. **In the End Phase, if the figure did not activate this turn and was not the target of any attack** — hit or missed. Left alone, people collect themselves.

Pinned. A figure that becomes Shaken *while already Shaken* — by any source, including the Casualty Die's Staggered result — is **Pinned**. A Pinned figure may only Crawl, hug its cover where it is, or self-aid (**Buddy Aid** (p. 38)). To attempt anything else, it must first pass a Grit test at +2 — one test at the start of its activation; on a failure, Crawl, cover, or self-aid is all that activation holds. A Pinned figure still cannot take Reaction Fire, and its tests still carry the +2 TN.

Pinned recovers to **Shaken**, never straight to clean, in either of two ways: a Rally, or a full turn in which the figure is not shot at — clear it to Shaken in the End Phase. There is nothing below Pinned; further suppression on a Pinned figure changes nothing, which is its own small mercy.

One dose of Field Stims will carry a figure through the worst of this — **One use - clear Shaken from self immediately, or act normally while Serious for one activation (then Bleed +1).** — and the crew members who insist on packing them are usually the ones who have needed them.

TABLE: STATUS EFFECTS AT A GLANCE

STATE	EFFECTS	GETS WORSE	RECOVERS
Shaken	-4 AP at next activation (min 2); +2 TN on own tests; no Reaction Fire	Shaken again -> Pinned	End of own next activation; Rally; or End Phase if not activated and not shot at
Pinned	Only Crawl, hug cover, or self-aid; anything else needs Grit at +2 (one test, start of activation)	-	Rally (to Shaken); or End Phase if not shot at (to Shaken)
Down and Dying	Unconscious; bleed-out clock d6+2 turns; cries force Grit tests within 6 squares	Clock expires -> dead; second Critical -> dead	Stabilized by Aid (stays Down, must be carried)

The Warden's figures use the same states; its Down figures are simply out of the fight.

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-SHAKEN-PINNED.SVG]

Read the two states as what they are: the game's model of fire that works without hitting. A rifle that makes three figures Shaken has taken six or more AP and three reacting guns off the board — often a better trade than a wound. The Warden knows this arithmetic cold, and its machine guns are built on it (**Crew-Served Weapons** (p. 46)). Learn to spend suppression the way you spend ammunition, and learn what it means when it is being spent on you: someone intends to move while you flinch.

That is the whole cost of being hit: location, severity, blood, and nerve. What it does to the mind — fear, morale, panic, leadership, and the Rally that answers them — is the next chapter's subject (**The Human Factor** (p. 42)). What it does to the roster — recovery tables, permanent injuries, and the memorial page — waits in **The Long War** (p. 84). Between those two lies the discipline this chapter teaches by arithmetic: keep the bag close, count the marks out loud, and never plan a mission whose exfil route you could not walk at half AP.

THE HUMAN FACTOR

Ask anyone who was at the low bridge what they remember and they will not say the shooting. They will say Amos Vance’s voice. Boone’s gun had gone quiet, two of ours were face-down in the ditch grass, and the line was coming apart one heartbeat at a time. Vance came up the ditch bent double, a hand on each shoulder, a name in every ear, that graveside voice saying you are not done yet, get your rifle up. The man is wrong about plenty. He was not wrong about us. We got up. We got everybody home.

Bullets decide less than this chapter does. What Shaken and Pinned do to a figure — the lost AP, the flinch, the reactions that never come — is defined with the rest of the damage rules in **Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40). This chapter owns everything around that state: when your people’s nerve is tested (**Nerve Under Fire** (p. 42)), how a voice restores it (**Rally** (p. 43)), when the Warden’s people break and run (**Breaking the Warden’s People** (p. 44), **Rout** (p. 44)), and what you owe an enemy who is done fighting (**Surrender & Prisoners** (p. 44)). Fear in the REACH system is not a special subsystem. It is the same 2d10 against a printed number — the number is just written on a person instead of a rifle.

NERVE UNDER FIRE

A morale test is a Grit test: 2d10, unmodified unless a rule says otherwise, against the figure’s own printed Grit (**The Test** (p. 5)). Testing costs no AP and resolves immediately, mid-activation or mid-phase, the moment its trigger occurs. A Crew figure tests at exactly these four moments, and no others:

TABLE: CREW MORALE - WHEN GRIT IS TESTED

TRIGGER	TIMING	ON FAILURE
First time under effective fire (per figure, per mission)	when the attack resolves	Shaken
A Crew figure goes Down or Dead within 6 squares or in LOS	immediately	Shaken
Surprise Point Blank contact (a Blip resolves adjacent)	before either side acts	Shaken
A Dying figure’s cries, within 6 squares	start of your activation, once per turn	Shaken

Natural 2 on any of these - Panic: Sprint (no AP, +1 Noise, counts as Sprinting) to the nearest cover away from the enemy, then Pinned.

- **First blood.** The first time each mission that this figure comes under effective fire — an enemy attack roll is resolved against it, or a blast, template, or near miss touches its square. One baptism per figure per mission; after it, incoming fire is business.
- **A neighbor falls.** A Crew figure goes Down or Dead within 6 squares of this figure, or within its LOS. Every figure that qualifies tests, at once.
- **Surprise at Point Blank.** An enemy the figure did not know was there appears at Point Blank — adjacent, or in its Zone: a Blip resolving in its face (**Blips** (p. 18)), a door opening onto rifles.
- **The cries of the Dying.** A Dying figure is close enough to hear. This trigger’s rule — its radius, its timing, its once-per-turn limit — is printed with the bleed-out clock in **Bleed** (p. 37); test as it directs.

Failure: the figure is Shaken. A figure that is already Shaken when it fails is Pinned (**Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40)). Resolve the shot before the test — so a near miss that Shakes a green shooter, followed by a failed baptism test, leaves that shooter Pinned before they have fired a round.

Natural 2: Panic. The figure immediately Sprints — no AP, out of any turn order — to the nearest Cover or Concealment square that takes it away from the nearest revealed enemy; if no such square is in Sprint reach, it Sprints directly away. The flight is not an activation, but it is a Sprint in every other respect: it makes Sprint Noise (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)) and the figure counts as a Sprinting target until its next activation ends. Then it is Pinned where it stops.

A natural 20 simply holds. There is no prize for being brave; there is only still being in the fight.

Each event triggers one test per affected figure. Passing a test never immunizes anyone against the next one — courage in this game is not a save, it is a habit.

Margin note, Vance's hand, flyleaf of the parish register: *Fear is information, not a verdict. It says: this is real, and you are still here to know it. The ones who worry me aren't the ones who go down behind the wall and shake. It's the ones who never do. Those men have stopped receiving information.*

RALLY

Rally is the answer to most of what this chapter can do to you. It costs 2 AP (**Action Points** (p. 13)) and is available only to a figure with the **Leader** trait or a printed Grit of 9 or less — the professionals, and the people the valley already listens to.

When a figure Rallies, every Shaken or Pinned Crew figure within 3 squares — the Rallying figure itself included — immediately rolls 2d10 against its *own* printed Grit, one roll per figure. These rolls are unmodified: they are not the affected figure's action, so Shaken's TN penalty does not apply. On a success, a Shaken figure clears entirely; a Pinned figure drops to Shaken (**Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40)) — nobody comes all the way back from the bottom on one word. (Almost nobody: cards can say otherwise, and Amos Vance's Shepherd skill, below, is the standing exception.) On a failure, nothing changes, and nothing prevents another Rally later in the turn, from the same voice or a different one.

A Shaken figure may Rally others. A Pinned one must first pass its Grit at +2 like any other action beyond survival (**Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40)) — panic is not led out of a ditch by someone still in it.

Radios widen the circle. The Handheld Net's card reads: Crew figures with radios may Rally each other at radius 6 instead of 3. Both ends of the call need a set — a figure without one must still be within the 3 squares of an actual voice. And the net is only yours while the spectrum is (**Drones & Electronic Warfare** (p. 59)).

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-RALLY-RADIUS.SVG]

AMOS VANCE

CALLSIGN	Pastor
TIER	Green
SHOOT	13/15
GRIT	9
AP	8
BIO	Buried the valley's dead for thirty years. Refuses to bury it whole.

EXAMPLE

The lot at the substation, turn 5. Marcus Boone is repositioning his MMG along the fence line when an ECA Marksman fires in the Warden Phase and hits. Hit Location d10: 5 — Torso, and Boone wears no plates. Severity: d10 comes up 8, plus the rifle's DR 3, minus armor 0 — 11. Critical: Boone is Down and Dying, bleed-out clock d6+2, the d6 lands 3 — five turns (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)).

A Crew figure just went Down, so everyone within 6 squares or LOS tests Grit now. Tanya Okafor, two squares away behind the truck, is already Shaken — a burst walked past her in the open earlier this turn, a near miss (**The Attack Procedure** (p. 23)). She needs her Grit of 10 and rolls 4 and 3 — 7. Failed. Shaken while Shaken: **Pinned**. Birdy Sizemore, four squares off in the ditch, needs her 11 and rolls 6 and 4 — 10. Failed by one: **Shaken**. Amos Vance, five squares back with LOS, needs his 9 and rolls 6 and 5 — 11. He holds.

Turn 6, Crew Phase. Vance activates first. Boone is Dying within 6 squares of him, so the cries rule bites at the start of his activation (**Bleed** (p. 37)): 9 and 4 — 13 against his 9. He holds again. He has 8 AP: he Walks 2 squares to the truck (2 AP), putting Okafor at 2 squares and Birdy at 3, and Rallies (2 AP) — legal for him twice over, by his Shepherd skill and by his Grit.

Each affected figure rolls against her own Grit. Okafor, Pinned: 8 and 4 — 12 against her 10. Success — and where a base Rally would only step her down to Shaken, Vance's Shepherd skill clears the state entirely: Okafor comes all the way back, whole. Birdy: 5 and 5 — 10 against her 11. Failure — she stays Shaken, face down in the ditch.

Vance keeps his last 4 AP watching. The right play now writes itself: leave Birdy unactivated — if nobody shoots at her, the End Phase clears her for free (**Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40)) — and spend Okafor's restored turn getting to Boone, because his clock does not care how anyone feels.

BREAKING THE WARDEN’S PEOPLE

The Warden’s figures do not take morale tests shot by shot — being Staggered off the Casualty Die is that story (**The Enemy’s Ledger: the Casualty Die** (p. 40)). What the Warden tests is the *group*, at the two moments that break real units:

- an element has lost **half its starting figures** (Down and Dead both count as lost), or
- the element’s **Leader** is killed.

When either occurs, each surviving figure of that element tests Grit once — 2d10 against its printed Grit. Card specials are the last word here and modify the Grit TN before rolling; read them. The two ends of the scale:

SRT OPERATOR	
FACTION	authority
SHOOT	9/11
GRIT	8
ARMOR	2
DOCTRINE	Assault
WEAPON	carbine
SPECIAL	Elite - group morale at -2. Enters Zones with flashbangs (defenders do not fire first).
ELEMENT	team of 4, QRF/ALARM asset

MARAUDER	
FACTION	marauder
SHOOT	13/15
GRIT	12
ARMOR	0
DOCTRINE	Assault
WEAPON	shotgun
SPECIAL	Group morale at +2 (breaks easily). Frenzied - Sprints toward Known at every Directive.
ELEMENT	packs of 5-8

Some cards go further — an element that ignores its first failure each mission, a pack whose whole spine is one man, hired guns whose card routs them without a test. The card overrides this section wherever it speaks.

Every figure that fails falls back one Doctrine step along the ladder:

Assault → Base-of-Fire → Holding → Rout

A figure whose current Doctrine is not on the ladder — Sweep, Cordon, QRF — falls back to Holding: it stops maneuvering and goes firm where it stands. A figure that fails while Holding

Routs. Figures that pass keep the Doctrine they had, so a mauled element can split — each figure follows its own step, run by its script as normal (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)), and the Good-Faith Clause governs any seam between them (**The Good-Faith Clause** (p. 4)).

Each trigger is tested once, when it occurs — and both can occur to the same element in one bad minute. There is no Rally on the Warden’s side of the table: a step lost is lost for the mission. This is why the target-priority conversation in your crew keeps ending on the same word: *leaders*.



TABLE: OPFOR GROUP MORALE

STEP	RULE
Trigger	An element has lost half its figures (Down and Dead together), or its Leader is killed
Test	Each survivor rolls 2d10 vs its Grit, once (marauders +2, SRT -2, faction specials apply)
Failure	Falls back one Doctrine step: Assault -> Base-of-Fire -> Holding -> Rout. Sweep/Cordon/QRF fall back to Holding
Rout	Sprint toward the nearest board edge away from the Crew each activation; no shooting or reacting; removed on exit
No rallying	The Warden has no Rally - a step lost is lost for the mission

ROUT

A Routing figure is done fighting. On each of its activations it ignores its scripts, its Directives, and its friends, and Sprints its full move toward the nearest board edge that takes it away from Crew figures. It does not shoot, does not react, and counts as a Sprinting target. When it exits the board, remove it. Whether you spend rounds on a running man’s back is between you and your ammunition — the shot is Noise like any other, and the man was already gone.

SURRENDER & PRISONERS

An enemy in the middle band of the Casualty Die is Down — dying or senseless where he fell (**The Enemy’s Ledger: the Casualty Die** (p. 40)). The Warden does not track his bleeding: left where he lies, he is out of the fight and, when the mission ends, out of the story. Taking him alive instead is work, and it comes in two parts:

- **Stabilize.** Buddy Aid, exactly as for your own people (**Wounds & Recovery** (p. 36)) — same AP, same test, and it spends the same scarce Aid Bag uses. Triage is a policy decision your medic makes with your supplies.
- **Restrain.** An Interact taking 4 AP, adjacent to a Down or surrendered enemy: ties, a search, a moment eye to eye. Skills can shorten the job — restraint used to be Hollis Grant's profession:

HOLLIS GRANT

TIER	Skilled civilian
SHOOT	11/13
GRIT	10
AP	8
BIO	Was the law here when the law was local. Some habits keep.

Surrender. A Routing figure that begins an activation adjacent to a Crew figure, or that is cornered — no legal move that takes it farther from the Crew — drops its weapon and quits. Treat it as Down for capture purposes: no stabilizing needed, restraint still required.

Moving a prisoner. A restrained prisoner moves with one escorting Crew figure: while the escort is adjacent, the prisoner Walks along with the escort's own movement at no extra cost. Prisoners never Sprint. A prisoner at the Exfil when your Crew leaves exits with them (**Running Missions** (p. 81)); one left on the board is lost, and the valley keeps score on people you abandon (**The Long War** (p. 84)).

What he is worth. Scenarios name prisoners as objectives outright, and the campaign prices the rest: a prisoner is intelligence, leverage, a trade — and a mouth, a witness, and a decision you will have to live with. The Long War's dilemma rules make sure of that (**The Long War** (p. 84)).

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Play a few missions and count how enemies actually leave the board. Some die. More are Staggered into uselessness, fail a group test over a dead sergeant, fall back a step, fall back again, and run. That is the point. Small-unit fights are decided by fire that makes the other side stop *acting* long before it makes them stop living — suppression is the weapon; bullets are mostly its delivery system. Mechanically, morale is also the only lever that scales: you are eight people in a valley of hundreds, and you cannot shoot the Authority to zero. You can make its people quit tonight. The Rout and prisoner rules exist so that winning that way leaves something on the table — ground, gear, and human beings — instead of a body count.

Nerve is the currency every later chapter spends. The machine gun you are about to meet in **Crew-Served Weapons** (p. 46) is the game's great engine of Shaken — a weapon whose entire doctrine is this chapter, delivered at 600 rounds a minute — and when you reach the Warden's scripts in **The Enemy System** (p. 66), you will find the fallback ladder is where their logic bottoms out. The Authority counts rifles. You have just read the chapter about what it keeps failing to count.

CREW-SERVED WEAPONS

Boone ran the gun class at the quarry, and the first thing he did was make everyone carry it. Up the spoil bank and down again — gun, tripod, spare barrel, and the belts — until the arithmetic lived in their shoulders. Then he set it up and let each of them fire a burst, watched them fall in love, and took the gun away. The steel is the cheap part, he said. Steel doesn't tire and steel doesn't bleed. What they'll try to kill is everything around the steel — the one feeding it, the one hauling for it, the two minutes it takes to move it. They can make more guns. They can't make more of you.

This chapter owns the weapons that fight as a team's job rather than one figure's action: the machine guns, Sustained Fire and the Beaten Zone, and the Warden's mortars. Nothing upstream changes — a shot from a machine gun still runs the attack procedure (**The Attack Procedure** (p. 23)), its hits still resolve by target type (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36), **The Enemy's Ledger: the Casualty Die** (p. 40)), and Shaken still means exactly what **Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40) says. What this chapter adds is the team, the specialist actions **Action Points** (p. 13) promised, and one genuinely new idea: an attack made against ground instead of a silhouette. Vehicle mounts are resolved where vehicles live (**Vehicles** (p. 52)); the scripts the Warden runs its gun teams on live with its Doctrines (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)).

THE GUN TEAM

MEDIUM MACHINE GUN	
CLASS	crew-served
DR	4
PEN	2
EFF	30
Sustained Fire and Beaten Zone rules (ch. 9). Team of Gunner + AG (+ Bearer).	

The Medium Machine Gun is served by three jobs. The jobs are positions, not names: any Crew figure or support unit standing in one is doing it, and the rules read the position, never the roster.

- **The Gunner** carries the piece, deploys it, and fires it. Whoever is behind a deployed gun is its

Gunner.

- **The Assistant Gunner (AG)** occupies the feed-side square adjacent to the gun. The AG feeds the belt, watches the fall of shot, and halves nearly every cost the gun has — deploying the tripod, reloading, packing up. A figure serves as AG only while it can act: a Down or Pinned figure serves nothing. A Shaken AG can still push a belt — it feeds, but it does not spot (**Sustained Fire** (p. 47)).
- **The Ammo Bearer** is optional, and is wherever the spare belts are: any figure carrying extra ammunition for the gun. An Auxiliary Porter serving as Bearer carries two belts, per its card.

Kill the figure and the job dies, not the gun. Lose the **Gunner** and the weapon lies where it fell — any figure adjacent may take it over with an **Interact** (2 AP) and become its Gunner. Lose the **AG** and Sustained Fire stops — no feed, no Beaten Zone — reloads slow to a crawl, and packing up takes twice as long, until another figure moves into the feed square and takes the job. Lose the **Bearer** and the ammunition clock starts: the belts on the body stay on the body until someone recovers them (**Interact**, 2 AP, adjacent).

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-CSW-ROLES.SVG]

Margin note, Boone's hand: *The Corps builds a gun team backward from how the movies do. The junior man shoots. The senior man lies beside him — bins on the beaten zone, hand riding the belt, calling every correction — and the barrel change, the rate, the next position are all his. Trigger work is the easiest thing we teach. Keeping a gun fed, cool, laid on ground that matters, and alive is the whole trade. So when you are on the wrong end of one: don't shoot the man shooting. Shoot the one beside him who looks like he's doing nothing. He is not doing nothing.*

THE CREW-SERVED TRAITS

Four traits mark these weapons. They are named in the trait glossary (**Weapon Traits** (p. 24)) and defined here.

Crew-Served. The weapon fires only while deployed (**Into Action, Out of Action** (p. 47)) — never from the shoulder or the hip, not even a Snap Shot. Its Reload costs 3 AP, not 2 (**Action Points** (p. 13)). Off its mount it is a load, not a weapon: a figure carrying a packed gun has both hands full and moves at half AP, exactly like carrying a casualty (**Wounds & Recovery** (p. 36)). Boone's Strong Back ignores that penalty, which is half the reason he is Gun One. Inside a Zone, a crew-served weapon fires at the long-gun penalty (**Fighting Inside a Zone** (p. 31)), and Sustained Fire is impossible into, out of, or within a Zone — with one exception: a gun deployed Posted at a Portal may lay its Beaten Zone on the grid outside. The classic gun in a window.

Sustained. The weapon may take the Sustained Fire action (**Sustained Fire** (p. 47)). It also makes normal Aimed and Snap Shots while deployed, on the Gunner's Shoot line at the weapon's DR, and it is Automatic, with everything the near miss implies (**The Attack Procedure** (p. 23)). A deployed gun holding AP takes Reaction Fire like any figure (**Reaction Fire** (p. 14)); there is no better Overwatch in the game.

Mounted. The weapon fires from a tripod or a vehicle mount only — never a bipod, never arms. A vehicle mount counts as deployed; fighting from vehicles belongs to **Vehicles** (p. 52).

Indirect. The weapon uses neither the attack procedure nor its own LOS. It fires by the indirect procedure — a spotter and a walked-in round — defined at **The Warden's Mortars** (p. 50).

INTO ACTION, OUT OF ACTION

Deploying. Setting the gun on its bipod costs 2 AP and puts the Gunner prone behind it — low, stable, in Cover at any distance a prone figure earns it (**Open or In Cover** (p. 9)), and seeing nothing over a wall. Setting up the tripod costs 4 AP with an AG assisting, 6 AP without. The tripod raises the gun: the Gunner fights from behind low cover rather than under it, firing over what a prone gun cannot see, and it is the only ground mount a Mounted weapon accepts. A deployed gun fires. An undeployed gun is freight.

Displacing. Packing the gun to move costs 4 AP — 2 with an AG. This is the vulnerability window, and it is doctrinal and real: **from the moment**

packing begins until the gun is next deployed, the Gunner and AG count as Open against every attack, whatever the terrain says, and may not take Reaction Fire. Then the gun travels as a load until somebody pays to put it back into action. Every machine gunner since the trenches has known this arithmetic — the team is never more killable than in the minute it stops being a gun team and becomes people carrying furniture. Plan a displacement like a withdrawal, because it is one: smoke, a covering rifle, and the next position chosen before the first goes quiet.

SUSTAINED FIRE

Sustained Fire is the reason the team exists. It costs 4 AP and requires all three: the gun **deployed**, a belt with actions left on it (**Belts, Reloads & Jams** (p. 48)), and an **AG feeding**. No AG, no Sustained Fire — a lone gunner owns a heavy automatic rifle and nothing more.

1. Lay the template. Place the Beaten Zone template — 2 squares wide, 4 long — with its long axis along the line of fire and its nearest edge at the target square. Every square of it must be in the Gunner's LOS and within the gun's Effective Range (30 squares for the MMG).

2. Make one attack roll: 2d10 against a flat TN of 11. Not the Gunner's Shoot line — the Sustained TN printed on the Beaten Zone table (**The Beaten Zone** (p. 48)). There is no Cover TN and never will be: the Beaten Zone ignores low cover along its axis, because grazing fire owns the hand's width of air above every wall's lip. Take **-1 TN if the AG is spotting** — it has LOS to the template and is not Shaken. Boone's Machine Gunner skill fires Sustained at a base of 10 instead. Modifier lines that describe the gun and its crew apply as usual — a Shaken Gunner's +2, obscuring smoke or darkness, an elevated position's -1; lines that describe a single target (Sprinting, Point Blank) never apply, because the Beaten Zone has no single target. A natural 2 jams the gun, cleared by Reload; a natural 20 resolves every hit in the template as a catastrophic hit (**The Attack Procedure** (p. 23)).

3. Resolve every figure in the template. On a success, **every figure in the Beaten Zone takes a hit at DR 4** — a Casualty Die for the Warden's people, Hit Location and Severity for yours, rolled

per figure. **Success or failure, every figure in the Beaten Zone is Shaken unless prone.** Even the burst that kills nobody rewrites the next thirty seconds.

Sustained Fire is gunfire for Noise purposes, under the gunfire cap (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)).

MARCUS BOONE

CALLSIGN

Gun One

TIER

Service vet

SHOOT

10/12

GRIT

10

AP

8

BIO

Marine 0331. His gun is the crew's argument of last resort.

THE BEATEN ZONE

TABLE: BEATEN ZONE (SUSTAINED FIRE)

PROPERTY	RULE
Template	2 x 4 squares, long axis along the line of fire, nearest edge at the target square, fully in LOS
Attack	one roll at TN 11 (no Cover TN — the BZ ignores low cover along its axis)
On success	every figure in the BZ takes a hit at DR 4
Success or fail	every figure in the BZ is Shaken unless prone
Persistence	BZ marker stays until the gun moves, reloads, or shifts fire
Crossing	double AP per square inside; one immediate attack at TN 13 per square entered
Belt	3 Sustained Fire actions, then Reload (3 AP with AG; 5 AP without, jam on natural 4 or less)

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-BEATEN-ZONE.SVG]

The template persists. When the action ends, the marker stays: the gun is laid, locked, and firing interval bursts across that ground. Remove it when the gun moves or packs up, Reloads, fires at anything outside the template, loses its AG, or when its Gunner leaves the trigger — Down, Pinned, dead, or stepped away. Shaken alone does not lift it; flinching men keep firing. While the marker stands, the same Gunner may Sustain again on the same lay — a fresh 4 AP, a fresh belt action, a fresh roll, the full effect repeated.

Crossing an active Beaten Zone. Every square of the template costs **double AP to enter**, and **each square entered draws one immediate attack** at a

flat TN of 13 — no Cover TN, no modifiers, resolved the instant the figure enters, per square, every figure, either side. A hit is a hit at DR 4, wound procedure or Casualty Die as ever. Crawling doubles from 2 to 4 AP per square and the attacks come anyway; prone spares your nerve — the Shaken clause — not your body. Leaving the zone works the same way: every template square entered on the way out is paid for and shot at.

The rule is symmetric, and mostly it will be pointed at you. The Warden's MG teams run everything in this chapter — its Base-of-Fire Doctrine is built on this action (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)) — and its ECA gun team is a pair with no Bearer: kill its AG and it loses the Beaten Zone, exactly as its card says. Treat an active enemy zone as terrain, because that is what it now is: ground with a price printed on it.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

The Sustained roll ignores the Gunner's marksmanship on purpose. A laid, traversing gun is not "aiming" in any sense your rifle understands — the beaten zone is a property of the tripod, the traverse, and the man calling corrections, which is why skill enters the number as the AG's -1 and Boone's trade, not a Shoot line. It has no Cover column for the same reason: grazing fire is geometry, not accuracy, and a low wall's lip sits inside the band the rounds own. The crossing tax is tuned so that four upright squares through an active zone are odds-on to end in at least a Serious wound or a Down. The zone is not meant to be crossed. It is meant to be answered — kill the team, or go around.

BELTS, RELOADS & JAMS

A belt feeds 3 **Sustained Fire** actions; normal shots off the gun are rounding error and cost the belt nothing. When the third is spent the gun is dry: **Reload — 3 AP with an AG, 5 AP without one.** A gun reloaded without an AG feeds dirty: until its next Reload with an AG assisting, every attack roll it makes jams on a natural total of 4 or less, not just the natural 2. Boone's Machine Gunner reloads at 2 AP with an AG.

The team carries its war on its backs: one belt on the gun, one spare on the AG, two more on the Bearer — four belts, twelve bursts, a full mission's argument. Track the belts with a d6 standing beside the gun: the ammo die. Field the gun

without a Bearer and you start two belts poorer; lose a carrier mid-fight and their belts wait on the body for an Interact (2 AP, adjacent) to bring them back into the fight. What belts cost the campaign in Supply is accounted in **The Long War** (p. 84).

EXAMPLE

The toll at Herron's field. Turn six, and the OPFOR is Alerted. Marcus Boone — Gun One, 8 AP — has the MMG on its tripod on the mill-race embankment, laid across the harvest field at the fence gap every approach funnels through. An Auxiliary Porter, Odell, who humped the belts up the bank, lies in the feed square: able to act, so he is the AG. A Civil Order squad — five Corpsmen and their Boss; Corpsmen Shoot 13/15, Armor 0 — is working up the fence line toward the mill.

Boone activates. The gun is deployed and Odell is feeding: Sustained Fire is legal, 4 AP. He lays the template on the gap — 2 wide, 4 long, nearest edge on the gap square, all eight squares in LOS and inside 30. Three Corpsmen are inside it, two upright, one prone. The roll: the flat TN is 11, Boone's Machine Gunner makes it 10, and Odell — feed square, LOS to the field, not Shaken — spots for -1: **TN 9.** Boone rolls **6 and 5 — 11. Success.** Every figure in the zone takes a hit at DR 4, one Casualty Die each: $7 + 4 - 0 = 11$, **Dead.** $2 + 4 - 0 = 6$, **Down.** $1 + 4 - 0 = 5$, **Down** — against an unarmored man the die cannot roll low enough to spare him; the floor of a machine-gun hit is Down. The Shaken-unless-prone clause has nobody left to frighten. Turn the ammo die: one of the belt's three actions spent. Boone ends his activation holding 4 AP — two Reaction Fires behind a laid gun — and the template stays on the table. Three of six figures Down or Dead in one burst trips the Corpsmen's Jumpy special and the half-strength trigger in the same instant: the survivors owe Grit tests, and one Corpsmen fails even on the Boss's Cruel reroll (**The Human Factor** (p. 42)).

Warden Phase. The Directive pushes the squad toward its Known enemy. The flank route around the template is a six-square detour; the shortest path cuts one corner square of the zone, and this turn the Warden judges the detour worse — it pays the toll. A Corpsmen steps into the template: the square costs double, 2 AP, and entering it draws the crossing attack — **flat TN 13**, no Cover, no modifiers. The Warden rolls **8 and 6 — 14. Hit.** Casualty Die: $3 + 4 - 0 = 7$, **Dead** on the wire. The last Corpsmen takes the detour. Then the Boss answers from the fence — the fire came from the gun team, and between its two figures the Good-Faith Clause picks the target the Crew can least afford: the AG. Boone's embankment makes it a Cover shot off the Boss's Shoot 12/14: TN 14. The Warden rolls **9 and 8 — 17. Hit.** Odell is a support unit — Casualty Die at -1: $6 - 1 + 3 - 0 = 8$. **Dead** in the feed square.

Count the field. Four of the Warden's figures Down or Dead for one porter — a trade the ground forced,

which is what a laid gun is *for*. But the moment Odell dies, the Beaten Zone marker comes off the table, and Gun One is broken as a system: no Sustained Fire, the next Reload at 5 AP and jamming on a natural 4 or less, the tripod and pack-up costs doubled — until somebody crawls into the feed square and takes the job. The Noise ledger closes at the gunfire cap: +3 (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)).

THE HEAVY MACHINE GUN

HEAVY MACHINE GUN

CLASS	crew-served
DR	5
PEN	3
EFF	40

Vehicle or tripod mount only. The technical's teeth.

The HMG is the same frame with bigger numbers — DR 5, Pen 3, 40 squares of Effective Range — and one hard restriction: it is **Mounted**. No bipod, no shoulder; it fights from a tripod dug in behind a berm, or from the ring mount of a technical. Every rule in this chapter applies unchanged, with the Beaten Zone's hits and crossing attacks resolved at the firing weapon's DR — 5 here. A vehicle mount counts as deployed, and a second crew member aboard may serve as AG; the gun may fire Sustained only while the vehicle is stationary, and everything else about shooting from, at, and out of vehicles — including what Pen 3 does to an armored hull — belongs to **Vehicles** (p. 52). When the Civil Order Corps' technical crests the ridge road, this is the gun on it, and the displacement window you practice with the MMG is the habit that keeps you alive under it.

THE WARDEN'S MORTARS

60MM MORTAR

CLASS	indirect
DR	5
PEN	2
EFF	60

Warden/scenario asset. Spotting-round walk-in procedure (ch. 9). Requires spotter with comms.

The 60mm mortar is a **scenario asset** — the **Warden's weapon, not yours**. When a mission

fields one, the sheet places the tube: on the board with a crew that can be killed, or off the table where only its rounds visit. Either way the tube is blind. It fires only through a **spotter**: an OPFOR figure with working comms — a radio, a vehicle set, a landline — and LOS to the target area, aiming at a **Known** Crew position, because the Warden never shoots what it does not Know (**Fieldcraft** (p. 17)).

While the link holds, the tube fires one round per Warden Phase, and the rounds walk:

- Spotting round.** The aim square is a Known position. The round scatters: d8 for direction — 1 is north, counting clockwise — and d6 halved, rounded up, for squares of drift. Mark the impact square; the round detonates at the end of the Warden Phase like any explosive, and figures may dive away (**Ranged Combat** (p. 23)). The impact is a Blast-1 blast attack at DR 5 against every figure within 1 square.
- Corrections.** Each following Warden Phase, the next round lands **1 square closer** to the aim square along the scatter line — the spotter is talking it in. At zero, fire for effect: a round on the aim square itself every Warden Phase the link survives.
- Breaking the walk.** The walk needs all three legs, every Phase: the spotter alive, its comms working, its LOS to the fall of shot intact. Break any leg — kill the spotter, cut the landline, jam the net, smoke the OP — and the tube goes silent. A replacement spotter, or a new aim square because you moved, starts over from a fresh spotting round.

Fear it in the right order. The first crump lands wide, and that wideness is a message: you have perhaps two turns before the rounds arrive where you are — 60 squares of reach means nowhere on the board is out of range, and no wall matters to a round arriving from above. So do not argue with the round. Displace, break LOS, become Unknown, and the walk dies blind — or run the message backward up the wire: somewhere a man with binoculars and a radio is killing you by voice. He has a square on the board. He is the target.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

The two halves of this chapter are one pincer, built deliberately. The Beaten Zone punishes moving; the mortar punishes staying — between them the game outlaws the wargamer's favorite sin, the perfect position held forever. Notice that every counter to the mortar is human, not material: you cannot shoot down a round, but the round is aimed by a network — a spotter, a radio, a line of sight — and networks have throats. Killing the observer instead of the weapon is this game's whole thesis wearing the other side's uniform.

The gun team, the ground it owns, and the tube that answers it: that is the chapter. Where these weapons ride instead of walk — mounts, technicals, and what Pen does to a hull — is **Vehicles** (p. 52); how the Warden emplaces its guns and when its Doctrine displaces them is **The Enemy System** (p. 66); what belts and tubes cost a campaign that has to steal them is **The Long War** (p. 84). And the next time a fence gap looks like the short way, look along it first. Somebody may already own that ground.

VEHICLES

Taped above the fuel gauge of the box truck, Delgado’s cramped ballpoint: “The Authority thinks a road is a thing you hold. A road is a thing you know. They have the blacktop, the bridges, and the checkpoints. I have every logging cut, church lot, and creek ford from here to the dam — and the difference is, they need theirs.” Below it, other hands, other weeks: rule one. the truck is a promise, not a fort. it takes you there and it brings you home, and the day you start fighting from it is the day it does neither. — rule two: count heads at the tailgate. twice. — V.

This chapter owns everything with an engine except the drones: how vehicles are read, boarded, driven, fired from, shot at, and lost. Attacks against them still begin with the attack procedure (**The Attack Procedure** (p. 23)) and hits on the people inside still end in the wound rules (**Wounds & Recovery** (p. 36)); the mounted machine gun’s Sustained Fire belongs to **Crew-Served Weapons** (p. 46), and how the Warden drives — QRF columns, patrol trucks, the technical at the wire — is scripted in **The Enemy System** (p. 66). What this chapter teaches is the trade every vehicle offers: speed and carriage, bought with Noise and a very large silhouette.

READING A VEHICLE CARD

Every vehicle is one card with five fields:

- **Handling** — the TN for Handling tests: rams, barrier runs, and any stunt a card or scenario calls one. Ordinary driving never tests.
- **Speed** — two numbers, road and rough: how many squares 1 AP of driving buys on each kind of ground.
- **Armor** — 0 for civilian steel, 1 for improvised plate, 2 for the real thing. Subtracted from the Vehicle Damage Die (**Shooting at Vehicles** (p. 54)).
- **Seats** — how many figures it carries, driver included.
- **Special** — the card’s own rules text. As always, the card wins.

PICKUP TRUCK

HANDLING	9
SPEED ROAD	3
SPEED ROUGH	2
ARMOR	0
SEATS	5
SPECIAL	Open bed - 3 more riders exposed (they may fire at +3; they are hit on Weapon/exposed results).
FACTION TYPICAL	crew, compact

TECHNICAL (HMG)

HANDLING	10
SPEED ROAD	3
SPEED ROUGH	2
ARMOR	0
SEATS	3
SPECIAL	Ring-mounted HMG - gunner fires with vehicle stationary at printed TN, moving at +3. Gunner is exposed.
FACTION TYPICAL	civil-order, compact

ECA PROTECTED VEHICLE (MRAP-TYPE)

HANDLING	12
SPEED ROAD	2
SPEED ROUGH	1
ARMOR	2
SEATS	8
SPECIAL	The Pen cap bites - small arms cannot do more than Mobility damage. Turret MMG. Occupants dismount from the rear only (one per activation).
FACTION TYPICAL	authority, QRF

Read the three together and the game’s whole vehicle spectrum is visible. The Pickup is fast, common, and made of excuses — Armor 0, and the bed carries three riders the card names **exposed**. The Technical is the same truth with a Heavy Machine Gun rung into the bed: the gunner is exposed too, and the gun is why anyone tolerates it. The ECA Protected Vehicle is the other end — Armor 2, eight seats, slow, and the reason this chapter has a section called the Pen cap.

Exposed occupants. A figure aboard a vehicle is either enclosed or exposed, and *the card decides*: only occupants the card names — the Pickup’s bed riders, the Technical’s gunner — are exposed. Everyone else rides enclosed: they cannot be targeted directly, and they are reached only

through the damage table. Exposed figures can be shot like anyone else (**Shooting at Vehicles** (p. 54)), and they are who a **Weapon / exposed** result finds.

GETTING IN AND GETTING OUT

Mounting or dismounting costs **2 AP of the figure's own allowance** (**Action Points** (p. 13)), moving between a seat and any square adjacent to the vehicle. Name the seat or position taken; changing seats or positions inside is an **Interact** (2 AP). A figure aboard has no facing and no Blind Arc — mirrors, windows, and a load bed see all round (**Facing and the Blind Arc** (p. 10)).

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-MOUNT-DISMOUNT.SVG]

The armored door. The ECA Protected Vehicle's card is the standing exception: its occupants mount and dismount through the rear door only, and the door passes **one figure per activation** — whoever's activation it is. A fireteam does not flow out of that truck; it trickles, and every activation it spends trickling is another roll of the Interrupt Die for whoever is watching (**The Interrupt Die** (p. 13)).

Bailing out. You may leave a vehicle while it is moving: during the vehicle's move, any occupant may pay 2 AP from its held AP — out of turn, like a dive (**End of the Phase** (p. 27)) — to go out the door. Place the figure prone in a square adjacent to any square the vehicle passed through this move; it takes a **DR 2 hit** (**Crew Wounds** (p. 36)). The ground is not soft. Occupants thrown out by a Wreck result bail by that rule instead (**What the Damage Means** (p. 55)), at no AP.

Stealing them. An unattended civilian vehicle with no keys starts with a hotwire: an **Interact**, 4 AP, requiring a Tool Roll — no test, no Noise until the engine turns. Authority vehicles do not hotwire: take the keys off a driver, or read the scenario. A stolen engine pays engine Noise like any other the moment it moves (**Driving** (p. 53)).

DRIVING

A vehicle activates **once per turn, during its driver's activation, with 6 AP** — a fixed allowance, whatever the driver's card prints. If the driver has

already spent AP this activation before taking the wheel, subtract it from the 6. Vehicle AP never persists: there is no vehicle Overwatch, and a driver at the wheel never attacks and never takes Reaction Fire — the hands are full. A driver who dismounts mid-activation (2 AP) finishes on foot with whatever remains.

Moving. Each 1 AP of driving moves the vehicle up to its Speed in squares — the road value while every square entered is road or Clear, the rough value the moment the move touches Rough, Concealment, or plowed ground; if one AP's move crosses both, use the rough value for all of it. Reversing always uses the rough value. Block, Water, walls, and standing timber are impassable — a checkpoint barrier is the one wall a vehicle argues with (**The Ram** (p. 56)) — and a vehicle occupies two squares, nose and tail, turning freely as it moves. Squares holding figures are entered only as a ram.

The engine is a source. A vehicle that moves at all during a turn adds +2 Noise for that turn (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). It is spotted, becomes Known, and is forgotten by the same rules as a figure (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)) — the engine feeds the pool, not the map.

Two speeds of target. Track the vehicle's movement across the whole turn, because two thresholds hang on it, both expiring in the End Phase. A vehicle that moved **at least 1 square** this turn is *moving*: everyone firing from it takes +3 (**Firing From Vehicles** (p. 54)), and it is not Cover (**Steel as Ground** (p. 57)). A vehicle that moved **4 or more squares** this turn is a *fast mover*: shots at it — and at its exposed occupants — take +3 (**Shooting at Vehicles** (p. 54)). Between 1 and 3 squares of movement lies the worst of both: hard to shoot from, easy to hit. Roll through or stay parked.

THE HANDLING TEST

A Handling test is 2d10 against the vehicle's printed Handling — the Sedan's forgiving 9, the Technical's 10, the Protected Vehicle's brutal 12. A card that prints a **Drive TN** — a skill or a support unit's stat line — uses that number instead, in any wheeled vehicle. Test only when a rule calls for it: rams, barrier runs, card specials, scenario stunts.

Failure on a ram or barrier run is a crash, and a natural 2 on any Handling test is a crash: the

vehicle takes a Mobility hit (**What the Damage Means** (p. 55)), stops in the last legal square, every occupant is Shaken, and the noise books as +3 (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)).

DRIVERS

Most wheels are held by **support units** — one-line figures, not Crew:

VOLUNTEER DRIVER

STAT Drive TN 10, Grit 11, Shoot 14/16

RULE Casualty Die at -1 (support). Will not leave the vehicle unless Rallied.

A support unit has no wound track and no hit locations. A hit on one resolves as a **Casualty Die at -1** (**The Enemy's Ledger: the Casualty Die** (p. 40)) — they are not soldiers, and the table knows it. The Volunteer Driver's line is also a warning: he will not leave the vehicle unless Rallied (**Rally** (p. 43)) — the truck is his cover, his post, and the whole of his war.

One Crew card turns driving from a liability into a weapon:

RAY DELGADO

TIER Skilled civilian

SHOOT 12/14

GRIT 10

AP 8

BIO Two million miles, every road east of the river - including the ones the maps forgot.

Delgado's **Driver** skill makes every Handling test a TN 8 test, in anything with wheels, and waives the barrier run's +2 outright. His **Mechanic** skill is the game's only field repair: an Interact, 4 AP, with his Tool Roll, clears one Mobility hit from a vehicle — once per vehicle per mission. Immobilized is two Mobility hits; even Delgado only buys one of them back.

FIRING FROM VEHICLES

Passengers fight; drivers drive. Any occupant except the driver may attack with its own AP, using the normal attack procedure — plus one flat modifier: **firing from a vehicle that has moved this turn is +3 TN**. Passengers with held AP take Reaction Fire under the usual rules (**Reaction Fire** (p. 14)), at the same +3 while the vehicle is moving. Braced Shots require a platform that has not

moved this turn and a passenger who goes nowhere — a parked truck bed is a fine rest; a rolling one is not.

Who can shoot *where* is the vehicle's geometry:



- **Cab seats** fire out the windows: the two flank quadrants only, never dead ahead through the windshield or dead astern through the load.
- **Exposed positions** — an open bed, a ring mount — fire in any direction.
- **The driver** fires in no direction. If the driver must fight, the vehicle has already failed.

MOUNTED GUNS

A ring or turret mount — the Technical's Heavy Machine Gun, the Protected Vehicle's turret Medium Machine Gun — counts as **deployed at all times**: no bipod, no set-up AP. The gunner fires it with ordinary shot actions at the printed TN while the vehicle is stationary, and at the moving +3 like any other passenger when it is not. **Sustained Fire** and the Beaten Zone (**Crew-Served Weapons** (p. 46)) are available from a mount only while the vehicle is stationary and another occupant feeds as assistant gunner. At DR 5 and Pen 3, the mounted HMG is the board's argument-ender against people and soft vehicles alike — which is exactly why the damage table's **Weapon / exposed** row exists, and why ring gunners are exposed: the gun draws every eye, and the man behind it stands in all of them.

SHOOTING AT VEHICLES

A vehicle is a huge target and an indifferent one. Declare your target: the **vehicle itself**, or one **exposed occupant**. An exposed occupant is attacked as a figure — your Shoot line, and always the Cover TN; the hull is the cover — at +3 if the vehicle is a fast mover.

Against the vehicle itself, skill barely matters and the procedure changes:

1. **Strike.** Roll $2d10 \geq 8$ — every shooter, every weapon. Add +3 if the vehicle moved 4 or more squares this turn. Your shooter-side modifiers apply as usual — Snap or Reaction Fire, Shaken,

smoke, range bands, Point Blank (**The Test** (p. 5)) — but a vehicle never has a Cover TN and never counts as a Sprinting target: the fast mover +3 is the whole of its evasiveness.

2. Damage. On a strike, roll the **Vehicle Damage Die: d10 + the weapon's Pen – the vehicle's Armor**, and read the table. Every weapon card prints Pen (**Reading a Card** (p. 6)): a Carbine's 0, the Battle Rifle's 1, the MMG's 2, the HMG's 3, the Rocket's 6.

TABLE: VEHICLE DAMAGE DIE (D10 + WEAPON PEN - ARMOR) (d10)

RESULT	EFFECT
3 or less	Rattled — occupants Shaken; cosmetic damage
4-5	Mobility hit — Speed halved; second Mobility = immobilized
6-7	Weapon / exposed hit — mounted weapon disabled or one exposed occupant hit (random)
8-9	Crew hit — driver or one occupant (random) takes a direct hit at +2
10+	Wreck — destroyed; occupants take a DR 3 hit and bail adjacent; 12+ it burns

Pen cap: against Armor 2+, a weapon with Pen below 2 treats any result above 5 as 5.

A **natural 20** on the strike ignores Armor and adds +3 to the Damage Die — subject, always, to the cap below. **Explosives** reach vehicles too: a Blast weapon whose footprint covers any of a vehicle's squares makes its blast attack against the vehicle at TN 12 flat, and a Triggered device detonating beneath one strikes automatically; on either, roll the Damage Die with the weapon's Pen. That arithmetic — the Rocket's Pen 6, the IED's 4 — is what actually opens armor.

THE PEN CAP

This is the rule the whole section stands on.

Against a vehicle with Armor 2 or more, a weapon with Pen less than 2 treats any Vehicle Damage Die result above 5 as 5.

Run the numbers against the Protected Vehicle, Armor 2. A carbine, Pen 0: even a d10 of 10 totals 8 — a Crew hit, says the table, except the cap folds it back to 5: a Mobility hit. A natural 20 that ignores Armor and adds 3 still folds back to 5. There is no roll, no volume of rifle fire, no lucky burst that takes that truck's occupants or its life. Small arms rattle the hull, blow the run-flats, wreck the vision blocks — Rattled and Mobility results, nothing above them, ever.

What the cap leaves you is the honest menu: strip its **mobility** — two Mobility hits leave it a pillbox with a turret, sitting exactly where you chose to shred its tires; kill what it **carries** when the door opens one figure at a time; or bring **real Pen** — the Rocket, the demolition charge, the IED buried where the Authority's trucks have to drive. The cap is also why the Warden's armor is never the mission: it is the terrain the mission routes around.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

The cap exists because the alternative lies. Without it, thirty rifle hits eventually roll a 10 and the armored truck dies to small arms — statistically certain, dramatically false, and it teaches exactly the wrong lesson about what an insurgency shoots at. With it, the build's math assertion is literally zero: rifle fire cannot exceed a Mobility result against Armor 2, at any odds, on any night. The MRAP problem is supposed to feel like the MRAP problem — you do not outshoot it, you out-plan it, and the campaign prices the tools that beat it (Rockets, demo, IEDs) as the scarce political objects they are.

WHAT THE DAMAGE MEANS

Rattled. Every occupant is Shaken (**Shaken & Pinned** (p. 40)) — the standard condition, with its standard escalation: an occupant Shaken again is Pinned. The hull is not effective fire against the people inside (**Nerve Under Fire** (p. 42)); a direct hit on one of them is.

Mobility hit. Halve both Speed values, rounding halves up. A **second** Mobility hit **immobilizes** the vehicle: it cannot move again this mission, though everything else aboard — seats, mounts, radio — still works, and it counts as stationary for every rule that cares. Delgado's Mechanic skill clears one hit (**Drivers** (p. 54)); nothing clears the second.

Weapon / exposed hit. The round finds whatever stands proud of the hull: randomize among the vehicle's mounted weapon and its exposed occupants. A mounted weapon struck is disabled for the mission; an exposed occupant struck takes a direct hit from the firing weapon — wound procedure for Crew, Casualty Die for the Warden's people, –1 for support units. If the vehicle has neither a mounted weapon nor an exposed occupant — and no card line like the Patrol Truck's

radio — the burst finds the engine bay instead: apply a Mobility hit.

Crew hit. Someone inside is hit through the skin of the truck. Randomize among *all* occupants, driver included; that figure takes a direct hit from the firing weapon at +2 — added to the Severity roll or the Casualty Die. Personal armor counts at its location, as always (**Armor Is Worn in Pieces** (p. 37)). If the driver goes Down or Dead while the vehicle is moving, it crashes immediately: Mobility hit, occupants Shaken, stopped. A cab occupant may take a dead man's wheel with an Interact (2 AP) — the vehicle drives again on that figure's next activation.

Wreck. The vehicle is destroyed, this mission and every mission. Each occupant takes a **DR 3 hit**, resolved by target type, and bails: place each prone in an adjacent square, no AP. On a **12 or higher, it burns**: place fire markers on its squares (**Fire** (p. 29)) — impassable, +1 Noise a turn, a column of smoke the whole valley can read. Burning or cold, a wreck is Cover, permanently (**Steel as Ground** (p. 57)); steel burns standing up.

THE RAM

A vehicle's last weapon is its mass. Declare a ram when the vehicle's move would enter squares holding figures, a barrier, or both; the ram is part

of movement and costs no extra AP. Make **one Handling test** for the action (**The Handling Test** (p. 53)):

- **Failure — crash.** Mobility hit, every occupant Shaken, the vehicle stops in the last legal square, +3 Noise.
- **Success — resolve each figure in the path.** Roll 2d10 per figure: **struck on 8 or more — 12 or more if the figure is prone or adjacent to Cover** (there is something to dive behind, and the table assumes they use it). A struck figure takes a **DR 4 hit**, resolved by target type. A figure not struck threw itself clear: place it prone in the nearest square out of the vehicle's path. Either way the vehicle drives on, and a ram that connects with anything books +3 Noise as a crash.

Barriers. Checkpoint gates, drop-arms, wire tangles, a sedan nosed across the lane — whatever the scenario marks as a barrier — take the same Handling test at +2. Success carries the vehicle through, the barrier is gone or flattened, and the crash is +3 Noise. Figures on or behind the barrier are in the path: resolve them as above. Delgado's card waives the +2; for everyone else the arithmetic is honest about what running a gate in a farm truck actually is.

EXAMPLE

Running the Wire Road checkpoint. Turn 7, and the mission has been Alerted since the substation came apart. The crew is mounted for the Exfil: Delgado at the wheel of the box truck, Vasquez in the cab beside him, and four in the cargo box — Boone, Pham, Okafor, Birdy — out of sight behind plywood and sheet steel, exactly as the card promises.

BOX TRUCK

HANDLING	11
SPEED ROAD	2
SPEED ROUGH	1
ARMOR	0
SEATS	2
SPECIAL	Cargo - carries the whole Crew or a mission load out of sight. Counts as Block terrain for LOS when parked.
FACTION TYPICAL	crew, ferrymen

The Wire Road runs straight through a Civil Order Corps checkpoint: a swing gate six squares ahead with a Corpsman standing on it, and a technical parked on the shoulder past the wire, its ring gunner holding 2 AP by his script, the truck long since Known — nothing about a box truck at speed is stealth (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)). Vasquez rides with her carbine up, but the checkpoint sits dead ahead, and cab seats fire the flanks only (**Firing From Vehicles** (p. 54)). The truck's answer to a checkpoint is the accelerator.

Delgado activates — the first Crew activation of the turn — and the vehicle takes its 6 AP. Speed on the road is 2 squares per AP. The first AP moves the truck 2 squares — and the Warden reacts *now*, while the shot is cheap: the truck has not yet moved 4 squares this turn, so no fast mover penalty. Reaction Fire with the ring HMG at a vehicle: TN 8, +3 for Reaction Fire — 11. The Warden rolls 9 and 7 — 16. Struck. Vehicle Damage Die: d10 comes up 5, plus the HMG's Pen 3, minus the truck's Armor 0 — 8: **Crew hit**. Number the six aboard and roll: **Boone**. A direct hit from a DR 5 weapon at +2. Hit Location d10: 6 — **Torso**, and Boone wears Rifle Plates. Severity: d10 = 2, +5 DR, +2 Crew hit, -3 plates — 6: **Light**. Shaken, -2 max AP, Bleed 1 (**Crew Wounds** (p. 36)). Half-inch round, plywood wall, plate edge: bare, that d10 totals 9 — Serious, prone in a moving cargo box.

Delgado does the only correct thing: more speed. The second AP makes it 4 squares — the truck is a fast mover now, +3 to be struck for the rest of the turn. The third AP carries it squares 5 and 6, onto the gate: a **barrier run** with a man on the bar. One

Handling test at +2 — except Delgado's Driver skill makes any wheeled vehicle TN 8 and waives the barrier penalty; anyone else tests against the truck's Handling of 11 plus 2. He rolls 6 and 5 — 11. Through — the gate tears off its hinge, +3 Noise (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). The Corpsman is in the path, upright in the open lane: struck on 8 or more. The Warden's man rolls to be missed and the dice say 6 and 4 — 10: struck, a DR 4 hit. Casualty Die: d10 = 6, +4, -0 Armor — 10: **Dead** (**The Enemy's Ledger: the Casualty Die** (p. 40)). The last three AP spend as 6 more squares, and the truck is through the wire and opening the range.

Warden Phase. The technical's element acts by Doctrine: the gunner, stationary, puts an Aimed burst after the truck. TN 8, +3 fast mover — 11. The Warden rolls 7 and 5 — 12. Struck. Damage Die: d10 = 2, +3 Pen, -0 — 5: **Mobility hit**. Rear tires gone to rag: both Speeds halve, rounding halves up — road 2 to 2, rough already 1. The truck limps — 12 squares a turn on rims instead of 18, still six people carried faster than any of them can run, and Delgado's Mechanic skill waits at the first quiet culvert: an Interact, 4 AP, Tool Roll, once per vehicle, and the tires are cut brush and prayer but the Speed comes back.

End Phase. Boone marks Bleed 1 (**Bleed** (p. 37)). The turn's ledger reads like a vehicle chapter: engine +2, crash +3, gunfire +3 at the cap — +8 Noise in thirty seconds, and somewhere behind them the checkpoint Boss is shouting into a manpack for ALARM (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). A truck buys distance with attention. Spend it on purpose.

Margin note, Delgado's hand, inside the box truck's log book: *The first four squares belong to their gunner — cheap shots, before the speed is real. So the run starts before they can see it: I want fourth gear at the sight line, not at the wire. And I never stop in the funnel. Shot, gate, screaming — the answer is the far side. A stopped truck is cover for everybody except the people inside it.*

STEEL AS GROUND

A vehicle that has not moved this turn is **Cover terrain** in its squares (**The Outdoor Grid** (p. 8)): figures fighting from behind it get the Cover TN by the normal determination (**Open or In Cover** (p. 9)). A vehicle that moved this turn is nothing — a blur the rules do not stop bullets with. A **wreck** is **Cover permanently**, one of the few pieces of terrain the fight itself manufactures, and worth manufacturing: a wrecked patrol truck in a

gateway is a wall the Authority paid for. The parked box truck goes one better by card — Block for LOS, a rolling piece of dead ground the width of a barn.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Vehicles in this game are logistics that can die, not cavalry. Six AP, a fixed pool, hands-full drivers, +3 to shoot on the move: the design pushes every vehicle toward the two jobs trucks actually did in every war this one rhymes with — carry people and things, and mount a gun *while parked*. The one-line driver is the same decision from the other side (and it is locked): the wheel is not a character sheet, and the game will not ask you to mourn a truck. It will ask you to mourn the volunteer who would not leave it — which is why he gets a Grit line and a rule about being Rallied, and the vehicle gets a damage table.

That is the motor pool: read the card, load by twos, drive loud, and know to the pip what a rifle cannot do to an armored hull. The other machines the Authority owns are smaller, quieter, and overhead — **Drones & Electronic Warfare** (p. 59) is their chapter, and the sky is worse than the wire. When the Warden's own wheels roll — the QRF clock, the column at the board edge, the technical that was always parked at the crossroads — their scripts are waiting in **The Enemy System** (p. 66).

DRONES & ELECTRONIC WARFARE

Taped inside the lid of the quad case, an index card in Oren Petty's careful print: "RULES OF THE AIR. 1. The sky is a ledger like everything else — every minute this bird is up, somebody is hearing it. 2. Fly the battery, not the map. Eight climbs go up; none of them come back. 3. If you hear a mower where no mower should be, get under trees and get STILL. It is not a mower." Beneath that, Deacon's block capitals: "AND THE JAMMER IS A LIT PORCH LIGHT. ASK STATIC BEFORE YOU TOUCH THE SWITCH." And a third hand, pencil, very small, at the bottom: the wasps with the wire tails don't care about porch lights. shotgun.

The heavy-equipment chapters end here, in the air. This one owns everything that flies and everything that fights over the spectrum it flies on: your recon quad, your one-shot strike drone, the dropper rig, the jammer on Petty's back — and the Authority's versions of all four, which are newer, more numerous, and pointed at you. Two loops run through the whole chapter. Yours: see them before they know you are there — the drone as the fieldcraft of **Fieldcraft** (p. 17) with altitude. Theirs: find, mark, strike — because the Warden shoots only what it Knows (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)), and under **ALARM**, its drones are how it comes to Know.

DRONES ON THE BOARD

A drone is a marker, not a figure, and it obeys aircraft rules, all of them short:

- **It flies.** A drone ignores terrain, walls, elevation, and figures for movement. It has no Blind Arc (**Facing and the Blind Arc** (p. 10)) and no facing.
- **It sees like a drone.** A drone has LOS to every outdoor square on the board except **canopy** squares — Concealment that is trees (timber and conifer squares, the map's tree-dot texture), whose crowns it cannot look through. It never sees inside a Zone; buildings are closed books from above (**Indoors: Zones and Portals** (p. 10)).
- **It is flown, not activated.** Every drone belongs to an operator — a Crew figure carrying the kit, or an enemy drone team. It does nothing on its

own; it acts only when its operator spends the actions below. One drone aloft per operator.

- **It is a small, fast, miserable target.** Shooting at any drone uses a single flat TN — no Open or Cover, and one hit downs it; drones do not roll damage (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)). The numbers and the procedure live at **Shooting Back** (p. 63). No figure, either side, may ever take Reaction Fire at a drone — anti-drone fire is always deliberate.
- **It is not terrain.** A drone never blocks LOS and is never cover.

Your quad's fuel is **Battery** — a printed number of charges, spent per control action, never recovered in-mission. When the Battery question and the Noise question (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)) both come up, you are flying correctly: the drone is a loud clock, and this whole chapter is about what to buy before it runs out.

THE RECON QUAD

RECON QUADCOPTER (CREW)

SIDE	crew
BATTERY	8
MOVE	6
SPECIAL	Launch 3 AP. Control actions (1 Battery each) - reposition, Sweep (reveal/resolve all within 3), overwatch feed (-1 TN for one designated shooter). +1 Noise per turn aloft. Shot down at 14 (shotgun 11 within 6).

The quad rides in a pack (Battery 8. Sweep, reposition, overwatch feed per chapter 11. — the kit fills both of a figure's slots) and launches from the operator's hands.

Launch (3 AP). Place the drone marker in the operator's square or an adjacent one, aloft, with its full Battery of 8. From the moment it is aloft to the moment it lands, it adds **+1 Noise per turn** in the Warden Phase's bookkeeping — the rotor buzz on the noise-sources table (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)).

Fly (2 AP and 1 Battery). While the drone is aloft, its operator may take the Fly action any number of times per activation, paying 2 AP and 1 Battery each, choosing one effect per action:

- **Reposition.** Move the drone up to 6 squares.

- **Sweep.** Resolve every Blip within 3 squares of the drone (**Blips** (p. 18)) — roll each on the Contact Table as normal — and reveal every hidden OPFOR element within 3 squares. Everything the Sweep reveals stays fixed in the camera’s view while it remains within 3 squares of the drone: you always know exactly where it is, and it can never resolve with surprise against you.
- **Overwatch Feed.** Designate one Crew figure. Until the drone lands, is downed, or the feed is re-tasked by another Fly action, that figure’s shots take **–1 TN against targets within 3 squares of the drone** — the spotter’s voice in one shooter’s ear. The bonus is a modifier like any other and counts inside the –3 cap (**The Test** (p. 5)).

Landing. A Reposition that ends on the operator’s square may land the drone free; packed, it is kit again. A drone that reaches 0 Battery aloft settles where it hovers at the end of the turn and sits there, dead weight — any Crew figure in or adjacent to its square may recover it with an Interact (**Action Points** (p. 13)). A drone shot down is destroyed, and the campaign’s supply ledger feels it (**The Long War** (p. 84)).

Being shot at. The Warden fires on your drone only while the force is **Alerted or worse** — an Unaware garrison hears a mower somewhere and files it under Tuesday. Every quiet turn on the ladder is free flying; the moment the mission goes loud, the sky gets expensive. The Warden’s procedure is printed with the rest of the anti-drone rules at **Shooting Back** (p. 63).

WHAT A SWEEP BUYS

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-DRONE-SWEEP.SVG]

Read the Sweep against the scouting rules of **Fieldcraft** (p. 17) and its value is obvious: a Blip normally resolves at 12 squares of ground-level LOS, 6 in Concealment, on the Warden’s terms as often as yours. The drone resolves them at **any distance from your Crew**, three squares of map at a time, on your clock, with nobody’s rifle committed. A Blip that resolves under the drone

deploys its figures as normal (**Blips** (p. 18)), but it deploys them seen — postures, count, and Leader, from an angle no ditch protects against. The buzz overhead is the price: the pool climbs a point a turn, and Noise never comes back (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). Fly early, strip the Blips that matter, and get it back on the ground before the ladder makes the sky hostile.

THE FPV STRIKE

FPV DRONE (ARMED)

CLASS	drone
DR	4
PEN	2
EFF	20

Pilot test 2d10 >= 10 vs a Known square. Jamming rules ch. 11.

The FPV kit (One armed FPV drone (weapon profile fpv). Single use.) is a different machine for a different job: an armed airframe with a camera, flown into the target and expended with it. It is Single-Shot in the fullest sense — one strike, then the kit is gone — and at Supply 4 it is the most expensive thing a figure can carry. The campaign, not the mission, decides how many you ever see (**The Long War** (p. 84)).

FPV Strike (4 AP, one use). Choose a target square within 20 squares of the pilot. The pilot needs **no LOS** — the camera flies the terminal leg, and dead ground is exactly what this weapon exists to reach — but the square must be one your side actually knows about: it must contain or be adjacent to a revealed OPFOR figure or vehicle, be in some Crew figure’s LOS, or lie within 3 squares of your aloft drone. You cannot steer to a guess.

Then make the **Pilot test: 2d10 ≥ 10**. It is a test like any other — a Shaken pilot is +2 — but no figure’s Shoot line is involved; the weapon’s Piloted trait replaces it (**Weapon Traits** (p. 24)).

- **Success:** the drone detonates in the target square, immediately — no end-of-Phase delay. Resolve the blast attack: 12/14 at DR 4 against every figure within 1 square, Open or Cover judged per figure from the detonation square (**The Blast** (p. 28)). Figures with held AP may dive before the blast, once each, as against any detonation. A vehicle in the footprint takes a Vehicle Damage Die at Pen 2 (**Vehicles** (p. 52)) —

enough to open anything short of the Authority's protected trucks.

- **Failure:** the strike goes in anyway, somewhere. **Drift d8 × d6 halved** (rounded up) from the target square — direction and distance exactly like grenade scatter, and walls stop drift the same way (**The Throw** (p. 27)) — then detonate there. A drifted warhead is still a warhead; think hard before flying strikes near your own people or anyone else's.
- **Natural 20:** perfect terminal control — against the figure in the target square itself, the hit ignores Armor and adds +3 Severity (**Natural 20**, **Natural 2** (p. 6)). **Natural 2:** link lost — the drone tumbles into a field and is gone, no detonation; the pilot takes the standard complication (+1 Noise, Shaken).

Every FPV detonation is an explosion for Noise (+3, **The Noise Pool** (p. 17)).

THE DROPPER RIG

The dropper (Converts the recon quad - 2 grenade drops (Open TN even vs cover-adjacent targets). Each drop costs 2 Battery.) is a conversion, not a new aircraft: clamp it under the recon quad and the eye becomes an eye that bombs. The rig itself is one slot and carries **2 drops**; the quad it converts is still the quad — same Battery, same Fly actions, same buzz — so the load usually spreads across two backs.

Drop (2 AP and 2 Battery). The converted quad releases a grenade on **its own square**, which must be outdoors — Deep is proof against the sky (**Indoors: Zones and Portals** (p. 10)). No Throw test, no scatter: three meters straight down does not miss. The grenade resolves like any thrown frag — at the **end of the current Phase**, with dives allowed (**End of the Phase** (p. 27)) — as a blast attack at DR 3 with one vertical exception: **every figure in the footprint is judged at its Open TN, even adjacent to cover**. A wall is a roof against rifles and nothing at all against what comes from directly above. Cover-adjacent is precisely the habit the dropper punishes: the Warden's people hug walls because your rifles taught them to.

At 2 Battery a drop, the rig eats the quad's endurance twice as fast as flying does. A full combat load — launch, position, one Sweep, two

drops — is 7 of the 8 charges. Fly the battery, not the map.

JAMMING

The jammer pack is the crew's only weapon that fires in a spectrum nobody at the table can see. Its card reads: Active - 6-square bubble; RF drones inside test at +4 and drift on failure; enemy manpack ALARM tests inside auto-fail.

Running the pack. The jammer fills both kit slots and takes a working operator — in this crew, that is Oren Petty, whose Ham skill exists for exactly this box. Switching it on or off is an Interact (2 AP). While active, it projects a **bubble of radius 6 squares centered on its carrier**, moving with him. Inside the bubble:

- **RF drones fail.** Any radio-controlled drone inside the bubble — the recon quads, both droppers, your FPV if its target square lies inside — is fighting the noise floor: its **Pilot tests take +4 and drift on failure**, and its **Sweeps simply fail** (the action and Battery are spent; nothing resolves, nothing is revealed, nothing becomes Known). The bubble does not read IFF: **your own quad fails inside it too**. Jamming, like smoke, has no friends.
- **Manpack ALARM dies in the static.** An enemy Leader's manpack ALARM attempt made inside the bubble **automatically fails** (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). Fixed sets and landlines are wired, not radios — the bubble does not touch them, which is why the wire still has to be cut the old way (**The Quiet Game** (p. 20)).

The jammer adds no Noise — the pool measures sound, and the pack makes none a human hears.

THE COST

Here is the clause that makes the switch a decision and not a setting. **While the jammer is active, the Warden hears it.** Not with ears — with every receiver in the county reading a wall of static and every operator asking what is being protected in the middle of it. You are loud in a spectrum you cannot hear, and you have no meter for how loud.

The rule: **each Warden Phase the jammer is active, the nearest unresolved Blip abandons whatever it was doing and moves toward the carrier's current position** — at its ladder speed, 2 squares while the force is Unaware, 3 from

Suspicious up (**Blips** (p. 18)). It is not made Known and no alert triggers; something is simply, patiently, walking down the bearing. Switch off, and the convergence stops with the static — but the Blip does not walk back.

So the pack is a trade with no neutral position. On: the FPVs the Authority can jam are blunted, their recon quad is blind inside your bubble, and the manpack call that starts the QRF clock dies in Petty’s static — while the ground element you have not met yet closes on the one figure in the crew who cannot run fast wearing it. Off: the sky works again, theirs included. The crew that wins this trade is the one that switches on late, for minutes, on purpose.

THE AUTHORITY’S JAMMERS

The Authority fields the same physics on a truck. Where a scenario deploys an **ECA EW vehicle**, it projects the same 6-square bubble around itself: your RF drones inside test at +4 and drift, your Sweeps fail, and your Handheld Nets go dead inside it — radio Rally collapses back to voice range (**Rally** (p. 43)). The truck is a vehicle like any other (**Vehicles** (p. 52)), which is the good news: a Mobility kill drags the bubble to a stop, and a Wreck turns it off.

DESIGNER’S NOTE

Everything in this chapter is imported from the drone war over Ukraine, compressed to skirmish scale. The recon-strike loop — a cheap quad finds you, and what follows is fires, not infantry — is the loop the Warden runs under ALARM, and it is why the counter-drone shot and the canopy rule exist: by 2024 the answer to being seen was measured in seconds, and “don’t be seen” had become the whole of infantry fieldcraft. EW is modeled as *terrain* — a bubble is a hill you carry, with a military crest and a price for standing on it — because that is how both armies came to treat it: jammers massed where it mattered and switched off where it didn’t, since every emitter is a beacon to a direction-finder. And the fiber-optic FPV is here because it is the current last word in that argument: twenty kilometers of glass thread instead of a radio link, immune to every bubble on the board. The counter that ends this chapter — a shotgun, trees, and breaking line of sight — is not a game abstraction. It is the state of the art.

THE WARDEN’S DRONES

The Authority’s drones enter play two ways: a scenario puts a drone team on the board from setup (or the Contact Table resolves one — **Blips** (p. 18)), or **ALARM launches them** (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). Either way the aircraft belongs to an operator element:

ECA DRONE OPERATOR	
FACTION	authority
SHOOT	13/15
GRIT	10
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	Holding
WEAPON	pistol
SPECIAL	Runs one recon quad or fiber FPV per Warden Phase (ch. 11). Kill him to ground it.
ELEMENT	pair with eca-rto

The operator runs **one drone per Warden Phase** — the Warden’s whole air force is a man with a controller, which is the vulnerability the card prints in the open: **kill him and his drone is grounded** — it settles where it hovers and is out of the mission. OPFOR drones spend 1 Battery per Warden Phase aloft; the Battery of 10 on the recon quad is a mission’s endurance, and the 6 on the fiber FPV is a leash. Enemy drones add no Noise — the pool is the Warden’s ear, not yours.

THE ECA RECON QUAD

Each Warden Phase it is aloft, the ECA recon quad flies one combined action: **Reposition up to 6 squares, then Sweep 3** — every Crew figure within 3 squares of where it stops is **Known (Known and Unknown** (p. 20)). It flies by priority: toward the last Known Crew position; failing that, toward the newest Noise source; failing that, along the mission anchor, objective first — gaps resolve against you (**The Good-Faith Clause** (p. 4)).

Being swept is worse than being seen. A swept figure **cannot become Unknown while it remains within 3 squares of the quad** — the 3-squares-and-gone rule (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)) resumes only once you are outside the envelope; beyond it, the drone does not count as a figure holding LOS. While that eye holds you, every Doctrine in the enemy system has a target (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)).

Three counters, all real:

- **Kill it.** The flat-TN shot below (**Shooting Back** (p. 63)). One hit downs it.
- **Canopy.** Squares under tree cover — timber and conifer Concealment — are **immune to Sweep**: the quad cannot see through crowns, and a figure under canopy is never swept, no roll. Note the season: LEAF SEASON's later scenarios thin the hardwoods, and where a scenario sheet says the canopy is down, it is down (**Running Missions** (p. 81)).
- **Freeze.** A Crew figure in any Concealment that has not moved this turn may hold still as the eye passes: when swept, roll **2d10** ≥ 8 — success, and the figure is not revealed and not Known. Movement is what the camera catches; a shape that could be a stump stays a stump. (A ghillie-rigged figure lying prone does better still — its card says how.)

THE FIBER FPV

ECA FIBER-OPTIC FPV

SIDE	authority
BATTERY	6
MOVE	8
SPECIAL	IMMUNE to jamming (fiber spool). Attacks one Known figure or vehicle per Warden Phase it is aloft - Pilot 11, DR 4 Pen 2 Blast 1. Its spool path follows LOS - breaking LOS twice forces it home.

This is the SRT's answer to Petty, and the reason the jammer is not a solution. The fiber FPV flies on a spool of optical thread, not a radio link: **it is immune to jamming, entirely** — the bubble might as well be weather. You cannot jam it. You can only kill it, hide from it, or beat it on geometry.

It launches under ALARM or by scenario, and it hunts by the Warden's law: it attacks only a **Known** Crew figure or vehicle (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)). Each Warden Phase aloft it moves up to 8 squares toward its target; when it can strike, the Warden makes its Pilot test at 11. Success: detonation on the target's square, immediately — blast attack 12/14 at DR 4, Pen 2, dives allowed, exactly like your own FPV in enemy hands. Failure: drift $d8 \times d6$ halved and detonate. Hit or drift, **the airframe is expended** — every fiber FPV is one strike.

Its weakness is the thread. The spool pays out along the path it has flown, and the drone must keep **LOS along its approach to the target**. Each

time its target breaks that LOS — a building, a conifer stand, dead ground — the drone spends its next Warden Phase repositioning to regain the line instead of striking. **The second time its target breaks LOS, the spool fouls and the drone is forced home: remove it.** Mark the first break; a barn with two doors is a weapon against this thing. So is going Unknown — a target it cannot Know is a target it cannot take — and so is its own Battery: count the leash.

THE ECA DROPPER

Under ALARM, where the scenario fields one, the ECA dropper works your side of the vertical rule: every **other** Warden Phase, it drops a frag on the square holding the **densest cluster of Known Crew figures** — most Known figures in one blast footprint, ties against you. The drop resolves at end of Phase, dives allowed, and every figure in the footprint is judged at its **Open TN**, cover-adjacent or not, exactly like yours (**The Dropper Rig** (p. 61)). It is an RF aircraft: **it is jammable** — inside your bubble the drop fails like a Sweep. The cluster rule is the lesson: from the moment the Authority's drones are up, standing shoulder to shoulder is a targeting solution. Spread out.

SHOOTING BACK

An anti-drone shot is a normal shot action — Snap or Aimed, from a figure's AP — against a **flat TN of 14**: no Open or Cover, no range bands. The only range rule is that the drone must be inside the weapon's Effective Range. The shooter's own condition still applies off the closed list (**The Test** (p. 5)): a Snap Shot is +3, a Shaken shooter +2, smoke between you +2. One hit downs any drone — no Casualty Die, no damage roll (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)). And a shot is a shot: it makes the shooter Known and pays gunfire's Noise like any other trigger pull (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20), **The Noise Pool** (p. 17)).

Why the shotgun matters. The Hunting Shotgun's Spread trait buys it a different number: **TN 11 within 6 squares** — inside its whole Effective Range of 6. Run the curve: an Aimed carbine shot at 14 connects about one time in four; the shotgun at 11 is better than even money. A cloud of shot against a jinking rotor is twice the gun a rifle is, which is why the crew's oldest, cheapest weapon is standing air defense in this war — and why

Okafor's scattergun stays uncased when the mowers start.

The Warden shoots back too. While the force is **Alerted or worse**, each revealed OPFOR element that has **no Known Crew target in LOS** and has your drone inside its weapon's Effective Range fires on it as part of its normal activation: **one attempt per element per Warden Phase**, $2d10 \geq 14$, shotgun-armed elements at 11 within 6. People always outrank drones on the Warden's priority list — an element with a Known target in LOS shoots the target, not the aircraft. Neither side ever takes Reaction Fire at a drone.

WHAT THE DRONE FEEDS

Close the chapter by closing the loop. Everything the Warden does runs on Known (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)): Doctrine fire, Directive orders, Reaction Fire — no trigger in the enemy system pulls without it (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)). Before ALARM, the Warden earns Known the slow way: sentries' eyes, your muzzle flashes. After ALARM, the recon quad mass-produces it. One Sweep can hand every element on the board a target at once — the Base-of-Fire line gets its cluster, the Assault element gets its bearing, the QRF gets its grid, the mortar Directive gets the address it was waiting for. The drone is not another rifleman; it is the Warden's supply line for the only ammunition its Doctrines burn.

Which sets your counter-air priorities in order: the **operator** first, because one man grounds the fleet; the **aircraft** second, because one hit downs it; the **geometry** always — canopy, stillness, spacing, and the discipline of going Unknown — because it costs no ammunition at all. The full machinery this feeds — Doctrines, Directives, the QRF — is the next chapter's business: **The Enemy System** (p. 66).

Margin note, Petty's hand: *battery math for people who don't do battery math. eight charges. one to get anywhere, one to look, one to get back where I can reach it. that's a five-charge margin and the mission will eat three of them when somebody yells NOW. so no, I will not "just keep it up for a while." the buzz costs a point of quiet a turn and quiet doesn't come back either. tell me the minute you want, and I'll fly you that minute like it's the last one. it might be.*

EXAMPLE

The pump station. Turn 2 of a raid on a fuel point; thresholds Suspicious 3 / Alerted 7, pool at 2, force Unaware. Blips 2 and 4 sit between the crew and the tanks; a sentry pair with a fixed landline set holds the pump house; across the road, the scenario posts an ECA drone team, grounded until ALARM. Oren Petty carries the recon quad — both slots, so tonight his jammer stayed home — with Reyna Vasquez and Tanya Okafor forward.

Turn 2. Petty (7 AP — Slow): Launch (3 AP), the quad aloft at Battery 8. Fly: Reposition (2 AP, 1 Battery), 6 squares out over the fence line. Fly: Sweep (2 AP, 1 Battery) — 7 AP, spent to the bone. Both Blips sit within 3 of the drone. Blip 2: $d10 = 1$ — Nothing; somebody's dog, removed. Blip 4: $d10 = 7$ — a fireteam, four figures with a Leader, deployed at the culvert in plain view of the camera and held there while the quad stays on them. Battery 6. Vasquez and Okafor walk up and bank AP; the Interrupt Die — rolled after the second activation ends (needing a 10) and again after the third (9 or better) — shows a 4, then a 6: the revealed fireteam stays put. Warden Phase: rotor buzz, +1 Noise — pool 3, **Suspicious**. The fireteam stands to under a sound it cannot place.

Turn 3. Petty: Fly: Reposition (2 AP, 1 Battery — 5) to keep the fireteam in the envelope; Fly: Overwatch Feed (2 AP, 1 Battery — 4), designating Vasquez. Vasquez, rested against a deadfall: Braced Shot (5 AP) at the fireteam Leader behind the culvert lip. Cover TN of her Shoot 10/12: 12, -1 Braced, -1 feed — TN 10. She rolls 6 and 7 — 13. Hit. Casualty Die: $d10 = 5 + \text{carbine DR } 3 - \text{Armor } 1 = 7$. **Dead**. The survivors test Grit for their Leader and hold — ECA discipline (**Breaking the Warden's People** (p. 44)). The unsuppressed shot is +2 Noise — pool 6 — and a shot in their LOS is clear contact: **Alerted**, and Vasquez is Known at her fired-from square.

Warden Phase. Directive drawn: EYES UP. The pump-house sentries reach their fixed set — automatic — **ALARM**: QRF clock $d6+2$ rolls 5 turns, and across the road the drone team wakes. The fireteam has a Known target in LOS, so it fires at Vasquez, not the quad; her deadfall holds. The operator puts up the fiber FPV.

Turn 4. Vasquez displaces 4 squares behind the dairy barn, no OPFOR figure holding LOS on the way — **Unknown**. Petty pulls the quad 6 squares homeward (2 AP, 1 Battery — 3) and holds 5 AP. Warden Phase: the fiber FPV closes 8 squares toward her last Known square and finds no Known target — it loiters. The fireteam, nothing Known in

LOS now, spends its phase on Petty's quad: one attempt, $2d10 \geq 14$ flat — **8 and 4, 12**. The quad jinks.

Turn 5. The fireteam presses the barn; Vasquez fires again to stop the rush — a hit, and Known again. Okafor does not activate: she stands dead still in the crabapple row, shotgun up, banking all 8. Warden Phase: the fiber FPV has its Known figure. Pilot 11: **5 and 4 — 9**. Failure — drift $d8 = 6$, $d6 = 4$, halved: 2 squares, into the stock pond. The blast attack catches no one, and the airframe is spent: one strike, hit or drift. The operator's next bird, the recon quad, launches and will fly at her last Known square. Petty, under timber canopy, cannot be swept at all.

Turn 6, Warden Phase. The ECA quad repositions and Sweeps 3: Vasquez, 2 squares from where it stops, is **Known** — and stays Known while it holds her. Okafor, in Concealment, unmoving since her last activation: freeze test $2d10 \geq 8 — 9$. A stump stays a stump. Next Crew Phase she ends the argument: the quad crosses the yard at 4 squares, inside her shotgun's 6; Aimed Shot (4 AP) at the flat 11: **6 and 7 — 13**. One hit, and it is a lawnmower falling out of the sky — no damage roll, down (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)).

Count the ledger. Two Battery stripped both Blips before the crew crossed the fence; the feed bought the -1 that made a TN 10 of a Leader's life; the Authority spent both aircraft and got one drifted warhead in a pond. Cost: the pool went from 2 to loud, Vasquez was Known twice, Okafor's shot marked her — and the QRF clock stands at 2. The sky is a ledger. Balance it and get out.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Why price the quad in Battery *and* AP? AP alone would make flying free tempo — the drone as a better scout with no scarcity — and Battery alone would let one figure fly all day while fighting all day. Two currencies make the operator a real specialist: Petty's activation is the drone, and eight charges force the question the whole chapter turns on — which three minutes of this mission deserve an eye in the sky? The flat anti-drone TN, meanwhile, is deliberately outside the Open/Cover economy: nothing on the board changes it, so the decision is never “where do I shoot it from” but “who is holding the shotgun” — one number that makes a farm tool into air defense, which is the period-correct joke and true besides.

THE ENEMY SYSTEM

From a Civil Order Corps duty binder, recovered at the Route 9 checkpoint, water-stained and laminated: “REACT TO CONTACT: 1. RETURN FIRE. 2. TAKE COVER. 3. REPORT. The element in contact fixes. The nearest element flanks. The post reports. Do not pursue beyond your sector. The district does not need chasing. It needs holding.” In the margin, pencil, Deacon’s block capitals: THEY FIGHT BY THE BINDER. GOOD. A BINDER CAN BE READ. And beneath that, smaller, a different hand: the binder is in our book now. chapter twelve. read it until you can hate it from both sides of the wire.

Everything that hunts you in this game is run by **the Warden**: the dice, the tables, the Doctrine scripts, and the Directive deck, operating together as one procedural enemy. The chapters before this one kept pointing here. This is the chapter they were pointing at — the Warden’s complete operating manual. Nothing in it is advice. It is procedure, and you will run all of it.

YOU ARE THE WARDEN’S HANDS

The Warden is not an app, a referee, or a memory game. It is a machine made of four parts: the **Alert Ladder** that sets the whole force’s posture (**The Alert Ladder** (p. 67)), the **Doctrine scripts** that tell each element what to do (**The Six Doctrines** (p. 68)), the **Directive deck** that focuses the force turn by turn (**The Directive Deck** (p. 71)), and the **dice** that settle everything the scripts leave to chance. Play it entirely face up. The Warden hides nothing from you except what the Blip markers hide from everyone (**The Warden’s Hidden Hand** (p. 72)); its scripts are printed in this chapter precisely so that you can read them, plan against them, and still lose to them.

What the Warden knows is exactly three things: the number on the Noise track, the force’s current Alert state, and the set of Known positions on the board (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)). It is never psychic and never blind — it is procedural. When a rule says “the Warden rolls,” you roll, on its behalf.

That makes you both players at this table, and one rule governs the seam. The **Good-Faith Clause** was stated in **The Good-Faith Clause** (p. 4); it is

reprinted here, in full, because this chapter is where you will use it most:

When a Doctrine script, a Directive, or any Warden procedure is ambiguous, resolve it in the most tactically sensible way *against* the Crew. When two readings are exactly equal, take the one less favorable to you. Break every tie against the player. You are the Warden’s hands, not its lawyer. Do not look for the reading that spares your people; look for the one a competent enemy would take, and take it.

The clause is not a patch for bad rules. It is the Warden’s judgment, delegated to you. Scripts can carry a unit to the right wall; only you can decide which side of the doorway it stacks on. When this chapter says “the Warden chooses,” it means: apply the clause.

THE WARDEN PHASE

The Warden acts once per turn, in the second phase of the turn sequence (**The Turn Sequence** (p. 12)), and always in the same five steps. Run them in order, completely, every turn — including the quiet ones. A Warden Phase in which nothing seems to happen is the Warden Phase working.

(a) **Alert and Noise bookkeeping.** Noise was marked the moment it happened, all turn long (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)); this step is the audit. Read the pool against the scenario’s printed thresholds and move the force’s Alert state if a threshold has been crossed. Apply any state changes earned directly during the turn — clear contact, a body found by a revealed element, a sentry’s spot — if you have not already; those move the ladder the instant they occur, and step (a) is where you make sure the marker caught up. The state you set here governs the rest of the phase.

(b) **Directive.** If the force is Alerted, draw one Directive card and read it aloud. Under ALARM, draw two (**The Directive Deck** (p. 71)). If the force is Unaware or Suspicious, skip this step — the deck stays face down.

© **Blips move.** Every unresolved Blip moves: along its printed route while the force is Unaware, toward the newest Noise source or the last Known

position from Suspicious up (**The Warden's Hidden Hand** (p. 72)). Resolve any Blip whose movement demands it, by the rules of **Blips** (p. 18).

(d) **Elements act.** Every revealed OPFOR element activates once, in the order given in **Elements** (p. 68), each running its Doctrine script (**The Six Doctrines** (p. 68)) under the turn's Directive. This is the step with the shooting in it.

(e) **Clocks tick.** Advance every running clock by one: the QRF clock (**The QRF Clock** (p. 68)), bleed-out clocks (**Bleed** (p. 37)), fires, drone batteries, and any scenario clock the sheet lists. A clock that reaches zero fires its effect now.

Then the phase is over, and the End Phase settles the turn (**The Turn Sequence** (p. 12)).

THE ALERT LADDER

The Alert state is the whole force's posture — one state for every element, sentry, and Blip on the board, moved by the triggers in the table and never moved back. The ladder was introduced from your side of the board in **The Noise Pool** (p. 17); this is the Warden's side: what its force actually does at each rung.

TABLE: THE ALERT LADDER

STATE	TRIGGER	WARDEN BEHAVIOR
Unaware	start of most missions	standing posture — posts and patrol routes; no Directives
Suspicious	Noise at threshold (default 3), or an unresolved sighting	nearest element investigates newest Noise; Blips drift toward Noise
Alerted	Noise at threshold (default 7), or clear contact	Directive card each Warden Phase; elements act by Doctrine against Known positions
ALARM	Leader/RTO with working comms spends 2 AP (auto at a fixed set; 2d10 >= 12 on manpack under fire) — or scenario fallback timer	QRF clock d6+2 turns; Blips +2 on Contact rolls; OPFOR drones launch

ALARM is a human act. Kill the leaders, cut the wire, jam the net — or it is coming.

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-NOISE-LADDER.SVG]

Unaware. The force runs on its standing posture and nothing else. Sentries stand their posts and check their arcs each Warden Phase (**Spotting** (p. 19)); Blips walk their printed routes; revealed elements execute their Doctrine's bottom line — Holding elements hold, Sweep patrols follow their waypoints. No Directives are drawn. This is the only state in which takedowns are legal (**Takedowns** (p. 21)); the window closes forever at Suspicious.

Suspicious. Something was heard, and somebody goes to look. The revealed element nearest the newest Noise source investigates it per its script — Holding sends one figure, keeping the post manned (**Holding** (p. 69)); a Sweep element re-routes toward the sound (**Sweep** (p. 69)). Every Blip abandons its route and drifts toward Noise. Still no Directives: the force is curious, not fighting. An unresolved sighting — a shape somebody reported but nobody confirmed — puts the force here regardless of the pool.

Alerted. The force is fighting. Draw a Directive every Warden Phase, and run every element's full script against Known positions (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)). **Clear contact** puts the force here instantly, whatever the pool reads: a shot fired at or by an OPFOR figure in any OPFOR element's LOS, a body found by a revealed element (**Bodies** (p. 21)), or a breach heard from an adjacent square or Zone. From Alerted on, the Warden maneuvers — and its Leaders start looking for a radio.

ALARM. The outside world has been told. The moment ALARM triggers: start the QRF clock (**The QRF Clock** (p. 68)); all Contact Table rolls take the table's printed ALARM modifier for the rest of the mission; OPFOR drone operators launch their aircraft (**The Warden's Drones** (p. 62)); searchlights, illumination, and any other scenario-listed effects switch on. From the next Warden Phase, draw two Directives instead of one. ALARM changes nothing about a script's logic — it changes what the board is about to contain.

ALARM IS A HUMAN ACT

The pool cannot trigger ALARM. **Escalating to ALARM requires a person:** an Alerted figure with the **Leader** or **RTO** trait must reach working comms — its own radio, a vehicle set, a fixed base station, a landline — and spend 2 AP on the call. At

a fixed set or landline the call succeeds automatically. On a manpack radio while under fire, it needs $2d10 \geq 12$; the attempt spends the AP either way, and a failed call may be retried on a later activation.

Everything about this rule is a target list. Kill the Leaders and RTOs first and nobody ranking is left to call. Cut the landline — an Interact (**The Quiet Game** (p. 20)) — and the fixed set is furniture. Jam the net (**Jamming** (p. 61)) and the manpack call dies in static. The Warden, for its part, plays the same list in reverse: its scripts send Leaders toward comms the moment the force is Alerted, and the TALK TO ME Directive orders every Leader to try at once.

Denial is not forever. Every scenario prints a **fallback timer** — a missed radio check-in, usually turn 8. When it expires, ALARM triggers on its own: the silence where a report should have been is the report.

THE QRF CLOCK

When ALARM triggers, roll a d6, add 2, and set the QRF clock to the total. The clock ticks down by one in step (e) of every Warden Phase — including the phase in which it started. When it reaches zero, the reaction force arrives: place it as new Blips at the board edge the scenario names (if the scenario names none, the edge nearest the last Known position), mounted, and run it by the QRF Doctrine from its first activation (**QRF** (p. 70)). QRF Blips are contacts of known character: they resolve like any Blip (**Blips** (p. 18)) but never roll on the Contact Table — they resolve into exactly the force the scenario prints.

The clock is public. Set it in the open and count it down where you can see it, because every plan you make after ALARM is a plan about that number.

ELEMENTS

An **element** is the group an OPFOR card represents — a sentry pair, a fireteam of four, an MG team, a vehicle and its crew. The card's *element* line prints the grouping. An element activates as a **group**: all its figures act during the same activation, in whatever internal order serves the script, each figure spending its own 8 AP as the script directs — most often movement plus an attack.

Activation order is nearest-threat-first. In step (d), activate revealed elements in order of their distance to the nearest Known position, closest element first, measuring from each element's nearest figure. If no position on the board is currently Known, order by distance to the last Known position, and failing that, to the newest Noise source. Break ties by the Good-Faith Clause: the order that serves the Warden best. A Directive that names an order — “Base-of-Fire elements fire before anyone moves” — overrides this sequence for the turn; run the named elements as the card directs, then the rest, nearest-first.

Held AP. Each Doctrine prints the AP its figures keep un-spent — their Overwatch (**Overwatch** (p. 14)), the ammunition of Reaction Fire (**Reaction Fire** (p. 14)). The printed number is a floor the script protects whenever its line allows: an element ends its activation holding at least that much per figure unless the turn's line or Directive forces it all out the muzzle. Remember the one asymmetry: the Warden's reactions, like all its triggers, fire only at Known figures.

An element that acted early on an Interrupt (**The Interrupt Die** (p. 13)) still activates normally in this step; the Interrupt itself runs the element's same script, with 4 AP.

When an element takes losses, the group tests and can break — that machinery belongs to **Breaking the Warden's People** (p. 44), and its fallback ladder is written into every script below. A figure that fails falls back one Doctrine step and runs the new script from then on; an element can split, each figure on its own rung.

THE SIX DOCTRINES

Every OPFOR card prints a Doctrine, and each Doctrine is a **priority list**: on the element's activation, read the lines from the top and **execute the first line whose condition is true**, spending AP as that line directs. One line per activation — a line, once taken, is the whole order. If no line's condition is true, roll a d10 on the Doctrine's **fallback table** and do what it says. If a card special and a script disagree, the card wins; if a printed **constraint** line and anything else disagree, the constraint wins (**The Directive Deck** (p. 71)).

The six scripts below are the complete set, and this is the only place in the book they appear in

full — the cards print only the Doctrine's name. Learn them from this side of the table and you will recognize them from the other.

HOLDING

Sentries, posted guards, static weapon positions. **Held AP: 4.**

Constraint: the element never moves beyond its printed objective radius — by default, 6 squares of its post.

1. **A Known enemy is in LOS** → fire the best shot the AP allows — Aimed with 4 AP or more available, otherwise Snap — from current cover. Do not move.
2. **The force is Suspicious and this element has not yet investigated** → ONE figure moves cover-to-cover toward the newest Noise source, spending at most half its AP; the rest hold.
3. **The force is Alerted and the element contains a Leader, RTO, or fixed comms not yet used** → attempt ALARM per the ladder (**ALARM Is a Human Act** (p. 67)).
4. **Otherwise** → hold position, turn facing toward the newest Noise or the nearest Known, keep all AP.

D10	FALLBACK
1-3	Hold; face the loudest thing.
4-6	Shift to better cover within 2 squares.
7-8	One figure investigates 3 squares toward the last Noise.
9-10	Comms attempt — or a signal shout: +1 Noise, and the nearest element gains this element's Suspicious focus.

Fighting a Holding element is prying a rock out of a wall. It will never chase you, and it will kill the ground it owns for as long as it stands on it — 4 held AP means a post that answers movement twice. You choose when that fight starts. It has already chosen where.

SWEEP

Patrols, search elements, clearing parties. **Held AP: 2.**

1. **A Known enemy is in LOS** → halt in cover and fire; stay halted while any Known remains in LOS.
2. **A Known position exists anywhere** → advance on-line toward it, cover-to-cover; along the way, figures with Automatic weapons rake Concealment within 8 squares — every Crew figure inside the raked area suffers the near-

miss effect (**The Attack Procedure** (p. 23)): it is Shaken, no roll, prone or not, Known or not. Raking is fire at ground, not at a target: it costs the raking figure a Snap Shot's AP, adds gunfire Noise, and neither requires nor creates a Known target.

3. **The force is Suspicious** → move toward the newest Noise source at patrol pace, Spotting from each halt.
4. **Otherwise** → follow the printed patrol route.

D10	FALLBACK
1-4	Continue the route.
5-7	Sweep the nearest Concealment area by fire.
8-10	Hold and observe one full turn.

A Sweep element is a rake dragged across the map. Hide well and hold still and it passes over you — but the brush you are lying in may get sprayed on principle, and a flinch is all it costs the Warden to find out. Shoot at it and the rake becomes a firing line that does not advance into your muzzle; it halts, fixes you, and waits for the rest of the machine.

ASSAULT

Fire teams tasked to close, SRT, marauder packs. **Held AP: 2.**

1. **An enemy is adjacent or shares a Zone** → Point Blank attacks; entering an occupied Zone follows the Entry Fight rules (**The Entry Fight** (p. 31)) — SRT stack with flashbangs.
2. **A Known enemy is within 3 squares and grenades remain** → grenade first (**Grenades & Explosives** (p. 27)), then close.
3. **A Known enemy is in LOS** → bound cover-to-cover toward the nearest, in bounds of 3 squares or less between cover; Snap Shot with remaining AP.
4. **A Known position exists out of LOS** → move toward it by the best covered route.
5. **Otherwise** → move toward the mission anchor: the objective, then the last Noise.

D10	FALLBACK
1-5	Bound forward toward the anchor.
6-8	Flank — roll a d6: odd goes left of the last Known, even goes right.
9-10	Go firm in cover this turn.

Assault is the clock on the wall of every firefight. It closes a bound at a time, throws at 3 squares, and comes through doorways in pairs, and nothing in its script tells it to stop while a Known target exists. You do not out-wait it. You break its nerve (**Breaking the Warden's People** (p. 44)) — or you win the range argument before it stops being one.

BASE-OF-FIRE

MG teams, marksmen, any element told to suppress.
Held AP: 2.

Constraint: crew-served weapons follow the full deploy and displace rules of **Crew-Served Weapons** (p. 46).

- 1. **Deployed with a Known in LOS** → Sustained Fire on the largest Known cluster (**Sustained Fire** (p. 47)) for crew-served weapons; Braced or Aimed Shots for everyone else.
- 2. **A Known is in LOS but the weapon is not deployed** → deploy now (bipod or tripod).
- 3. **No firing position** → move at most half AP toward the nearest position with LOS to a Known; deploy next activation.
- 4. **Flanked — a Known enemy within 6 squares off the gun's axis or behind it** → displace to cover away from the threat; redeploy next activation.
- 5. **Otherwise** → overwatch the widest lane toward the last Noise; keep all AP.

D10	FALLBACK
1-4	Hold and scan (keep AP).
5-7	Shift the fire lane to the next likeliest approach.
8-10	Displace 3 squares to an alternate position.

Base-of-Fire does not own squares; it owns lanes. Slow into position and murderous once set, it turns the middle of the board into arithmetic you cannot afford (**The Beaten Zone** (p. 48)). Its script prints its own defeat: line 4 is the flank it fears, and the displace it forces is the only moment the gun is just two men in the open.

CORDON

Blocking elements, checkpoints, cut-off teams. **Held AP: 4.**

Constraint: the element is assigned a route or board edge at setup and never abandons it while any Crew figure is un-exfled.

- 1. **A Crew figure in LOS is moving through or toward the assigned route** → fire; do not pursue beyond 2 squares.
- 2. **Not yet at the blocking position** → move toward the board edge or route nearest the Crew's entry or objective; occupy the chokepoint — the bridge, the cut, the gate.
- 3. **At position** → improve cover, hold all remaining AP, watch the assigned lane.

D10	FALLBACK
1-5	Hold the position.
6-8	Shift 2 squares to a better chokepoint on the same route.
9-10	One figure moves to link up visually with the nearest friendly element.

A Cordon element is not fighting you; it is fighting your Exfil. It will watch a firefight kill its friends and not move, because its script knows what you know: the mission ends at a map edge (**Running Missions** (p. 81)), and you will arrive at that edge late, loud, and carrying someone. Fight it early or fight it then.

QRF

Reaction forces, arriving on the QRF clock after ALARM. **Held AP: 2.**

Constraint: arrives mounted at the edge the scenario names — else the edge nearest the last Known.

- 1. **Off-board and the QRF clock expires** → enter mounted at the designated edge; drive toward the last Known position at road speed (**Driving** (p. 53)).
- 2. **Mounted within 8 squares of the last Known** → halt in cover or defilade and dismount — one figure per activation from an MRAP, all at once from open vehicles (**Getting In and Getting Out** (p. 53)); the vehicle's weapon overwatches.
- 3. **Dismounted** → split the element: the half with the heaviest weapon acts as Base-of-Fire, the rest as Assault. Run each half by its own script from now on.

D10	FALLBACK
1-4	Press the assault line.
5-7	Suppress the last Known position.
8-10	Hold and attempt comms — report contact: Blips within 12 squares move toward the fight.

QRF is arithmetic with an engine. It is not a seventh kind of fight — it is a fresh Base-of-Fire and a fresh Assault, delivered to your doorstep at road speed while your ammunition is half spent. Everything you did to leaders and radios earlier in the mission was about the number on its clock.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

The Warden's intelligence is a priority list plus your good faith, and that division of labor is deliberate. Scripts are honest — you can read them, so ambushing the Sweep or baiting the Assault is real generalship, not guessing what a black box feels like today. But scripts cannot see a board, so every gap they leave is assigned to the one component that can: you, under a rule that forbids you to be kind. The result plays sharper than any flowchart we could print, because the flowchart's gaps are filled by the best enemy commander available at your table.

TARGET PRIORITY

When any script or Directive tells a figure to fire and more than one target qualifies, every Doctrine chooses the same way. Work down this list and take the first match:

1. **The Known enemy that attacked this element** since the element's last activation;
2. **the nearest Known in LOS**;
3. **the most exposed Known** — one an Open TN is available against;
4. **tie** → the candidate nearest to the element's Leader or to its objective.

Card specials modify this list where they say so — a marksman that hunts your Leaders is hunting them past line 2 — and the Good-Faith Clause settles anything the list leaves open.

Above the list stands the law that governs it: **every Warden trigger requires a Known target**. Doctrine fire, Directives, and Reaction Fire alike — an OPFOR figure never shoots at what the force does not know (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)). No exceptions, however obvious the shape in the field looks from your side of the table; this law is what makes the quiet game playable at all. Fire at ground — a raked treeline, a Beaten Zone laid on a lane — is legal because it targets no figure, and it wounds or Shakes whoever happens to be

standing in it without ever learning they were there.

Two boundary cases are already settled. A Crew figure that enters an occupied Zone is Known to the force the moment it crosses the Portal — the Entry Fight (**The Entry Fight** (p. 31)) and this law never conflict. And Known is force-wide and per figure: one Known rifleman is one target, not a revealed crew.

THE DIRECTIVE DECK

The Directive deck is the Warden's command voice: twenty-four short orders that focus the whole force for one turn. Shuffle it at setup. In step (b) of every Warden Phase at **Alerted** or worse, draw one card and apply it this turn; discard it face up — the discard pile is the Warden's visible history. If the deck runs out, reshuffle. Under **ALARM**, draw two: apply both if the force can obey both; if they are incompatible, apply the harsher — the one that, on this board, this turn, hurts the Crew more. That is a Good-Faith call and it is yours to make honestly.

A Directive is an order layered over the Doctrines, and the layering rules are strict:

- **Where the card speaks, it overrides the scripts** for the turn — GO FIRM stops every advance; DELIBERATE FIRE forbids movement outright.
- **Where the card is silent, the scripts run** — “then act normally” means exactly that.
- **A card never overrides a printed constraint.** A Holding element's objective radius, a Cordon's assigned route, the deploy rules on a crew-served weapon: constraints outrank Directives, always. A Directive that would march a Holding element off its post instead moves it to the radius' edge and no farther.
- **A card never overrides the Known law** (**Target Priority** (p. 71)). “Fire on the carriers” means the Known carriers.

Every card carries the same standing scope clause, printed here once so the cards can stay short: **“If impossible, do the closest legal thing; if nothing is legal, Go Firm — hold cover, keep maximum Reaction AP.”** An element with no legal way to obey does not idle on a technicality; it does the nearest thing a competent order-taker would.

Four cards from the deck, to show its range:

TITLE	PUSH THEM
ORDER	Assault and Sweep elements Sprint their first 3 squares toward the nearest Known position, then act normally. Base-of-Fire elements fire before anyone moves.
SCOPE	aggression

TITLE	FIX AND FLANK
ORDER	The largest element acts as Base-of-Fire this turn. The nearest other element moves against the Crew's weakest flank - the side with the fewest Crew figures.
SCOPE	maneuver

TITLE	RUSH THE WOUNDED
ORDER	Elements advance on the square of any Down Crew figure or casualty carrier. Deny the recovery. Fire on the carriers first.
SCOPE	cruelty

TITLE	FALSE CALM
ORDER	All elements hold position and cease fire this turn unless fired upon. Blips freeze. The QRF clock still ticks. (Let the players wonder.)
SCOPE	patience

Read **FIX AND FLANK** the way the Warden must: “the largest element” is counted in living figures, ties broken by the clause — the candidate whose guns hurt you more becomes the base. “The weakest flank” is the side with the fewest Crew figures, counted at the moment the card resolves. And read **FALSE CALM** as a warning about the deck’s temperament: the Warden’s patience is also an order, and a turn of silence with the QRF clock still ticking is not mercy.

Some cards interact with the roster. An ECA Officer on the board re-draws one Directive per Warden Phase and keeps the harsher — his card says so, and killing him is how you cancel the subscription (**Forces of the Fall** (p. 75)). On your side, a certain radioman’s Intercept skill lets you look at the top card once a mission and decide whether the Warden gets it (**Reading a Card** (p. 6)). The deck is a resource like any other; both sides get to play it.

THE WARDEN’S HIDDEN HAND

Blips — what they are, when they resolve, the Contact Table, surprise — belong to **Blips** (p. 18), and nothing here changes a word of it. This section is the other half: how the Warden plays them.

Movement is posture. In step ©, move every unresolved Blip: 2 squares along its printed route

while the force is Unaware; 3 squares toward the newest Noise source or the last Known position — whichever the force learned of more recently — from Suspicious up. Route the move as the Warden would (**The Good-Faith Clause** (p. 4)): the drift that cuts off a retreat is preferred to the drift that follows a parade. A Blip has no eyes, takes no reactions, and never Interrupts (**The Interrupt Die** (p. 13)); it is pressure, not a shooter. Its whole threat is where it is and what it might become.

Scripted sentries are the shown hand. The posts printed openly at setup are revealed elements from turn one — Holding elements, almost always, run by their script like anything else, with the spotting rule for eyes (**Spotting** (p. 19)). The scenario’s garrison is this pair of hands together: the sentries you can plan against, and the Blips you cannot, moving on the same ladder.

The QRF arrives as Blips. When the QRF clock expires (**The QRF Clock** (p. 68)), the reaction force enters the board as new Blip markers at its arrival edge — mounted contacts moving by the QRF script’s own line 1, at road speed, rather than at Blip walking pace. They resolve by every normal rule except the Contact Table: what they are was printed in the scenario, and the roll is skipped. Headlights on a ridge road are a Blip you already know the name of.

Directives reach Blips only when they say so. **FLARES AND WHISTLES** marches every Blip 3 squares; **FALSE CALM** freezes them. No other card moves a marker.



RUNNING THE WARDEN WELL

The procedures above run ninety percent of every mission untouched. The last tenth is seams — places where a script meets a board it never imagined — and the Good-Faith Clause exists for exactly that tenth. The craft is not inventing behavior; it is asking one question, every time: *what would a competent enemy do here, within the rules as printed?* Answer it, play it, and move on. Do not re-litigate a call after the dice land, in either direction.

Three seams, worked. How the clause resolves the gaps you will actually meet:

“Under fire,” on a manpack. An ECA Team Leader tries the ALARM call on his manpack. Is he “under fire”? The bible defines effective fire once (**Nerve Under Fire** (p. 42)): an attack roll resolved against the figure, or a blast, template, or near miss touching its square. Apply it here: if that has happened to him since his last activation, the call needs $2d10 \geq 12$; if not — you have been quiet, or shooting at someone else — the call succeeds like a fixed set. Ruling against the player means not stretching “under fire” to cover a man nobody is shooting at.

When the QRF clock starts ticking. The ALARM call succeeds in step (d), mid-phase. Does the new clock tick in this same phase’s step (e)? Yes. The clause picks the reading less favorable to you, and a clock set at 6 that reads 5 by the End Phase is that reading. Set it the moment the call succeeds; tick it with everything else.

“The largest element,” tied. FIX AND FLANK, and two four-figure elements tie for largest. The script cannot count past the tie; you can. The element with the machine gun, the better lane, the position you least want pouring Sustained Fire — that one is the base. The tie always breaks toward the board hurting you most.

A COMPLETE WARDEN PHASE

EXAMPLE

The fuel point, turn 5. The mission went loud in turn 4 — Vasquez’s burst across the gate was clear contact, and the force is **Alerted**. The board: a wire-fenced ECA fuel point on a crossroads. The Warden’s force — its cards are in **Forces of the Fall** (p. 75) — is four revealed elements and one marker. A **sentry pair** (Holding) mans the sandbagged gate. An **MG team** (Base-of-Fire) is deployed on the loading dock, bipod down, one Sustained Fire action already spent from its belt. A **fireteam** — Team Leader and three Riflemen (Sweep) — is coming back in from patrol, behind the tank farm, no LOS to anything Known. The **command element** — an Officer and his RTO (Holding) — is at the office, a fixed radio set inside. **Blip 3** is somewhere north, unresolved. The Crew: Vasquez and Okafor are **Known**, behind a culvert and a stock tank 9 squares from the gate — both fired last turn, and Okafor is prone. Ledford is Unknown, prone in the fence-line brush on the Sweep’s path. Pham is Unknown in the ditch behind, holding 4 AP. The Noise pool reads 11 after the Crew Phase (8 carried in, +3 from gunfire at the cap — **The Noise Pool** (p. 17)).

(a) **Bookkeeping.** Pool 11 against thresholds of 3 and 7: **Alerted**, already marked since turn 4’s clear contact. No change; the pool cannot reach ALARM on its own (**ALARM Is a Human Act** (p. 67)).

(b) **Directive.** The force is **Alerted**: draw one. **FALSE CALM** — “All elements hold position and cease fire this turn unless fired upon. Blips freeze. The QRF clock still ticks.” But the Officer is alive, and his card re-draws one Directive per Warden Phase, keeping the harsher. The re-draw is **PUSH THEM** — “Assault and Sweep elements Sprint their first 3 squares toward the nearest Known position, then act normally. Base-of-Fire elements fire before anyone moves.” Which is harsher? Good faith answers from the board: the Crew is bloodied and close, and a turn of pressure hurts more than a turn of quiet. **PUSH THEM stands**. **FALSE CALM** goes face up on the discard.

© **Blips move.** The force is past Suspicious, so Blip 3 moves 3 squares toward the last thing the force learned — the Known culvert — angling, per good faith, toward the crossroads that also happens to be the Crew’s way home. It ends far from any Crew LOS: unresolved, still a rumor.

(d) **Elements act.** **PUSH THEM** sets the order: Base-of-Fire fires before anyone moves. After that, nearest-threat-first (**Elements** (p. 68)).

The MG team (Base-of-Fire, line 1: deployed, Known in LOS). Sustained Fire (**Sustained Fire** (p. 47)) on the largest Known cluster — Vasquez and Okafor, both

inside one 2×4 template. The Gunner lays the Beaten Zone with its near edge on the culvert, rolls one attack at the sustained TN of 11, no Cover TN — the BZ ignores the culvert's low cover along its axis. **2d10: 6 and 7 — 13.** Success: every figure in the zone takes a hit at DR 4. Vasquez: Hit Location **d10 = 9**, Legs; Severity **d10 = 2**, +4, -0 armor = 6 — a **Light** wound: Shaken, -2 max AP, Bleed 1, and no Sprint on that leg (**Resolving a Hit** (p. 36)). Okafor: Location **d10 = 4**, Torso, no plates; Severity **d10 = 1**, +4 = 5 — **Light**: Shaken, -2 max AP, Bleed 1. The zone's other clause — everyone in it Shaken unless prone — adds nothing: Okafor is prone and Vasquez is already Shaken by the wound. The BZ marker stays on the board: crossing it now costs double AP and an attack at TN 13 per square (**The Beaten Zone** (p. 48)). Second belt action spent; one remains. The team ends holding its script's 2 AP.

The gate sentries (Holding — nearest element, 9 squares from the Known pair). Line 1: a Known enemy in LOS. Each fires the best shot 8 AP allows — Aimed, 4 AP — and note what line 1 quietly costs the Warden: these two have a landline, and their ALARM line is line 3, but the script executes the *first* true line only. Gunfire trumps the phone call. Target priority: Vasquez fired at this element last turn — priority 1 (**Target Priority** (p. 71)). Both shoot Aimed at Vasquez behind the culvert, Cover TN 14 on their 12/14 line. **Sentry one, 2d10: 8 and 5 — 13.** Miss. **Sentry two: 6 and 5 — 11.** Miss — the culvert holds. Each ends holding 4 AP: the gate will answer movement twice before your next turn ends.

The fireteam (Sweep, behind the tank farm). PUSH THEM first: all four Sprint their first 3 squares toward the nearest Known position — four Sprints, +4 Noise, pool 15. (Their gunfire, when it comes, adds nothing: the +3 turn cap on gunfire Noise is already paid.) Then act normally: no LOS to a Known from the tank farm's shadow, so line 1 fails and **line 2** runs — a Known position exists, advance on-line toward it, cover-to-cover, raking Concealment within 8 squares along the way. The fence-line brush is on the axis at 6 squares. Two Riflemen rake it as they bound — a Snap Shot's AP each, no roll, no target: fire at ground. Ledford is lying in that brush. He suffers the near-miss effect: **Shaken**, prone or not — and still Unknown; the Warden sprayed a treeline, not a man. Each figure ends its bound behind cover holding 2 AP. Pham, watching the line cross her arc, could take Reaction Fire — and does not. Her shot would make her Known (**Known and Unknown** (p. 20)), and a pistol at 10 squares is a bad price for that.

The command element (Holding, at the office, farthest). Line 1: no Known in LOS from the office —

false. Line 2: force is not Suspicious — false. **Line 3: the force is Alerted and the element contains a Leader, an RTO, and a fixed set not yet used — attempt ALARM.** The RTO spends 2 AP at the base station: automatic. **ALARM.** Roll the QRF clock: **d6 = 4**, +2 — **the clock is set at 6.** From this moment, Contact rolls take the ALARM modifier and the scenario's floodlights come on; the fuel point has no drone team, so that line stays empty. Next Warden Phase, the deck yields two cards. The Officer holds his remaining AP behind the office wall — line 3 was the element's whole order.

(e) **Clocks tick.** One clock is running. The QRF clock ticks in the phase it started (**Running the Warden Well** (p. 72)): 6 → 5.

That is the phase, and no one decided anything except the dice, the scripts — each line cited above by number — and three good-faith calls: a harsher card, a Blip's drift, a tie that never came up. The End Phase will mark Vasquez's and Okafor's Bleed (**Bleed** (p. 37)). Read the board the way the Warden now reads it: two Known and bleeding behind a culvert with a live Beaten Zone across their line of retreat, a Sweep line one bound from a Shaken man it does not know it has found, a gate holding eight AP of reactions, and headlights six minutes out. Your move.

The scripts are the enemy's skeleton. The next chapter is its flesh: who these people are, faction by faction, card by card — **Forces of the Fall** (p. 75).

FORCES OF THE FALL

First page of the crew's threat ledger, a school composition book with the district map taped inside the cover, Vasquez's hand: "Four kinds of trouble. The Authority, which is a payroll. The Corps, which is a grudge with a rifle. The Compact, which is a toll booth. The Ferryman, which is a price. And marauders, which are weather. Learn the difference at a distance, because the difference is the plan: you outwait a payroll, outnerve a grudge, outtalk a toll booth, outbid a price — and you get out of the weather." Beneath it, Deacon's capitals: AND YOU NEVER FIGHT TWO OF THEM AT ONCE ON PURPOSE.

The last chapter was the enemy's skeleton — the scripts every element runs (**The Enemy System** (p. 66)). This chapter is the flesh: the four powers that field those elements, what their people are like, how their units combine, and every enemy card in the game, faction by faction. Read it as the crew reads its ledger — not to admire the enemy, but to pick, at two hundred meters, which fight you are in.

READING AN ENEMY CARD

Enemy cards are deliberately lean — a statline and a script reference, no biography (**Reading a Card** (p. 6)). Every field on one is a handle into a procedure you already know:

- **Shoot Open/Cover** — the two TNs the figure attacks with, chosen by your cover exactly as yours are (**Open or In Cover** (p. 9), **The Attack Procedure** (p. 23)).
- **Grit** — what the figure rolls against when its group breaks: half the element down, or its Leader dead (**Breaking the Warden's People** (p. 44)).
- **Armor** — subtracted straight off the Casualty Die when you hit it (**The Enemy's Ledger: the Casualty Die** (p. 40)).
- **Doctrine** — the script the element runs every Warden Phase (**The Six Doctrines** (p. 68)). *Per element* means the scenario assigns it at setup.
- **Weapon** — a profile from the arsenal (**The Arsenal** (p. 25)); its DR is the Casualty Die's other half when the figure hits you.
- **Special** — the one rule that makes this unit itself. A special overrides the general rule

wherever they disagree.

- **Element** — the grouping the card fights in, which is the unit the Warden activates and the unit that tests morale (**Elements** (p. 68)).

Blips resolve into these cards too: when the Contact Table names a "patrol pair" or a "fireteam" (**Blips** (p. 18)), the scenario's faction tells you which cards to deal and the card's element line tells you how they stand. That is the whole literacy. Everything below is who carries the cards.

THE AUTHORITY

INTSUM. The Emergency Continuity Authority is a payroll, a fuel ledger, and a chain of command that still believes in itself. Its professional core is real — career soldiers and federal officers who never left their posts — and it fights like a bureaucracy that has read its own manuals: sentry pairs on fixed comms, patrols on schedules, machine guns sited where the map says they should be, and a reporting culture that treats the radio as a weapon system. Its people are adequately trained, adequately armored, and genuinely disciplined; they hold under fire that would scatter anyone else in the valley. Their weakness is structural, not personal. Everything runs on the leader, the RTO, and the schedule — cut those and the remainder is well-drilled men waiting for instructions that are not coming. The Authority does not avenge its dead tonight; it files them, and comes back with more of everything. Assume every fight you start with the ECA is being written down.

In the field. The ECA fights as a system of mutually supporting elements: sentry pairs (Holding) screen an objective, an MG team (Base-of-Fire) owns the widest lane, fireteams of four sweep or assault as tasked, and a command element — Officer and RTO — sits on fixed comms and runs the Directive deck harder than anyone (**The Directive Deck** (p. 71)). Unaware, it is all posts and patrol schedules you can time. Suspicious, a single figure walks out to look while the posts stay manned. Alerted, the fireteams maneuver against your Known positions under Directives while the Leaders reach for the net — and ALARM is what

the ECA is *for*: an SRT team or mounted QRF on the clock, drones up, the whole board tightening (**The QRF Clock** (p. 68)). Priorities against them never change: Leaders, RTOs, the AG on the gun. The Rifleman's discipline forgives one failed morale test a mission (**Breaking the Warden's People** (p. 44)); nothing forgives the element that loses its radio.

ECA RIFLEMAN

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	11/13
GRIT	9
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	per element
WEAPON	carbine
SPECIAL	Disciplined - ignores the first failed group-morale test each mission.
ELEMENT	fireteam of 4 with eca-team-leader

ECA TEAM LEADER

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	11/13
GRIT	8
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	per element
WEAPON	carbine
SPECIAL	Leader. Manpack radio - may attempt ALARM (2d10 >= 12).
ELEMENT	leads a fireteam

ECA MG TEAM (GUNNER + AG)

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	11/13
GRIT	9
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	Base-of-Fire
WEAPON	mmg
SPECIAL	Full crew-served rules (ch. 9). AG killed - loses Beaten Zone.
ELEMENT	pair

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-CSW-ROLES.SVG]

ECA SENTRY

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	12/14
GRIT	10
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	Holding
WEAPON	carbine
SPECIAL	Fixed post with landline - ALARM attempt is automatic if Alerted at post.
ELEMENT	pair at scripted positions

ECA MARKSMAN

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	10/12
GRIT	9
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	Holding
WEAPON	hunting-rifle
SPECIAL	Scoped. Prioritizes Crew Leaders and the MMG Gunner over nearest.
ELEMENT	single, paired with a sentry post

ECA OFFICER

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	11/13
GRIT	8
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	per element
SPECIAL	Leader. While alive, re-draw one Directive per Warden Phase (take the harsher).
WEAPON	pistol
ELEMENT	command element with RTO

ECA RTO

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	12/14
GRIT	9
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	per element
WEAPON	carbine
SPECIAL	Fixed-set comms - automatic ALARM attempt while at the command post.
ELEMENT	with officer

SRT OPERATOR

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	9/11
GRIT	8
ARMOR	2
DOCTRINE	Assault
WEAPON	carbine
SPECIAL	Elite - group morale at -2. Enters Zones with flashbangs (defenders do not fire first).
ELEMENT	team of 4, QRF/ALARM asset

ECA DRONE OPERATOR

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	13/15
GRIT	10
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	Holding
WEAPON	pistol
SPECIAL	Runs one recon quad or fiber FPV per Warden Phase (ch. 11). Kill him to ground it.
ELEMENT	pair with eca-rto

The marksman deserves a margin note: his special rewrites target priority (**Target Priority** (p. 71)) — he is hunting your Leaders and your Gunner past every nearer target, which makes him the one enemy on the board whose priorities mirror yours. The drone operator is not a rifleman at all; he is the Warden's supply line for Known (**The Warden's Drones** (p. 62)), and his card says the counter out loud: kill him and the aircraft lands. The SRT team is the elite exception to everything: Assault Doctrine, flashbang entries that take the Entry Fight away from you (**The Entry Fight** (p. 31)), morale at a level that means they mostly do not break — they arrive with ALARM, and they are the argument for making sure ALARM never gets called.

THE CIVIL ORDER CORPS

INTSUM. The Corps is the Authority's local auxiliary: neighbors who signed on for rations, requisition shares, or the pleasure of a uniform, led by bosses who were owed favors before the Fracture and collect them at gunpoint now. They are numerous, poorly trained, and unevenly brave — jumpy at first blood, vicious when the odds run their way, and led by men whose cruelty is a

management technique. The ECA uses them the way you would expect: checkpoints, cordons, and bodies for the sweeps its professionals are too few to walk. Do not confuse cheap with harmless. A Corps squad is six rifles, it knows your face, and its boss keeps it in the fight well past the moment its nerve is gone.

In the field. Corps squads of six fight under a Boss, usually as Cordon or Sweep — the ECA gives them the ground it can afford to lose. Unaware they are lazy posts and shortcut patrols; Suspicious they investigate in a bunch, because nobody wants to walk toward the noise alone; Alerted they are a lot of Snap Shots and a Boss shouting his squad's spine straight; and under ALARM their technicals mount the heaviest gun the faction owns and arrive as cut-rate QRF (**QRF** (p. 70)) — read the technical's card before you cheer, because an HMG does not care who is holding it (**The Heavy Machine Gun** (p. 50)). Their morale is glass with a reroll behind it — see the worked example below — and the whole faction's hinge is the Boss: while he lives the squad rerolls its failures; drop him and the same squad takes a Leader-death test with no net (**Breaking the Warden's People** (p. 44)).

CIVIL ORDER CORPSMAN

FACTION	civil-order
SHOOT	13/15
GRIT	11
ARMOR	0
DOCTRINE	per element
WEAPON	carbine
SPECIAL	Jumpy - the first casualty in the element forces an immediate group-morale test.
ELEMENT	squads of 6 with coc-boss

COC BOSS

FACTION	civil-order
SHOOT	12/14
GRIT	10
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	per element
WEAPON	battle-rifle
SPECIAL	Leader. Cruel - while alive, Corpsmen reroll failed morale once.
ELEMENT	leads a squad

COC TECHNICAL CREW

FACTION	civil-order
SHOOT	13/15
GRIT	11
ARMOR	0
DOCTRINE	QRF
WEAPON	hmg
SPECIAL	Mounted HMG (vehicle rules ch. 10). Bails on a Mobility hit unless the Boss is aboard.
ELEMENT	technical + 3 crew

EXAMPLE

First blood at the low bridge. A Corps squad — six Corpsmen and a Boss, Sweep Doctrine — is working the creek line when Ledford's rifle takes the point man off his feet: **Down**. The Corpsmen card's Jumpy special triggers on the element's first casualty: an immediate group-morale test, every survivor rolling 2d10 against its own Grit (**Breaking the Warden's People** (p. 44)). The five Corpsmen need 11: they roll 13, 6, 10, 16, 9 — two hold, three fail. The Boss needs his 10 and rolls 12 — he holds, and his Cruel special lets the Corpsmen reroll their failures once while he lives: the 6 rerolls to 14, the 9 to 11 — saved — but the 10 rerolls to 8. One Corpsmen falls back a Doctrine step; Sweep is off the ladder, so he drops to Holding and goes firm behind the bridge rail while his squad walks on without him (**The Six Doctrines** (p. 68)). One rifle shot, one man down, one man quit. Now consider what the same shot does tomorrow, aimed at the Boss.

THE COMPACT

INTSUM. The Compact is what county militias become when they federate into a business: protection, tolls, and boundary-keeping, enforced by men who hunted these ridges before any of this and will hunt them after. They are not an army and do not fight like one — no fixed posts to speak of, no radios worth jamming, just bands of four to six who move through timber like they own it, because in every sense that matters they do. The Compact is not looking for your war. It is looking for its cut, its border respected, and its name said carefully. It will trade, it will parley, and it will kill you with patience if you make either impossible. Treat every Compact contact as a negotiation that has not yet picked its language.

In the field. Compact bands favor Sweep and Cordon on their own ground — they patrol what

they tax and block what they do not — and their Woods-wise special cuts your eyes, not theirs: every Concealment spotting distance against a Compact figure or Blip is halved, so the concealed contact you would resolve at six squares is, when it is Compact, at three before you make it out (**Blips** (p. 18), **Spotting** (p. 19)). Their ladder tops out low. A Compact board is timber and hollows, not radio nets: with no RTOs and no fixed sets, most Compact scenarios can reach ALARM only through the fallback timer — a band overdue at the store — and what ALARM summons is not a QRF column but the rest of the family, entering as Blips wherever the scenario says the ridge paths run. Their Headmen carry the faction's real weapon instead: parley. Where a scenario allows it, a contact becomes an Interact and a contest of Grit instead of a firefight — a door the ECA never offers, on the terms the scenario prints. Their morale is a professional's (**Breaking the Warden's People** (p. 44)): they break like men with somewhere better to be, and a band that quits tonight has not forgotten you exist.

COMPACT FIGHTER

FACTION	compact
SHOOT	12/14
GRIT	10
ARMOR	0
DOCTRINE	per element
WEAPON	battle-rifle
SPECIAL	Woods-wise - Concealment spotting distances against them are halved.
ELEMENT	bands of 4-6

COMPACT HEADMAN

FACTION	compact
SHOOT	11/13
GRIT	9
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	per element
WEAPON	carbine
SPECIAL	Leader. Negotiator - some scenarios allow parley (Interact, Grit-off) instead of contact.
ELEMENT	leads a band

THE FERRYMEN

INTSUM. The Ferrymen move things: fuel, medicine, ammunition, people, and information, across every line on the district map, for anyone whose payment clears. They are a network, not a

territory — crossings, cutouts, and couriers — and their gunhands are exactly what the name says: hired security for cargo, paid to make robbery expensive rather than to win wars. A Ferryman escort fights briskly, professionally, and only as long as the arithmetic favors the payroll; heroism is not in the contract. Some missions they are your vendor, some missions your target, and the network remembers which you were. Of the valley's four powers they are the only one you can simply *buy* — and the only one whose grudge follows you into the campaign's ledgers rather than onto the board.

In the field. Gunhands work in escort pairs, Holding around whatever they are paid to keep — a crossing, a cache, a truck (**Holding** (p. 69)). Their submachine guns are close-work weapons that lose no TN inside Zones, so pry them out of buildings with grenades and angles, not doorways (**The Entry Fight** (p. 31)). Their alert behavior barely climbs the ladder: Unaware they watch the cargo, Suspicious they pull in tighter around it — a Holding element's investigating figure never wanders far from the pay — and Alerted they fight from cover exactly as long as the arithmetic holds. No Ferryman ever calls a QRF that does not exist; when a Ferryman scenario has an ALARM worth the name, it is usually a signal to move the cargo, not reinforce it, and the mission clock is what tightens. Their card carries their whole soul — paid, not devoted: at half casualties the element routs automatically, no test (**Rout** (p. 44)). Kill one and his partner is already leaving.

FERRYMAN GUNHAND

FACTION	ferryman
SHOOT	12/14
GRIT	10
ARMOR	0
DOCTRINE	Holding
WEAPON	smg
SPECIAL	Paid, not devoted - routs at half casualties automatically.
ELEMENT	escort pairs

MARAUDERS

INTSUM. Marauders are transient predators — packs of five to eight built around a chief, feeding along the roads and the softest farms, moving on when a place is chewed through. They hold nothing, garrison nothing, and answer to nothing;

a marauder contact is weather, not policy. What makes them dangerous is that they do not fight like anyone else in this book: no posts, no comms, no fallback plan — just a shotgun rush that arrives all at once, at close range, screaming. What makes them survivable is the same fact. The pack's whole cohesion is the chief's presence, and its nerve is the worst in the valley; marauders break early, break hard, and do not rally, because nothing but momentum was holding them together. Fear them inside six squares. Bury them with distance, discipline, and one well-chosen bullet.

In the field. Marauders run Assault, always, and their Frenzied special turns every Directive into the same order: Sprint at the Known (**Assault** (p. 69)). There is no alert ladder to speak of with a pack on the board — Unaware they are already moving, Alerted they are merely louder, and there is no QRF because there is no one to call. The pack's arithmetic is printed on two cards: group morale at +2 means every test sheds bodies (**Breaking the Warden's People** (p. 44)), and the Chief's card ends the fight outright — the pack routs when he dies, full stop. Against marauders, target priority is a one-name list.

MARAUDER

FACTION	marauder
SHOOT	13/15
GRIT	12
ARMOR	0
DOCTRINE	Assault
WEAPON	shotgun
SPECIAL	Group morale at +2 (breaks easily). Frenzied - Sprints toward Known at every Directive.
ELEMENT	packs of 5-8

MARAUDER CHIEF

FACTION	marauder
SHOOT	12/14
GRIT	10
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	Assault
WEAPON	battle-rifle
SPECIAL	Leader. The pack routs when he dies, full stop.
ELEMENT	leads a pack

ASSEMBLING THE ENEMY

The *element* line on each card is the faction's building block, and scenarios assemble garrisons from those blocks: ECA fireteams of four under a

Team Leader, sentry pairs, a two-man gun team, an Officer-and-RTO command element; Corps squads of six under a Boss; Compact bands of four to six under a Headman; Ferrymen escort pairs; marauder packs of five to eight under a Chief. When a card's Doctrine reads *per element*, the scenario assigns the script at setup — the same four riflemen are a Sweep patrol in one mission and an Assault team in another. Leaders matter twice over in that arithmetic: the card that leads an element is also the figure whose death forces its group test (**Breaking the Warden's People** (p. 44)), which is why every faction's block is written around one man you can name.

Each faction leans on the ladder differently, and you can read a scenario's temperament from its roster. An ECA garrison is Holding and Base-of-Fire wrapped around an objective, Sweep patrols on its clock, and an Assault or QRF fist behind the ALARM it will spend the whole mission trying to call. The Corps mans Cordons and sweeps in numbers, because numbers are what it has. The Compact sweeps and blocks its own borders and would rather talk than test its morale table. Ferrymen hold points and cut losses. Marauders assault, only and always — the one force in the game with nothing worth defending, which is exactly what makes them immune to half your tricks: no leaders to isolate but one, no comms to cut, no post to slip past. Mixed boards happen, and the factions are not allies: a scenario that puts the Corps and the Compact on the same map will

say who shoots at whom, and the Warden runs each force on its own ladder as the sheet directs. Building your own garrisons — points, budgets, and the density Heat buys — is the Mission Architect's business (**Mission Architect** (p. 105)), and the campaign's Heat track decides how much of the Authority's attention your valley has earned (**The Long War** (p. 84)).

DESIGNER'S NOTE

No faction in this book has an ideology, and that is load-bearing. The Authority is continuity of government that never gave anything back; the Corps is opportunism in a uniform; the Compact is a toll; the Ferrymen are a price; marauders are appetite. Nobody says left or right, ever — partly so the table stays open to anyone, but mostly because the game is about something more durable than a platform: what occupation is, procedurally — checkpoints, censuses, requisitions, informers — and what it costs neighbors to refuse it. The moment a faction stands for a position, the player is invited to argue with the faction instead of the fact. The fact is the checkpoint. The argument is the mission.

You now hold both halves of the enemy: the scripts and the people who run them. The chapters ahead put them on a map with something worth taking — **Running Missions** (p. 81) builds the mission around you, and **Pineland Burning** (p. 93) is where the valley starts proving its motto.

RUNNING MISSIONS

From the mission book — a graph-ruled composition book that lives in the church belfry and travels in a bread bag — the entry for the second of October, Vasquez’s hand: WHAT: the fuel point on the crossing. WHY: winter is a number of gallons and we are short. WHO: five. One long gun. Doc. IN: the creek culvert, last dark. OUT: the ford. The truck waits at the ford until moonset, and after moonset the truck is a rumor. Beneath it, block capitals, the line Deacon has written under every plan since Mackall: PLAN THE EXFIL FIRST. THE OBJECTIVE IS HOW WE SPEND THE NIGHT. THE FORD IS WHETHER WE GET ANOTHER ONE.

Everything before this chapter happens inside a turn. This chapter is the frame around the turns: what a scenario hands you, how it goes onto the table, how it ends, and what it pays. The missions themselves live in **Pineland Burning** (p. 93), and the toolkit for building your own lives in **Mission Architect** (p. 105) — both assume you run their frames exactly as this chapter states them. What a mission costs and earns across weeks is the next chapter’s business (**The Long War** (p. 84)); this one is the night itself.

MISSION ANATOMY

Every mission — scripted or built — has the same four-part frame.

The briefing. The scenario sheet is the mission’s contract, and it prints everything the frame needs: the map and its season notes; the objectives; the Warden’s order of battle — scripted sentries, Blips and their routes, the Contact Table, Doctrines and any Directive changes; the Alert thresholds, starting Noise, and fallback timer (**The Alert Ladder** (p. 67)); the Insertion; the Exfil and its Deadline; the mission’s Supply cost; and the aftermath block that scores it all (**Aftermath** (p. 83)). Read the whole sheet before setup. The Warden hides nothing but what the Blips hide.

Insertion. Where the Crew starts: a board edge or a marked point, printed per scenario. Intel spends can move it or soften what waits past it (**Intel & Insertion** (p. 82)).

Objectives. The **primary objective** is the mission — the sheet states it as a testable fact (*the*

transformer is destroyed; the prisoner is off the board with the Crew; the convoy exits the east edge).

Opportunity objectives are optional work the sheet prices separately: a safe worth opening, a cache worth hauling, a name worth photographing. Take them when the night allows. No opportunity objective is worth a name on the memorial page, and the aftermath arithmetic is built so that this stays true.

Exfil. A marked point or edge, and a Deadline. The mission does not end when the objective does; it ends at the Exfil, under the one rule this chapter exists to state (**The Exfil Rule** (p. 82)).

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-MISSION-ANATOMY.SVG]

SETTING UP

Set up every mission in the same order:

1. **Lay the map.** Build or unfold the printed board and apply the sheet’s terrain and season notes — late LEAF SEASON scenarios thin the Concealment as the leaves come down, and the sheet says exactly where.
2. **Place the mission.** Objective markers, caches, vehicles, civilians, and the Exfil marker, per the sheet.
3. **Post the sentries.** Scripted sentries go on the board openly, at their printed posts and facings (**Blips** (p. 18)).
4. **Seed the Blips.** Numbered markers at their printed positions, patrol routes noted, the scenario’s Contact Table beside the board.
5. **Set the ladder.** Note the Alert thresholds, set the Noise pool to the sheet’s starting value, and note the fallback timer. The force starts Unaware unless the sheet says otherwise.
6. **Set the clocks.** Turn marker at 1; mark the **Exfil Deadline** — the turn limit, usually turn 12.
7. **Spend intel.** Declare any pre-mission network flips now (**Intel & Insertion** (p. 82)).
8. **Pick the lineup and pay for it.** Choose the mission’s crew from the roster (**The Roster** (p.

and build each figure's loadout from the gear pool — a weapon, armor, and two slots of kit (**Reading a Card** (p. 6)). Then pay the mission's Supply bill (2. **Resupply** (p. 87)): the sheet's base cost, plus the printed Supply cost of every item fielded. Rifle Plates cost 2 Supply the night they go out; the recon quad costs 2; a bare rifle and a knife cost nothing beyond the base.

9. **Insert.** Place the Crew at the Insertion, any facings, and begin turn 1.

INTEL & INSERTION

The network is the difference between arriving and being expected. Each spend below **flips one asset from Hidden to Exposed** — the pools, the assets, and what exposure risks are all owned by **The Network** (p. 85); this section is only when the spends happen and what they buy the night.

Declared at setup (step 7):

- **Move the Insertion** (Underground). Start at any alternate Insertion the sheet marks, or shift along the printed edge. Forged passes and a borrowed delivery route put you where the patrol schedule says you cannot be.
- **Reveal a Blip** (Underground). Pre-resolve one Blip of your choice: roll its Contact now and place the result face up. Sometimes the best intelligence is *it's a dog*.
- **A Guerrilla team** (Guerrilla, paid with Capability — **The Network** (p. 85)). Two to four fighters join the lineup for this mission, entering at the Insertion with the Crew unless the sheet says otherwise.
- **An extra gear slot** (Auxiliary). One figure carries three slots tonight; a courier met you at the fence with the rest.

Declared in play, the moment they matter:

- **Reroll a Contact roll** (Underground). Once, reroll a just-rolled Contact Table result — take the second roll.
- **Delay ALARM** (Underground). Once, when an ALARM call would succeed, it fails instead — the frequency was changed, the duty officer was bought, the line was already slack (**ALARM Is a Human Act** (p. 67)).
- **Extend the Exfil** (Auxiliary). Declare before the Deadline turn's End Phase completes: the

Deadline moves 2 turns later. The truck waits, and somebody will answer for it.

One more Auxiliary spend — off-board medical — is made after the mission, where the recovery roll needs it (1. **Recover** (p. 86)).

THE EXFIL RULE

The Exfil is a marked point or board edge. A Crew figure there may spend 1 AP of movement to step off the board: remove the figure — it is **out**, and it may not return. A carried Down figure exits with its carrier (**Carrying the Fallen** (p. 40)). A restrained prisoner exits with an adjacent escort (**Surrender & Prisoners** (p. 44)). Support units exit like Crew. Whatever a figure carries off the board — loot, belts, a body — comes home; everything else stays.

The mission ends the moment no living Crew figure remains on the board, or when the Deadline turn's End Phase completes — whichever comes first.

Anyone not out is lost. Not delayed, not “next scene” — lost, along with everything they carry. Whether the lost are captured or dead is the campaign's decision, made in the Recover step (1. **Recover** (p. 86)); the mission itself only knows they did not reach the ford. There is no CASEVAC and no second truck (**Carrying the Fallen** (p. 40)): a Down neighbor is carried to the Exfil or they are gone.

A mission may always be scrubbed — walk everyone out before the primary is done. The aftermath prices failure, and it prices an empty seat at the ford far higher. Scrubbing early, everyone breathing, is not the game punishing you. It is the game working.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

The Exfil rule is borrowed from every underground that ever fought without a rear area — the Maquis version is the bluntest: whoever missed the rendezvous was mourned, because there was nothing else to do with them. Mechanically it is the keystone under half this book. The Deadline is what makes Noise arithmetic, the QRF clock, and a Cordon element's patience mean anything; the anyone-not-out clause is what makes the carry rule and the Rapport ledger bite. A mission you can leave at leisure is a shooting gallery. One that closes like a door behind you is a raid.

AFTERMATH

Score the mission immediately, while the table still remembers it, in this order:

1. **Outcomes.** Read each objective as the testable fact the sheet stated: complete or not. Partial credit exists only where the sheet prints it.
2. **Campaign deltas.** Apply the Rapport, Heat, and Capability movements printed in the sheet's aftermath block for each outcome — the tracks themselves are defined in **The Three Tracks** (p. 85). Then apply the standing riders, which stack with anything the sheet prints: the mission ended under ALARM, **Heat +1**; each Crew body left on the board, **Rapport -1**; each restrained prisoner abandoned, **Rapport -1**; each civilian hit by Crew fire during the mission, **Rapport -2**.
3. **Loot and Supply recovery.** Add the sheet's printed Supply awards for what was actually carried out. Looted weapons and kit carried off the board enter the gear pool; captured arms hauls raise Capability where the sheet says so.
4. **The lost.** List every figure that did not exit, with their state when the board ended — dead, Down, or hale. The Recover step resolves them (**1. Recover** (p. 86)).
5. **Log it.** Mission, date, outcomes, deltas, the lost, and one honest sentence about what went wrong. Then put the board away and open the between-mission sequence (**Between Missions** (p. 86)).

EXAMPLE

Moonset at the ford. Turn 11 of the depot raid. The sheet prints an Exfil Deadline of turn 12, and the mission has run under ALARM since turn 8 — the Officer's call beat the crew to the radio room. The Exfil is the ford on the southwest edge. Tanya Okafor went Down on turn 10 — Critical, stabilized by Pham the same turn, so the clock is stopped but she must be carried (**Carrying the Fallen** (p. 40)). Boone lifts her; his Strong Back skill spares him the half-AP penalty, but both hands are full either way, and the MMG stays in the fence grass where he set it down. Nothing brings that gun home tonight except a figure with a free pair of hands, and there isn't one.

Vasquez crosses the ford on turn 11 and steps off — 1 AP, out. Boone follows on turn 12 with Okafor on his shoulders; Pham walks off beside them with the courier bag. Birdy is not with them. The QRF's Cordon element took the road bridge on turn 10 (**Cordon** (p. 70)), and the long way around it is fourteen squares when the End Phase of turn 12 completes. The mission is over. Birdy is lost — alive when the board ended, and what that means now belongs to the campaign (**1. Recover** (p. 86)).

The aftermath, in order. *Outcomes:* the primary — the depot's fuel burns — was completed on turn 7; the opportunity objective, the dispatch office safe, was never touched. *Deltas:* the sheet's aftermath block prints Rapport +1 and Heat +1 for the primary — a fire that size is a loud win. Riders: the mission ended under ALARM, Heat +1 again. No bodies and no prisoners were abandoned, and no civilian was hit. *Loot:* the courier bag is the sheet's loot line — +2 Supply. The MMG comes off the gear pool's ledger, and Birdy's binoculars go where she goes. *The lost:* one name, alive at the end. The Recover step will take her captured — Heat +1 more when it does — and a lockup two counties north goes into the campaign log as unfinished business.

Net: Rapport +1, Heat +3 by the time the Recover step is done, Supply +2, one gun gone, one nineteen-year-old gone. The fuel burned for an hour. The arithmetic is what keeps burning.

The night is scored; the weeks between nights are the other half of the game. The campaign — the roster, the tracks, the network, and the sequence that turns one mission into the next — is **The Long War** (p. 84).

THE LONG WAR

The last pages of the mission book are ruled into columns, Vance's hand, a different ink for every week: Wells cleaned: 2. Funerals: 1 — Aldridge, the pneumonia, not us. Apples up from the Tolley orchard for the school. Two new checkpoints on Route 9; they are counting again. Dogs at the substation now, the real kind. And at the very back, one page kept apart, block letters at its head: HELD IN OUR REACH — the names go here whole. First name, last name, how, and where they lie. The Authority keeps no page like this one. That is the difference, and don't let anybody tell you different.

A mission is an hour. The war is a season. This chapter owns the season: the roster your crew is drawn from, the three tracks that measure how the war is going, the network of neighbors that makes any of it possible, the sequence you run between missions, and the choices that no dice can make for you. Run it exactly as written. The campaign layer has fewer rolls than a firefight and higher stakes than any of them, because everything here persists — wounds, reputations, arrests, and the names on the back page.

THE CAMPAIGN LOOP

The campaign is a loop: play a mission (**Running Missions** (p. 81)), score its aftermath (**Aftermath** (p. 83)), then run the **between-mission sequence** (**Between Missions** (p. 86)) — one pass of that sequence is a **campaign turn**, a week or two of fictional time. The sequence ends by selecting the next mission, and the loop closes.

Not every campaign turn holds a mission. A **quiet turn** — chosen with the Lie low action, forced by an empty till, or taken so somebody can teach — runs only steps 3 through 7 of the sequence: nothing was risked, so nothing recovers and nothing is earned, but the valley keeps living, the deck keeps dealing, and the Authority keeps counting. The campaign's calendar is LEAF SEASON's: October into November, and the weather in the scenario sheets worsens whether you use the weeks or waste them.

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-CAMPAIGN-LOOP.SVG]

The whole layer lives on two play sheets from the printed set: the **campaign log** — tracks, Supply, the Advance bank, the mission record, the memorial page — and the **network tracker**, one line per asset. Keep them open at every step of this chapter and write in pencil; the campaign is the story of what gets erased. A full between-mission sequence takes twenty minutes at the table. Do not let its speed fool you about its weight: more campaigns are decided in those twenty minutes than in any firefight, because the firefight only ever loses you tonight, and the sequence is where you can lose the winter.

THE ROSTER

The campaign runs on a roster of **8 to 12 named characters** — neighbors, with cards. LEAF SEASON ships with twelve, and their cards are the campaign's whole cast: the printed set carries no replacements beyond what Rapport earns you (5. **Consequences** (p. 88)). Support units — drivers, porters, guides, the medics the Auxiliary sends — are not roster: they are one-line stats who come with an asset or a scenario and go home after.

For each mission, pick the lineup: the briefing prints the size, usually five or six. Two constraints always apply. **At most one SOF-vet-tier figure may start any mission** — Deacon is a resource, not a fixture. And nobody who is out on a recovery result may go (1. **Recover** (p. 86)).

Lineup selection is the campaign's quiet skill, and it is played against the briefing, not the roster sheet. A raid on a wired compound wants the Lineman and a breacher; a night of pure fieldcraft wants the Stalker and the Scout and nobody who cannot keep quiet at a walk; anything that ends with a truck wants Delgado behind the wheel before it wants a better shooter beside him. Read what the mission will actually spend — Noise, Aid Bag uses, hands for carrying — and staff for the exit as carefully as the objective, because the ford

does not care who was brilliant at the transformer. Then look at who you are leaving home, on purpose: the bench is not the leftovers, it is next mission's crew, and the campaign punishes any plan that treats the same five names as the crew and the other seven as scenery.

Plan for rotation, because the recovery tables will impose it. A Serious wound benches a name for a mission or two; a Critical survived may bench them for three and hand back somebody permanently changed. A roster run as six regulars and six spectators collapses the first bad night — the campaign is designed so that your fourth mission is fought by whoever is left standing, which is why Advances exist to spread skills instead of deepening one hero (6. **Advances** (p. 89)), and why the Cross-Training rules make teachers of your specialists before the war makes vacancies of them.

The dead stay dead. No roll, no late chapter, no mercy. When a character dies, move their card out of the box and write the memorial page: name, mission, how, and where they lie. Whether there was a body to bury is last night's arithmetic (**Aftermath** (p. 83)); the funeral is a week the living spend (3. **Network Actions** (p. 88)).

Margin note, Deacon's block capitals, inside the roster folder: *EIGHT IS NOT DEPTH. EIGHT IS A FLOOR. EVERY SKILL ON ONE CARD IS A SKILL THE VALLEY LOSES IN ONE NIGHT. PAIR THEM UP — DOC TEACHES, BOONE TEACHES, JUNIOR TEACHES. THE DAY THE PLAN ONLY WORKS IF NOBODY IS HURT, THE PLAN DOES NOT WORK.*

THE THREE TRACKS

Three tracks, each running 0 to 10, are the campaign's instrument panel. They move only when a rule moves them — a scenario's aftermath block, a standing rider (**Aftermath** (p. 83)), a network action, an event, a Hard Choice. Mark them on the campaign log after every change.

Rapport — starts at 3. Your standing with the valley's people and with the G-chief, the old man whose fighters answer to blood and memory before they answer to you. Raised by wins, by restraint, by aid — the deltas print on the sheets, and the Work the valley action buys it directly. Lowered by civilian harm, by failed missions, by

bodies and prisoners abandoned. Rapport is the campaign's load-bearing wall: **at 0–1**, the valley closes — no Auxiliary use of any kind, and every Consequences step deals a betrayal (5. **Consequences** (p. 88)). **At 8+**, the valley opens — recruits and the safehouse upgrade (5. **Consequences** (p. 88)).

Heat — starts at 2. The Authority's attention on your corner of the district. Raised by loud wins, ALARM exfiles, and captured crew; lowered only by the Lie low action — weeks of nothing, while the Underground spoofs the census rolls and the informers' reports read *quiet*. Heat is the dial the enemy reads: every scenario's garrison line is keyed to your current Heat band, and the Mission Architect budgets OPFOR density and quality from it directly (**Mission Architect** (p. 105)). **At 8+**, sweep events fire every campaign turn (5. **Consequences** (p. 88)), and Exposed assets start disappearing into trucks.

Capability — starts at 1. The partner force: how far the G-chief's fighters have come from deer rifles and anger. Raised by the Train action, by training missions, and by captured arms where a sheet says so. Capability is also a currency — fielding a Guerrilla team spends it, and Developing a Guerrilla asset spends it (**The Network** (p. 85)) — so the track breathes: build it, spend it, build it again. A high mark is not a score. It is the possibility that someday this war gets fought by the valley itself.

Read the panel together, not track by track, because the campaign's central tension lives between the first two. Almost everything that raises Rapport fast — big wins, rescues, the fuel that gets a hollow through the cold — raises Heat with it, and almost everything that cools Heat costs weeks the calendar will not give back. The panel's worst reading is not three low numbers; it is high Heat over low Rapport, the Authority leaning on a valley that has stopped covering for you. The best players of this layer treat the tracks the way the crew treats Noise: as a budget spent on purpose, not a score watched with dread.

THE NETWORK

The Crew is the point of the spear, but the spear is people: the **network**, tracked as assets in three pools on the network tracker. An asset is a person

or a place with a name you write yourself — a courier, a barn with a false floor, a clerk in the district office, three cousins with rifles. Each pool unlocks a different kind of help:

- **The Underground** — urban access, intel, forged papers. Underground flips buy the mission's information edge: moved Insertions, revealed Blips, rerolled Contacts, a delayed ALARM (**Intel & Insertion** (p. 82)) — and the Gather intel action between missions (**3. Network Actions** (p. 88)).
- **The Auxiliary** — caches, couriers, early warning, safehouses. Auxiliary flips buy logistics and mercy: the extra gear slot, the Exfil extension (**Intel & Insertion** (p. 82)), and off-board medical when a recovery roll turns fatal (**1. Recover** (p. 86)).
- **The Guerrillas** — bodies. Flip a Guerrilla asset at setup and spend **1 Capability**: a support team of two to four fighters joins the lineup for one mission, statlines printed by the scenario or built by the Mission Architect. They fight, they carry, and they go home to the hollows after — they are the G-chief's people, not yours, and the dilemma deck will remind you.

Where the network comes from: LEAF SEASON's campaign start sheet prints your opening assets, pool by pool, each with a suggested name you should immediately cross out and replace with a real one — a neighbor, a barn, a route (**Pineland Burning** (p. 93)); campaigns built from scratch take their starting network from the Mission Architect's budget (**Mission Architect** (p. 105)). After that, the network grows only one way: the Develop action, one asset at a time, each a week of somebody's carefully spent trust (**3. Network Actions** (p. 88)). Write every asset as a line on the network tracker — name, pool, Hidden or Exposed — because the tracker is about to become a casualty list you have opinions about.

Every asset is Hidden or Exposed. Using an asset — any flip, any Guerrilla fielding — turns it **Exposed**: somebody moved, somebody talked, somebody's absence was noticed. An Exposed asset cannot be used again until it has rested — flip

it back to Hidden with the Rest action (**3. Network Actions** (p. 88)), the asset sitting out a mission while its cover heals. Exposed is where the campaign's quietest losses happen: when a Heat sweep fires (**5. Consequences** (p. 88)), **every Exposed asset is caught on a d10 roll of 1–4 — lost**: arrested, burned, or gone north. Log lost assets by name. Some of them can be gotten back, and those missions write themselves.

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-NETWORK-CELLS.SVG]

DESIGNER'S NOTE

The three pools are not invented; they are the architecture of unconventional warfare as it has been taught for seventy years, most famously at the Robin Sage exercise around Camp Mackall — underground for intelligence and access, auxiliary for support, guerrilla force for combat power, cadre to bind them. That course's fictional country is called Pineland, which is a name this book has already tipped its hat to, and Deacon's biography is one long wink at it. We kept the doctrine because it is true: resistance is three different jobs done by three different kinds of neighbor, and the game's economy — flips, exposure, rest — is those jobs' actual risk arithmetic. The twist LEAF SEASON adds is only this: the cadre was not parachuted in. It grew here.

BETWEEN MISSIONS

After every mission's aftermath, run the between-mission sequence — **seven steps, in this order, no skipping ahead**. On a quiet turn, begin at step 3 (**The Campaign Loop** (p. 84)).

1. RECOVER

Every surviving crew member who came home wounded finds their **worst wound** carried off the table and rolls a d20 on the recovery table. The safehouse upgrade adds +2 to the roll (**5. Consequences** (p. 88)). Where a line offers an Auxiliary medical asset, the flip happens now, Exposing the asset (**The Network** (p. 85)) — the veterinarian, the requisitioned clinic, the nurse who asks no questions.

TABLE: POST-MISSION INJURY RECOVERY (D20, ROLL FOR THE WORST WOUND CARRIED OFF THE TABLE) (d20)

WOUND CARRIED	D20	OUTCOME
Graze / Light	no roll	Back next mission; Light - sits one mission out on a d20 roll of 1-4 (roll now)
Serious	1	Dies of complications - unless an Auxiliary medical asset is flipped Exposed now
Serious	2-8	Out 2 missions
Serious	9-16	Out 1 mission
Serious	17-20	Scar and a story - back next mission
Critical (survived)	1-3	Dies in the night - an Auxiliary medical asset flipped now converts this to 4-10
Critical (survived)	4-10	Permanent mark (roll on Permanent Effects) and out 3 missions
Critical (survived)	11-16	Out 3 missions
Critical (survived)	17-20	Out 2 missions

A safehouse network upgrade (Rapport 8+) adds +2 to this roll. The dead stay dead.

One roll per casualty, for the worst wound only — the lighter ones ride along on the same recovery. A character who comes back, comes back whole: the campaign heals everything the table does not make permanent, and no wound from a previous mission is carried onto the next board. What the table cannot heal it says so — a result that reads “out N missions” means missions actually played: quiet turns do not shorten it. A bench is measured in risks not taken, and a character sits until N missions have been fought without them. A permanent mark rolls on the table below and is written on the card in ink:

TABLE: PERMANENT EFFECTS (D10) (d10)

D10	EFFECT
1-2	Slow to mend - max AP permanently -1
3-4	Hands never steady again - Shoot TNs +1
5-6	Nerve damage - Grit +1
7	Lost eye - +2 TN on shots beyond 10 squares; -1 spotting
8-9	Deep limp - may never Sprint
10	Against all odds, whole - no permanent effect, and Grit -1 (they know what they can take)

The lost. Now resolve everyone the mission’s aftermath listed as not out (**Aftermath** (p. 83)). A figure that was Dead on the board is dead. A Down and Dying figure whose clock was never stopped is dead — nobody came, and the campaign does

not pretend otherwise. Anyone lost *alive* — hale, restrained, or stabilized — is **captured: Heat +1**, remove them from the roster, and everything they carried is gone. Captured is not dead: log where they were taken. Rescues are missions, built from the raid and infiltration templates (**Mission Architect** (p. 105)), and sometimes the deck hands you the thread.

The dead go to the memorial page, and the page is a rule, not a ritual: name, mission, how, where they lie. Read it before you pick your next lineup. It is the campaign’s only scoreboard that never resets.

2. RESUPPLY

Supply is the campaign’s one logistics number: ammunition, diesel, calories, batteries, all abstracted into a single till on the campaign log. It comes in through aftermath loot lines (**Aftermath** (p. 83)), events, dilemmas, and the caches your Auxiliary builds. It goes out at mission setup (**Setting Up** (p. 81)), where every mission presents a bill:

- **The base cost: 1 Supply per mission**, unless the briefing prints a higher number. This is the crew’s rifles, food, and fuel for the night.
- **Each item of kit fielded costs its printed Supply.** An Aid Bag is 1; Rifle Plates are 2; NV Goggles are 3. Items priced at 0 cost nothing beyond the base. The cost is per mission fielded — it is the belts, batteries, and wear the item eats, not the item itself, and paying it refills the item’s uses and payloads.
- **Crew-served weapons and drones cost more, deliberately.** A crew-served gun fields with its full belt load for 2 Supply. The drones price themselves on their cards — the Jammer Pack at 3, the FPV kit at 4, and the FPV’s airframe is spent forever when it flies (**Drones & Electronic Warfare** (p. 59)).

The gear pool is everything the crew owns — the printed cards in your box plus what missions have looted. It grows by loot, by scenario award, and by the rare purchase an event puts on the table; it shrinks when things are destroyed, expended, or lost with the people carrying them. During this step, audit the pool: strike what is gone, add what came home, and resolve any purchase the deck has offered. You cannot spend Supply you do not

have; a crew that cannot cover next mission's base cost takes a quiet turn and builds the Auxiliary that fixes it.

3. NETWORK ACTIONS

The weeks between missions are worked, not waited out. **Choose two actions** from the table; the same action may be taken twice.

TABLE: NETWORK ACTIONS (CHOOSE 2 PER CAMPAIGN TURN)

ACTION	EFFECT
Develop	Add one Hidden asset to Underground, Auxiliary, or Guerrilla (Guerrilla also costs 1 Capability)
Gather intel	Flip an Underground asset Exposed - before the next mission, pre-resolve one Blip or reveal one scripted position
Train	Capability +1 (max 10); requires a quiet turn or an SOF vet teaching
Lie low	Heat -1 (min 0); no mission this campaign turn
Rest an asset	Flip one Exposed asset back to Hidden
Work the valley	Rapport +1 (max 10); a named crew member spends the turn on wells, wiring, and funerals

Assets caught Exposed when a Heat sweep fires (Heat 8+) are lost on a d10 roll of 1-4.

Two clarifications. **Lie low** taken at all makes this a quiet turn (**The Campaign Loop** (p. 84)); taken twice, the quiet deepens — Heat -2, still one turn. **Train** and **Work the valley** name people: a teacher, a named crew member with a shovel — characters out on recovery can teach and dig, which is what a bench is for.

4. THE EVENT

The valley moves whether you do or not. The **event deck is 18 cards**; shuffle it at campaign start, discard as drawn, reshuffle when it runs out. Each between-mission sequence, **roll a d20: on 19-20 draw two cards, otherwise draw one**, resolving in draw order. A card marked *Immediately* resolves now; one marked *Next mission* is set beside the log and applied to the next mission's setup. Scenarios and Hard Choices can also instruct draws; they work the same way.

TITLE	CENSUS SWEEP
TRIGGER	Immediately
EFFECT	The Authority runs house-to-house checks. Heat +1. One Auxiliary asset of your choice must flip to Exposed to keep its cover story intact - or lose it on a d10 roll of 1-3.

That card is the deck in miniature: the Authority's attention arriving as paperwork, a tax paid in exposure, and a choice about which neighbor stands in the doorway holding their papers steady. Events are not weather. They are the war, continuing.

A discarded card is done, but not every card discards on resolution: some events state a condition that keeps them on the table — an informer unfound, a toll unpaid — and those stay face up beside the log, working, until their own text says they stop. When two *Next mission* cards are waiting at once, both apply; where they collide, the Good-Faith Clause reads them against you (**The Good-Faith Clause** (p. 4)). And when a card's instruction is impossible — no Auxiliary asset to flip, no cache to lose — do exactly what the card says to do about it, and nothing else; the deck was written knowing your ledger might be empty, and an empty ledger is its own kind of news.

5. CONSEQUENCES

Now read the tracks — after the event, so its deltas count. Three checks, every campaign turn:

- **Heat 8+: a sweep fires.** Roll a d10 for every Exposed asset: on 1-4 it is lost (**The Network** (p. 85)). The sweep does not lower Heat. The trucks will come again next turn unless you cool it.
- **Rapport 0-1: the valley closes.** No Auxiliary use of any kind — no flips, no support units, no medical — until Rapport climbs to 2. And draw a **Hard Choice** now (**Hard Choices** (p. 90)): at this Rapport, somebody is already talking, and the deck decides who.
- **Rapport 8+: the valley opens.** Choose one, now: a **recruit** — add a new Green character to the roster, from the scenario book's recruit list, up to the roster cap of 12 — or the **safehouse upgrade**, once per campaign: the network's medicine gets walls and a stove, and every recovery roll takes +2 from now on (**1. Recover** (p. 86)).

Run the checks in that order, and note that they are states, not one-time alarms: a track that stays past its threshold fires its consequence every campaign turn until you move it. Heat 8+ is not a storm that passes. It is a season the valley lives in until you buy your way out of it, one quiet week at a time.

6. ADVANCES

After each mission, the crew banks 2 **Advances** — shared points, kept on the campaign log. Spend any number of banked Advances now, on characters who went on the just-completed mission and came back alive; unspent points keep. Every purchase is paid in full, and the costs climb — competence is bought retail:

MARKSMANSHIP STEP

COST Green → Skilled: 2 Advances. Skilled → Veteran (10/12): 3. Veteran → 9/11: 4.

RULE Improve Shoot one tier step. Nobody trains past 9/11 — the 8/10 tier is a lifetime, not a course. Requires live-fire between missions (1 Supply, +1 Noise event on a d10 roll of 1).

HARD LESSONS

COST 2 Advances

RULE Improve Grit by 1 (minimum 8). May only be bought in a campaign turn after the character was Shaken, Pinned, or wounded — composure is bought with bad nights.

CONDITIONING

COST 7 → 8: 3 Advances. 8 → 9: 4.

RULE Improve AP by 1 (maximum 9). Characters with the Old Knees or Slow trait cap at 8.

CROSS-TRAINING

COST 3 Advances

RULE Learn one skill from the learnable list below. Requires a teacher — a crew member or network asset that has the skill — and a quiet campaign turn (no mission that turn for the student, OR Rapport 6+ so the auxiliaries cover the time).

The ceilings are part of the design. Nobody trains past the 9/11 tier — the 8/10 line is a lifetime, not a course, and the roster's one card that carries it came by it across twenty years. Marksmanship's range day is never free: pay its Supply, and on its printed risk roll of 1 the shooting is reported — treat it as **Heat +1**. Grit is bought only with bad nights, exactly as the card states, which means the crew member who has been through the most is the one who can grow the most: hard lessons are the campaign's honest name for them.

Cross-Training is how the roster survives itself: any skill below can be learned from a teacher who has it — a living, present crew member, or the named network asset — under Cross-Training's

printed conditions. Read the teacher lines before you need them: two of these skills die with a single name apiece, and the Leader line cannot be taught at all until the valley trusts you, because command here is given by the led. Skills die with people. Teach early, and teach the skills whose loss you cannot plan around — a second medic and a second driver have saved more campaigns than any marksmanship step ever has.

STALKER

RULE In Concealment, blips and sentries spot this figure only within 3 squares.

TEACHER Ledford, or any Guerrilla asset

DRIVER

RULE Drive TN 8 in wheeled vehicles; ramming and barrier runs at no Handling penalty.

TEACHER Delgado

MECHANIC

RULE Interact (4 AP) with a tool kit clears a vehicle Mobility hit, once per vehicle per mission.

TEACHER Delgado, or an Auxiliary asset

MACHINE GUNNER

RULE Sustained Fire at TN 10; reload the MMG at 2 AP with an AG.

TEACHER Boone

DRONE PILOT

RULE Operate crew drones; FPV Pilot tests at -1 TN.

TEACHER Petty, or an Underground asset

DEMOLITIONS

RULE Place charges at 3 AP; demo breaches never trigger the natural-2 default complication (a professional's fingers).

TEACHER SOF vet, or Capability 4+

FIELD MEDICINE

RULE Buddy Aid at 2d10 ≥ 10 with an aid bag.

TEACHER Pham or Haddad

LEADER

RULE May Rally (2 AP, radius 3).

TEACHER Deacon or Vasquez only, and only at Rapport 6+ — command is given by the led.

7. THE NEXT MISSION

Close the turn by choosing what comes next. In LEAF SEASON, the arc's own order and branches are printed in **Pineland Burning** (p. 93); events and Hard Choices add missions of their own — a lockup with a name in it, a convoy fight in the first snow — and the Mission Architect builds anything else the campaign needs (**Mission Architect** (p. 105)). Whatever you choose, read it against the panel: the briefing's garrison line is keyed to your current Heat, your lineup is whoever Recover left standing, and the network you just spent is the network you will have. If instead this was a quiet turn, note it and start the next sequence when its week is done.

HARD CHOICES

Some nights the dice rest and the campaign asks you directly. The **Hard Choices deck is 12 cards**. One is drawn when a scenario instructs it — mid-mission or in its aftermath — when an event or another card instructs it, or when the Consequences step calls one at Rapport 0–1. Drawn blind, shuffle and draw, or roll a d12 on the table version.

Read the card aloud. Choose option A or option B. Apply every printed cost immediately, or on the schedule the card states; roll only where an option prints a roll. There is no option C, and the Good-Faith Clause (**The Good-Faith Clause** (p. 4)) has a campaign face: if you have found a reading in which a Hard Choice costs you nothing, you have misread the card.

A card drawn mid-mission by a scenario's script resolves right there, at the table, before the next activation — the game stops because the fiction has: somebody is standing in the orchard waiting for your answer. Its campaign costs land in the aftermath; anything tactical it changes, changes now. However a card arrives, log it — the card, the option, the turn — because several of them keep charging after they resolve, and one or two are waiting to see whether you ever slip. A Hard Choice is never finished the night you make it. That is what makes it one.

TITLE	THE PRISONER
SITUATION	The ECA team leader your crew dragged out of the substation has a broken arm, a radio codebook, and a wife in the enclave. The guerrillas want him shot in the orchard before dawn. They lost two of their own to his patrol in September.
OPTION A	Hand him over. Capability +1, the codebook stays (reveal all scripted sentries next mission) - but Rapport with the valley's families -2, and the story travels.
OPTION B	Walk him to the county line and let him go. Rapport +1. Heat +2 when he reports everything he saw. The guerrillas remember that you chose him.

TITLE	THE MEDIC
SITUATION	After the ambush on the bridge road, an ECA medic stayed with your wounded when his column broke and ran. Boone is alive because of him. He has not asked for anything. He is nineteen.
OPTION A	Send him back under a white rag. Rapport +2 (the valley hears). Heat +1 - he must report where he was held.
OPTION B	Offer him the valley. Roll 2d10 - on 12+ gain a support Medic-Aux asset permanently; on less he says no, and holding him after the offer costs Rapport -1.

Notice what the deck keeps doing: it prices Rapport against everything else you want. Capability wants the prisoner shot; Rapport is the families who will hear about the orchard. Heat wants the medic held; Rapport is the valley learning you sent a nineteen-year-old home. The tracks are honest about this — the valley's good opinion is the currency every other currency eventually converts through, because without the people there is no network, no warning, no ford with a truck at it. There is no correct answer on any card. There is only which cost you can carry, said out loud, in front of the log you will read at the end.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Robin Sage grades its candidates on rapport, and it is closer to pass/fail than any marksmanship score: the exercise's guerrilla chief is scripted to demand things — a prisoner shot, a village punished — that the candidate must refuse *without losing him*, because a cadre that wins its arguments and loses its host has failed at the only thing it is for. THE PRISONER is that scripted night, dealt to your table. The deck's job is to make the campaign's real skill the one Robin Sage tests: keeping your people, your conscience, and your war in the same hand — and knowing which one you will put down when a card finally makes you choose.

HOW IT ENDS

LEAF SEASON has an ending: six linked scenarios, October into November, and when the last one is scored, **Pineland Burning** (p. 93) reads your panel — Rapport, Heat, Capability, and the names still on the roster — against the coming winter and tells you what the valley's season bought. First frost is already in the deck; the passes close whether the work is done or not.

Past the arc, the campaign is open-ended, and the Mission Architect will feed it as long as you like (**Mission Architect** (p. 105)). Open-ended does not mean endless. Endings worth honoring, when they come: the roster can no longer field a lineup, and the valley's war goes quiet for a generation. Rapport reaches 0 and stays — the campaign is over whatever the roster says, because a crew without a valley is just armed men in the woods. Or Capability stands at the top of its track with the tracks holding, and the war stops needing you: the G-chief's people take the night shifts, and the crew's last mission is teaching. The valley endures, or it doesn't. Either way, end the campaign the same way: read the log front to back, memorial page last, out loud if anyone is with you. That page is what the motto cost, and what it reached.

EXAMPLE

The week after the substation. Mission two ended with the transformer in pieces, a prisoner walked to the county line — **THE PRISONER**, option B, resolved in the aftermath — and the panel reading Rapport 5, Heat 5, Capability 1, Supply 4. Ledford came home Serious, a leg wound; Vasquez took a Light to the arm; Okafor was Shaken twice and hit once. Now the sequence, in order.

1 — *Recover.* Ledford rolls a d20 for the Serious: **11** — out 1 mission. Sugar Creek's best stalker will miss mission three. Vasquez's Light needs a d20 only to check the sit-out: **9** — back next mission. Nobody was lost; the memorial page stays one name long.

2 — *Resupply.* The till reads 4. The pool audit strikes nothing — the demo kit's spent charges refill whenever it next fields — and no purchase is on offer. Next mission's bill gets penciled: base 1, plus 2 if Boone's gun goes out.

3 — *Network actions.* Two picks. **Develop:** a new Hidden Auxiliary asset — the Tolley barn cache, a false floor and forty gallons. **Rest:** the schoolhouse courier, the Underground asset Exposed before mission two to reveal a Blip, flips back to Hidden.

4 — *The event.* The d20 comes up **9**: one card. **CENSUS SWEEP** — Heat +1, to 6, and one Auxiliary asset must flip Exposed to keep its cover story intact or be lost on a d10 roll of 1–3. The barn cache is three days old and already standing in a doorway holding its papers. Flip it Exposed rather than gamble it.

5 — *Consequences.* Heat 6: under 8, no sweep — but the next briefing's garrison line will read from the Heat 6 row, and it shows. Rapport 5: neither threshold. Nothing fires. The Exposed cache is a held breath until somebody spends a Rest on it.

6 — *Advances.* The crew banks 2, holding none, and spends both on Tanya Okafor: **Hard Lessons**, cost 2, legal because she was wounded at the substation. Her Grit improves from 10 to 9 — and a Grit of 9 or less can Rally (**Rally** (p. 43)). The lineman who froze in the yard in mission one is becoming somebody people get up for.

7 — *The next mission.* Mission three, without Ledford. The quiet approach just lost its Stalker, so the plan leans on Birdy's Scout and on darkness — and on the fact that Heat 6 means the checkpoints are double-manned now. The sequence is over. Winter is a number of gallons, and the barn is holding forty of them, Exposed.

The war you have just read the rules for is long on purpose. Missions are won inside an hour; the

valley is kept or lost across a season of these turns
— recover, resupply, work, listen, choose, learn, go

again. **Pineland Burning** (p. 93) deals the first hand.

PINELAND BURNING

Nailed to the door of the Corbin's Mill feed store, October of the fourth year, over the peeling census schedule: "BY ORDER OF THE DISTRICT ADMINISTRATOR — SEASONAL CONSOLIDATION OF FUEL, MEDICAL STORES, AND ROLLING STOCK FOR THE WINTER CONTINUITY PERIOD. PERSONS WITH KNOWLEDGE OF UNREGISTERED STORES ARE REMINDED OF THEIR DUTY TO REPORT." It hung one full day. By the second morning somebody had penciled along the bottom margin, small and level: they are counting gallons again. so are we. The clerk who took the notice down for filing carried that pencil line into the annex in her head, whole. Nobody ever taught her to do that.

This is LEAF SEASON: six linked scenarios, October into November, one valley. Run each night with the mission frame of **Running Missions** (p. 81); run the weeks between with **The Long War** (p. 84). This chapter adds what those chapters cannot: the ground, the enemy's actual dispositions, and the connective tissue — every scenario ends in a CONSEQUENCES block whose lines rewrite the later sheets. Play the six in order; what order cannot survive, **The Six Nights** (p. 94) handles.

THE VALLEY IN LEAF SEASON

The Sorrel comes down out of the Blue Ridge through a granite gorge, goes flat and red-brown past Corbin's Mill, and runs east until it stops being mountain water and starts being somebody else's river. Route 9 keeps it company the whole way. Everything the valley is hangs off that pairing like gear off a belt: Prewitt Dam plugging the gorge in the northwest, its wires marching east to an enclave nobody from here has seen the inside of; the town — a feed store, a dead mill, a courthouse annex with new padlocks and old clerks; the crossroads at Dutton's Cross where the upland farms come down to the blacktop; and the hollows, stacked north of the river like knuckles on a fist — Sugar Creek, Bray Hollow, a dozen more — each with one road in, one creek out, and a

memory that predates every map the district owns.

The Emergency Continuity Authority administers all of it from paper. District Nine runs on the census ledger, the requisition schedule, and the radio log: a checkpoint on the Route 9 bridge, a Civil Order Corps depot in the old co-op, patrols that keep to the blacktop, and a repeater on Gault Ridge that stitches the whole apparatus to the enclave. The professionals are few and mostly elsewhere. The Corps is local, numerous, and knows whose barn is whose. Four Octobers in, the arrangement has stopped pretending to be temporary: the works farm takes the census evaders, the fairground takes the confiscated trucks, and the winter consolidation order takes everything else.

October is the valley's one soft month. Hunting season puts rifles in truck racks legally; wood smoke covers cook fires; the canopy still holds, and a figure who knows the ground can cross the district in a day and never be a name in the log. It will not last. The leaves are coming down scene by scene, the sightlines opening with them, and the first hard frost is already in the long-range weather. The crew — twelve neighbors, one machine gun, one graph-ruled composition book — stands where every resistance stands at the start: trusted a little, unproven, short of everything but reasons. The G-chief's people watch from the high hollows and wait to see whether these twelve are worth burying beside.

Six nights will answer that.

CAMPAIGN START SHEET

Open the campaign log and the network tracker (**The Campaign Loop** (p. 84)) and copy this section onto them before the first mission.

Tracks. Start the panel at **Report 3, Heat 2, Capability 1** — the standard opening read (**The Three Tracks** (p. 85)):

TABLE: THE THREE TRACKS

TRACK	STARTS	RAISED BY	LOWERED BY	THRESHOLDS
Rapport	3	wins, restraint, aid, Work the valley	civilian harm, failures, abandoning bodies/prisoners	0-1: no Auxiliary + a Hard Choice every turn. 8+: recruit or safehouse upgrade each turn
Heat	2	loud missions, ALARM exfils, captured crew	Lie low, quiet missions	8+: sweep events - Exposed assets lost on d10 1-4
Capability	1	Train actions, captured arms	spent to field Guerrilla teams (1 per team per mission)	sets what the partner force can give you

Supply. The till opens at **6 Supply**. Mission bills are paid at setup, per **2. Resupply** (p. 87):

TABLE: WHAT THINGS COST (SUPPLY)

ITEM	SUPPLY
Fielding a mission (base)	1
Crew-served weapon full belt load	2
Each gear item fielded	its printed supply cost (see Arsenal appendix)
FPV airframe	4 - and the airframe is gone when it flies
Live-fire training (Marksmanship step)	1 - and Heat +1 on a d10 roll of 1

Starting network. Four assets, **all Hidden**. Each comes with a suggested name; cross it out and write a real one — a neighbor, a barn, a route you know (**The Network** (p. 85)):

- **Underground** ×1 — *the annex clerk*: eyes inside the district office at Corbin’s Mill, filing what the Authority thinks is filed.
- **Auxiliary** ×2 — *the Dutton orchard cache*: fuel and belts under the apple crates; and *the back-room clinic*: Haddad’s requisitioned-back stock, no questions kept on paper.
- **Guerrilla** ×1 — *the near cell*: three cousins with rifles above Sugar Creek, the G-chief’s closest handful.

Gear pool. The pool opens with every roster card’s printed default weapons and kit, plus: the MMG

with two belt loads · 2 spare carbines · 4 frag grenades · 2 flashbangs · 2 smoke pairs · 1 Demo Kit (2 charges) · 1 Recon Quadcopter · 1 suppressor · 1 Trauma Kit · 1 Rope & Harness. Vehicles: the box truck, Delgado’s pickup, and Birdy’s dirt bike. **No NV goggles and no FPV airframe** — the Authority owns the night and the sky until you take a piece of them (**2. Resupply** (p. 87)).

Roster. All twelve characters from the crew deck are available; the briefings below field **six to eight** per mission, with the standing limit of one SOF-vet-tier figure per lineup (**The Roster** (p. 84)). Read each briefing for what the night will spend — quiet feet, a driver, a jammer, hands for carrying — and staff the bench on purpose: the recovery tables will rotate it for you if you do not.

The recruit list. When Rapport reaches 8+ and the Consequences step offers a recruit (**5. Consequences** (p. 88)), take one of these three — Green statline (Shoot 13/15, Grit 12, AP 8), no starting skills. The roster cap is twelve: a recruit steps in only when a name has come off the page.

- **Webb Tolley** — the orchard’s eldest; drove the apple truck to every gate on Route 9 and waved at every guard by name.
- **Ruth Aldridge** — buried her father in October, the pneumonia; owns her own rifle and cleans it like an argument.
- **Cricket Dutton** — strings fence for half the crossroads farms; hears everything, repeats nothing, walks the hedgerows like a rumor.

Clipped inside the roster folder, Deacon’s block capitals: *SIX NIGHTS IS NOT A SEASON. IT IS THE PART THEY WRITE DOWN. BETWEEN THE NIGHTS: WELLS, WIRE, FUNERALS, AND WHOEVER IS TEACHING WHOEVER ISN’T HURT. FIELD THE BENCH EARLY, WHILE THE MISTAKES ARE STILL CHEAP. THE LAST NIGHT WILL BE FOUGHT BY WHOEVER IS LEFT STANDING — PLAN LIKE YOU BELIEVE THAT, BECAUSE I HAVE SEEN IT AND IT IS TRUE.*

THE SIX NIGHTS

The spine is fixed; the state it carries is not. Between scenarios, run the full between-mission sequence (**Between Missions** (p. 86)) — quiet turns, events, and Hard Choices land where they land, and the weather rows in each briefing assume roughly a week between nights.

Reading the maps. Every board is the standard 30×24 grid, printed with edge coordinates: columns lettered **A to Z, then AA to AD**, west to east; rows numbered **1 to 24** from the north edge down. A reference like N12 means column N, row 12. North is up on every map. Scripted posts, patrol routes, and named ground are printed on the map face — the Warden hides nothing but what the Blips hide (**The Warden's Hidden Hand** (p. 72)).

Carrying consequences. At each aftermath, after the standard scoring (**Aftermath** (p. 83)), read the scenario's CONSEQUENCES block and write every line that came true directly onto the later sheet it names. Pencil, on the sheet, that night — the campaign has no memory except the log. The master list:

OUTCOME CARRIED FORWARD	LANDS ON	EFFECT
S1 — link-up made and Eli Bray exits alive	S2	the Local Guide support unit fields free
S1 — the force never reached Altered	S2	pre-resolve any two Blips at setup; the convoy's order of march is printed face up
S2 — the technical is captured	S4	it may field as the convoy's gun truck (its HMG belt: 2 Supply)
S2 — the COC Boss is taken alive off the board	S3	remove one Blip (Warden's choice) and the gate sentries' facings are printed
S2 — the convoy reached ALARM	S3	the off-shift fireteam starts Posted, not Deep
S3 — the transformer is destroyed	S5	the standing recon quad is grounded (repeater dead, sorties cut)
S3 — the force never reached ALARM	S5	no ECA recon quad at all; the fiber FPV is the site's only aircraft
S3 — the Team Leader exits restrained	between	the next sequence opens with the Hard Choice THE PRISONER (Hard Choices (p. 90))
S4 — the medicine gets through	S6	the evacuation column moves 3 squares a turn, not 2
S4 — the truck or cargo is lost	S6	two of the column are stretcher cases
S4 — TRIBUTE resolved option B	before S5	insert the convoy fight: escort template, Compact OPFOR, first snow (Mission Architect (p. 105))
S5 — the ground-control site is	S6	the Warden fields no drones

OUTCOME CARRIED FORWARD	LANDS ON	EFFECT
destroyed		
S5 — the site survives	S6	the fiber FPV is aloft from turn 1, plus the recon quad per the S3 line
S5 — the frequency book is taken	S6	the scripted ALARM moves from turn 4 to turn 6
Any night — a crew member is captured	between	build the rescue with Mission Architect (p. 105) — raid template, the Corbin's Mill lockup or the works farm — and play it before the next spine night

Rescues and the TRIBUTE convoy are **inserted missions**: they use the Mission Architect's templates at your current Heat row, they cost Supply and weeks like any night, and the spine waits for them. The deck can force the same arithmetic from the other side:

TITLE	THE EXCHANGE
SITUATION	The Authority is offering Hollis Grant's cousin - taken in the census sweep - for any crew member on their list. They named three names. They will make the trade at the fairground, in daylight, on camera.
OPTION A	Refuse the trade. Rapport -2 with the Grant kin. The cousin ships to the works farm; a rescue template becomes available at Heat +1.
OPTION B	Stage the trade and break it. Run the exchange as a mission (raid template, ALARM starts armed) - if anyone on their list is captured in it, they are gone. No second chances either way.

That card is in the deck all season. So is winter.

EXAMPLE

Writing the ledger after Red Mud Crossing. The second night ends: cargo carried off, the technical captured, the Boss dead in the ford, and the escort's survivor reached the truck-cab radio — ALARM, turn 8. Score the aftermath first (**Aftermath** (p. 83)): Supply +4, Rapport +1, Heat +1 for the ALARM exfil rider. Then the CONSEQUENCES pass, pencil out: on the S4 sheet, under FORCES, write *technical available — belt 2 Supply*. On the S3 sheet: the Boss died, so no Blip comes off — but the convoy reached ALARM, so write *off-shift fireteam starts Posted*. In three weeks, at the wire, that pencil line is a rifleman awake at a window who would otherwise have been asleep. The campaign has no memory. The log is the memory.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Six scripted nights against a procedural enemy could have gone two bad ways: a railroad, or a reset. The CONSEQUENCES blocks are the third way — every sheet's garrison honestly reflects what the earlier nights made true: the Heat track's logic (**The Three Tracks** (p. 85)) at the scale of a single sentry's posture. Nothing carried forward is a reward or a punishment; it is the district, updating its paperwork. Play the spine twice and it will not be the same campaign, because you will not have told the district the same things about you.

SCENARIO 1 — EYES ON THE VALLEY

"First rule of the glass: see everything, be nothing." — Deacon's OP card, taped inside the mission book

BRIEFING. WHAT: the district resupply run — enclave to the Corbin's Mill depot, Route 9, Thursdays. Watch it pass. Count it. **WHY:** winter is a number of gallons, and theirs is written on the side of a truck. **WHO:** six, quiet feet, one long gun. **ALSO:** the G-chief is sending a man to the old sawmill on Bray Creek. Meet him, take his hand, walk him out. He is the beginning of everything. **IN:** over Gault Ridge, last dark. **OUT:** the same ridge, before the change of watch. Nobody knows we were ever off it.

THE MAP. Standard 30×24 board — the Sorrel bend below Gault Ridge, where Route 9 and the river run together at the mouth of Bray Hollow.

[ART TBD: MAPS/MAP-01-EYES-ON-THE-VALLEY.SVG]

The ridge bench runs the whole north edge, rows 1–3, High. The Sorrel crosses the south third (rows 16–19, impassable); Route 9 follows its north bank from AD14 to A16, bridging Bray Creek at N15 — the creek runs down column N from the hollow mouth at N1 and joins the river at N18, with a crawlable culvert under the road at N15. Hale's Sawmill sits on the creek at M9–P11 (two Zones); Mercer Quarry opens off a gravel spur at D16–D13, rock face Block at C11–E11 with a High rim above it at C10–E10. A powerline cut runs down columns U–V, rows 1–14. Full-canopy hardwood covers the slopes; conifer stands at G4–J7 and R3–T6 block deep LOS.

FORCES. Crew: up to 6; one Scoped weapon recommended. No support units — the contact becomes one. The Warden's force is Civil Order Corps (**The Civil Order Corps** (p. 77)):

CIVIL ORDER CORPSMAN

FACTION	civil-order
SHOOT	13/15
GRIT	11
ARMOR	0
DOCTRINE	per element
WEAPON	carbine
SPECIAL	Jumpy - the first casualty in the element forces an immediate group-morale test.
ELEMENT	squads of 6 with coc-boss

- **Post 9** — scripted sentry pair (2× Corpsman, Holding, radius 6): the bridge checkpoint at O15/P15, one facing west over the bridge, one facing east up the road. Landline in the shack at O14 — their ALARM is automatic at the post (**ALARM Is a Human Act** (p. 67)).
- **3 Blips**, routes printed: B1 loops the road shoulder F16–L16; B2 walks the powerline cut U2–U13; B3 circles the sawmill M8–P8–P12–M12.
- **The convoy** (scripted, turn 4): box truck plus escort pickup with 4 Corpsmen, entering AD14 at 6 squares a turn along Route 9, exiting A16.
- **Contact Table:** default (**Blips** (p. 18)), with 10 rewritten: *Merle Cutshall's fuel truck idling on the quarry spur — civilian; remove the Blip, but if the force ever reaches Alerted this mission, he reports what he saw: Heat +1 in the aftermath.*

PARAMETERS. Alert thresholds 4/8, starting Noise 0. Fallback timer: turn 8 (the depot expects a bridge check-in). **No QRF** — ALARM instead adds 2 Blips, one at each road edge (A16, AD14).

Insertion: north edge, A1–K1 (Underground flip: T1–AD1 instead, **Intel & Insertion** (p. 82)).

Exfil: north edge A1–K1. Deadline: turn 10.

OBJECTIVES. Primary — *the route log*: a Crew figure holds LOS to the convoy's vehicles within 12 squares (16 with binoculars) on two consecutive turns of its transit, and that figure exits (Rapport +1; S2's setup uses the log). Primary — *the link-up*: Interact adjacent to the contact marker in the sawmill's east Zone; **Eli Bray** authenticates and joins as a Local Guide support unit under your control. Opportunity — *the Ferryman drop*: a

waterproof case in the culvert at N15; Interact, one slot (+2 Supply). Aftermath rider: if the force never reached Alerted, the recon bonus carries to S2 (see CONSEQUENCES).

SPECIAL RULES. Season/light: *early autumn, day* — full canopy, Concealment blocks LOS one square deeper, canopy squares common (**Terrain Kits of the Eastern US** (p. 109)). The culvert: Concealment, Crawl only. This is the quiet night: play the whole stealth game — gaits, facings, the Blind Arc, patrol timing (**The Quiet Game** (p. 20)) — because everything after it is spent from whatever the district learns tonight.

CONSEQUENCES.

- Link-up made and Eli Bray exits alive → he guides S2 free (his Guide line kills Sprint Noise near him).
- Never Alerted → at S2 setup, pre-resolve any two Blips and place the convoy's order of march face up.
- Alerted or worse → standard aftermath riders only; the district's log now has a shape in it that looks like you.
- Eli Bray dies on the board → Rapport -2 over the standing riders. The G-chief sent one man to see what you were. He saw.

SCENARIO 2 — RED MUD CROSSING

"A ford is where the river makes everybody slow down and think." — Delgado, at the wheel, lights off

BRIEFING. WHAT: the Thursday run leaves Route 9 this week — Landis Road, the clay shortcut south, loaded heavy. The log says where it slows: the ford. **WHY:** their gallons become our winter, and the Corps learns the roads are not theirs after dark or before it. **WHO:** seven. The gun. **IN:** south woods, set before dawn; the trucks come with the sun. **OUT:** west, along the south bank. **HOLD UNTIL:** the lead truck is in the water. Nobody shoots early. Nobody shoots long.

THE MAP. Standard board — the Sorrel running full width along rows 12–13, Landis Road crossing it north–south down column N, the ford at N12–O13.

[ART TBD: MAPS/MAP-02-RED-MUD-CROSSING.SVG]

South of the water the cutbank rises High at P14–S14 — the perch. Parham's barn (one Zone) stands west of the road at L9–M10 behind a split-rail fence line K11–P11; True's Store, a roofless one-Zone ruin, at T16–U17. Old corn — crop Concealment — fills Q3–AA8; marsh chokes the west bend A11–D14; conifer at F17–I20; hardwood woods hold the south half and the block at E3–K8.

FORCES. Crew: up to 7. Set up hidden anywhere in rows 14–24 at least 3 squares from any road square; up to 2 figures may instead start in the corn (Q3–AA8). Eli Bray fields free if S1 carried him. The quarry:

COC BOSS

FACTION	civil-order
SHOOT	12/14
GRIT	10
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	per element
WEAPON	battle-rifle
SPECIAL	Leader. Cruel - while alive, Corpsmen reroll failed morale once.
ELEMENT	leads a squad

COC TECHNICAL CREW

FACTION	civil-order
SHOOT	13/15
GRIT	11
ARMOR	0
DOCTRINE	QRF
WEAPON	hmg
SPECIAL	Mounted HMG (vehicle rules ch. 10). Bails on a Mobility hit unless the Boss is aboard.
ELEMENT	technical + 3 crew

- **Scripted picket** — Corpsman pair at Parham's barn: L10 at the south door facing south, M9 at the corner facing east (Holding, radius 6).
- **The convoy** (enters N1, turn 2, 6 squares a turn until contact): escort pickup with 4 Corpsmen — box truck, volunteer driver and the Boss in the cab — the technical trailing 4 squares back. On contact the escort dismounts and runs Assault while the technical goes Base-of-Fire: the counter-ambush drill, scripted (**Building the Other Side** (p. 108)).

- **2 Blips:** B1 loops the north woods E4–K4–K8–E8; B2 drifts the south road N16–N22. Contact Table: default.
- **No QRF** — ALARM adds 2 Blips at the road edges (N1, N24). ALARM lives in two places: the truck-cab set (automatic) and the Boss’s shouting distance of it.

PARAMETERS. Thresholds 3/7, starting Noise 0, no fallback timer — the convoy *is* the force. Insertion: as above (ambush setup). Exfil: west edge, rows 14–24. Deadline: turn 10 — after the kill window closes, staying in greed.

OBJECTIVES. Primary — *the cargo*: at least 3 of the truck’s 5 crates carried off the west edge (Supply +4, Rapport +1 — belts and diesel for the hollows); crates load and unload at an Interact by two adjacent figures, and a carried crate is both hands, Walk only (**Carrying the Fallen** (p. 40)). Torching the truck instead merely *turns back* the run: Supply +0, Heat +1, and the primary counts failed. Opportunity — *the technical*: a Crew figure with the Driver skill mounts it and drives it off any legal exfil edge (Capability +1; it fields in S4). Opportunity — *the Boss, breathing*: restrained and off the board (**Surrender & Prisoners** (p. 44)) — he talks; see CONSEQUENCES.

SPECIAL RULES. Season/light: *early autumn, day*. Red mud: a vehicle entering the ford squares tests Handling; failure is a Mobility hit — axle-deep, and the Warden’s recovery of it is your opportunity (**What the Damage Means** (p. 55)). Vehicles cross ford squares at 1 square per AP; figures treat them as Rough. This is the Reaction Fire night: every escort Doctrine holds reaction AP, and the mid-move timing rule (**Reaction Fire** (p. 14)) is the whole difference between shooting men in truck beds and being shot climbing the cutbank. The technical’s HMG is DR 5, Pen 3: nothing on this board is cover from it except the dirt itself.

CONSEQUENCES.

- Technical captured → write it onto S4’s FORCES: the convoy’s gun truck, belt load 2 Supply.
- Boss taken alive → S3 loses one Blip (Warden’s choice) and prints the gate sentries’ facings; his

interrogation is the between-mission sequence’s business.

- ALARM reached → S3’s off-shift fireteam starts Posted, not Deep. The relay heard the district stand to.
- The driver is a volunteer, not a Corpsman. If he dies in the crossfire, the valley counts it: Rapport –1 over the standing riders.

SCENARIO 3 — THE SUBSTATION

“I know what that yard feeds. I wired half of it.” — Okafor, at the sand table

BRIEFING. WHAT: the Gault Ridge relay — fenced yard, two transformer banks, the repeater mast that stitches District Nine to the enclave. Drop the transformers. WHY: every checkpoint, every census truck, every drone sortie talks through that mast. Cut the valley loose from the paperwork. WHO: six. The gun on the knob. Okafor inside the wire. IN: west woods, full dark. OUT: the same woods. THE HARD PART: an ECA gun team lives on that roof, and it is not the Corps.

THE MAP. Standard board, night — the relay compound on its cleared bench, east of center.

[ART TBD: MAPS/MAP-03-THE-SUBSTATION.SVG]

The chain-link perimeter runs N8 to W15, gate at R15, the Relay Spur road running south from it to R24. Inside: transformer banks at O10–P11 and S10–T11 (Block); the control house at U9–W11, three by three, two Zones — control room east (fixed set, master switchgear), bunk room west — with a sandbag sangar on its roof at V10, High; the generator shed at O13–P14; the mast at V8. Floodlight poles at the fence corners (N8, W8, N15, W15) and the gate throw lit pools of radius 3. Everything within 3 squares of the fence is cleared ground. Huckleberry Knob — a hardwood knob, High — rises at D5–H9, six squares off the northwest wire. Conifer walls off rows 1–4 (H–AA); leaves-down hardwood holds the west and south.

FORCES. Crew: up to 6. The garrison is ECA (**The Authority** (p. 75)):

ECA SENTRY

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	12/14
GRIT	10
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	Holding
WEAPON	carbine
SPECIAL	Fixed post with landline - ALARM attempt is automatic if Alerted at post.
ELEMENT	pair at scripted positions

ECA MG TEAM (GUNNER + AG)

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	11/13
GRIT	9
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	Base-of-Fire
WEAPON	mmg
SPECIAL	Full crew-served rules (ch. 9). AG killed - loses Beaten Zone.
ELEMENT	pair

ECA TEAM LEADER

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	11/13
GRIT	8
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	per element
WEAPON	carbine
SPECIAL	Leader. Manpack radio - may attempt ALARM (2d10 >= 12).
ELEMENT	leads a fireteam

- **The gate** — sentry pair at R15/S15, one facing south down the Spur, one facing east; landline to the control room.
- **The roof** — MG team in the sangar at V10 (Base-of-Fire), tripod set, gun laid on the gate lane R15–R20: the Beaten Zone is one order away (**The Beaten Zone** (p. 48)).
- **Off-shift fireteam** — the Team Leader and 3 Riflemen, Deep in the bunk room; Doctrine Assault once revealed. (S2 line: if the convoy reached ALARM, they start Posted instead.)
- **4 Blips:** B1 walks the inside of the fence; B2 is the dog run, looping the south face Q17–U17–U19–Q19; B3 drifts the Spur R18–R24; B4 works the west woods J10–J16. Contact Table: default, with 10 rewritten: *the dogs* — +3 Noise, *the force is at least Suspicious*, and *the pair that resolves spots concealed figures at the full envelope: Stalker and Ghillie do not reduce it.*

- **QRF:** COC technical, enters R24 on the clock.

PARAMETERS. Thresholds 3/7, starting Noise 0, fallback timer turn 8 — a relay that misses its check-in is the report. Insertion and Exfil: west edge, rows 6–18. Deadline: turn 12.

OBJECTIVES. Primary — *the transformers*: both banks demolished (a placed charge each, **Breaching** (p. 32)) and detonated (Rapport +1, Heat +2 — the whole district hears a silence that big; S5 line in CONSEQUENCES). Opportunity — *the bunkroom lockers*: one Interact after the fireteam's Zone is cleared — one pair of NV goggles into the pool. Opportunity — *the Team Leader, breathing*: restrained and off the board; the sequence that follows opens with **THE PRISONER** — that draw is scripted, not random (**Hard Choices** (p. 90)). The gun on that roof is the night's exam: read **Crew-Served Weapons** (p. 46) again before you go.

SPECIAL RULES. Season/light: *late autumn, night* — leaves down, spotting envelopes +2; darkness modifier without lights; the posts' floodlit pools are revealed and immune to darkness in their arcs (**Terrain Kits of the Eastern US** (p. 109)). The fence: cut it (Interact 2 AP with bolt cutters, silent) or climb it (2 AP, +1 Noise). **What the yard feeds:** the master switchgear in the control room carries the floodlights *and* the fixed set — cut it (Interact 4 AP; a Lineman, 2 AP, no test) and the lights die everywhere, ALARM drops to the Team Leader's manpack under fire (**ALARM Is a Human Act** (p. 67)), and the fallback timer keeps ticking regardless. **Grid Sense, scripted:** if Okafor fields, her pre-mission question is answered in full — the Warden reveals the switchgear's location, the landline run, and which pools each pole lights, before setup ends.

CONSEQUENCES.

- Transformers destroyed → S5 loses its standing recon quad: the repeater is dead and the sortie schedule with it.
- The force never reached ALARM → S5 fields no ECA recon quad at all; the fiber FPV is the site's only aircraft. Quiet here is drone silence there.
- ALARM reached → S5 begins with its recon quad already aloft, sweeping from turn 1.
- Team Leader captured → **THE PRISONER**, scripted, next sequence.

SCENARIO 4 — LONG HAUL

“the truck is a promise, not a fort.” — painted inside the box truck’s door

BRIEFING. WHAT: the Ferrymen came through — fever medicine, cold-chain crates, paid for twice over. It lands downriver tonight. It has to reach the hollows by morning. **WHY:** the camps are coughing. Rapport is not a number, it is the Tolley kid breathing. **WHO:** seven, and a driver worth the name. The truck goes through Dutton’s Cross, because everything goes through Dutton’s Cross — and this week, so does a Corps checkpoint that was not there Friday. **OUT:** west, past the cross, cargo intact. Fighting is failure that hasn’t happened yet. Drive accordingly.

THE MAP. Standard board — Piedmont crossroads country in hard rain, Route 9 running full width through Dutton’s Cross.

[ART TBD: MAPS/MAP-04-LONG-HAUL.SVG]

Route 9 enters at AD12 and exits at A13, crossing Chapel Road (O1–O24) at the hamlet: the store at M10–O11 (two Zones), the chapel at Q10–R11 (two Zones, belfry High at Q10), houses at M14–N15 and Q14–R15, an equipment shed at T11–U12. Chapel Road fords the Sorrel — rows 20–21, full width — at Simmons Ford, O20–O21. A logging road runs the north edge rows 4–5 from AD5 to A4, dirt, with a connector at X5–X12; Dutton’s Orchard rows C7–H10, the barn loft High at B5–C6; Hodge’s Pond at G17–H18; a bald knoll High at V17–W18. Hedgerow Concealment lines the field breaks; open ground is half the board.

FORCES. Crew: up to 7, plus one free Volunteer Driver support unit if no crew member drives. The truck enters at AD12 on turn 1, mounted as you please; the captured S2 technical may enter with it. The net:

- **The checkpoint** (scripted, Holding, radius 6): drums across Route 9 at P12–P13; the district technical parked at O13, HMG laid east down the approach; two Corpsmen at the drums, two more and the **Boss** on the store porch at N11–

N12. The technical’s cab set makes their ALARM automatic once Alerted.

- **2 Blips:** B1 drifts west Route 9 (G12–C12); B2 walks the south track O22–O18. **Contact Table, replaced:** 1–2 nothing · 3–5 Corpsmen foot pair · 6–7 Corpsmen fireteam · 8–9 *flying checkpoint* — pickup, 3 Corpsmen, drops a drum barrier on the nearest road square, Holding · 10 *refugee column* — 6 civilians on the road, moving 2 a turn (**Aftermath** (p. 83) riders apply).
- **QRF:** a second technical, entering A13 on the clock — ahead of you, not behind.
- **The third party** — the Compact (**The Compact** (p. 78)), entering Chapel Road at O1 on turn d6 (roll at setup, seal it):

COMPACT HEADMAN

FACTION	compact
SHOOT	11/13
GRIT	9
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	per element
WEAPON	carbine
SPECIAL	Leader. Negotiator - some scenarios allow parley (Interact, Grit-off) instead of contact.
ELEMENT	leads a band

COMPACT FIGHTER

FACTION	compact
SHOOT	12/14
GRIT	10
ARMOR	0
DOCTRINE	per element
WEAPON	battle-rifle
SPECIAL	Woods-wise - Concealment spotting distances against them are halved.
ELEMENT	bands of 4–6

PARAMETERS. Thresholds 3/7, starting Noise 0, no fallback timer. Insertion: east edge (truck at AD12). Exfil: the truck must exit at A13 (Route 9) or A4 (logging road); crew, any west-edge square. Deadline: turn 12.

OBJECTIVES. Primary — *the medicine*: at least 4 of 5 crates exit the west edge aboard a vehicle (Rapport +2; the S6 line in CONSEQUENCES). Crates transfer between vehicles at an Interact by two adjacent figures. Opportunity — *the chapel drop*: one crate handed off inside the chapel’s nave Zone — the northern farms’ share (Rapport +1). Opportunity — *pass unremarked*: the truck exits

with the force never Alerted (Heat -1; some victories are silence).

SPECIAL RULES. Season/light: *late autumn, hard rain* — the smoke modifier beyond 8 squares, all Noise -1, drones grounded (**Terrain Kits of the Eastern US** (p. 109)). **The drums:** a halted vehicle at the barrier may bluff through — Interact, 2d10 ≥ 10, forged papers from an Underground flip pass automatically; failure is clear contact. Running the barrier is a Handling test at +2 and Noise 3 (**The Ram** (p. 56)). **The toll:** the first time the truck comes within 6 squares of the Headman's band — or at the end of turn 6, whichever is first — stop and resolve the Hard Choice **TRIBUTE** (**Hard Choices** (p. 90)), scripted: its campaign costs land in the aftermath; tonight, option A opens the logging road (the band escorts the truck to A4 and no Compact figure fires), option B turns the band loose — Cordon, assigned the logging road exit at V4-X5, and the parley door closes for the campaign.

CONSEQUENCES.

- Medicine through → S6's evacuation column moves 3 squares a turn. Fed, dosed, and ready when the trucks come.
- Truck or cargo lost → standing failure riders, and S6's column includes two stretcher cases.
- **TRIBUTE** option B → before S5, play the convoy fight the card demands: escort template, Compact OPFOR, first snow (**Mission Architect** (p. 105)).
- The Boss saw the gun truck. If the captured technical fielded and the checkpoint reached **ALARM:** Heat +1 — the district knows what you drive now.

SCENARIO 5 — SIGNAL AND NOISE

"Every net has a hum. Find the hum and you've found the hand." — Petty, headphones on, forty years early

BRIEFING. WHAT: the drone ground-control site at Prewitt Dam — trailer, mast, generator, the crews that fly District Nine's eyes. Put it out of the war. **WHY:** the last thing the sweep will do before it comes up our hollow is ask that trailer where everyone sleeps. **WHO:** six, and Petty rides the seventh seat with the jammer — he doesn't walk fast, so plan like it. **IN:** south slopes, full dark,

under the spillway's roar. **OUT:** the same. **THEIRS:** a fiber bird the jammer cannot touch. **OURS:** whatever Petty hears first.

THE MAP. Standard board, night — the gorge at Prewitt Dam, Lake Sorrel flooding the whole north edge.

[ART TBD: MAPS/MAP-05-SIGNAL-AND-NOISE.SVG]

The lake fills rows 1-7. The dam crest crosses the gorge at row 8, columns J-U — a High concrete walkway with the gatehouse (one Zone, fixed set) at N8-O8 and floodlights at K8 and R8. The spillway falls at T9-U11 into the stilling pool T12-U13; the tailrace runs east, rows 12-13, to AD13. Below the dam face the gorge walls are steep Rough (rows 9-11, K-S); the powerhouse at P10-Q11 is barred shut. On the west abutment, the visitor lot F9-J11 holds the war: the **GCS trailer** at G10-H10 (one Zone), the mast at G9, the generator at F11, a fuel blivet at I11, a lit pole at H9. The Route 9 spur switchbacks up from D24 through E14; a foot trail climbs from AD16 to the East Knob, High at V8-X9. Leaves-down hardwood on the south slopes; conifer along the east edge, rows 14-20.

FORCES. Crew: up to 6, plus Petty if able (he does not count against the six). The site:

ECA DRONE OPERATOR

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	13/15
GRIT	10
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	Holding
WEAPON	pistol
SPECIAL	Runs one recon quad or fiber FPV per Warden Phase (ch. 11). Kill him to ground it.
ELEMENT	pair with eca-rto

ECA FIBER-OPTIC FPV

SIDE	authority
BATTERY	6
MOVE	8
SPECIAL	IMMUNE to jamming (fiber spool). Attacks one Known figure or vehicle per Warden Phase it is aloft - Pilot 11, DR 4 Pen 2 Blast 1. Its spool path follows LOS - breaking LOS twice forces it home.

ECA MARKSMAN

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	10/12
GRIT	9
ARMOR	1
DOCTRINE	Holding
WEAPON	hunting-rifle
SPECIAL	Scoped. Prioritizes Crew Leaders and the MMG Gunner over nearest.
ELEMENT	single, paired with a sentry post

- **The lot gate** — sentry pair at F12/G12, facing south down the spur. **The crest** — sentry pair at S8/T8, one facing the gorge, one the Knob trail.
- **The trailer** — drone team: Operator and RTO (Holding). The recon quad flies per the S3 line; the **fiber FPV launches the moment the force is Alerted** and hunts Known figures every Warden Phase — breaking its LOS twice sends it home (**The Warden's Drones** (p. 62)).
- **The gatehouse** — the site Officer at the fixed set (**The Authority** (p. 75)); the Marksman on its roof, High, scoped across a leaves-down gorge.
- **4 Blips**: B1 walks the crest J8-U8; B2 loops the lot; B3 climbs the east trail AD16-W9; B4 drifts the south slope M16-R18. *If S3 ended in ALARM, add B5 on the tailrace path P13-T13.* Contact Table: default, dealing ECA cards.
- **QRF**: patrol truck with a fireteam, entering D24 on the clock; on ALARM roll a d10 — 8+ means an SRT team rides instead.

PARAMETERS. Thresholds 2/5 — this site is wound tight. Starting Noise 0, fallback timer turn 7. Insertion: south edge, H24-AA24. Exfil: south edge, H24-AA24. Deadline: turn 12.

OBJECTIVES. Primary — *the site*: trailer and mast both destroyed — a placed charge or a fire each (Rapport +1, Heat +2, and the S6 line: no drones over the hollow). Opportunity — *the airframe crate*: in the trailer, carried like a body (**Carrying the Fallen** (p. 40)) — one FPV airframe into the pool, first fielding free of Supply. Opportunity — *the frequency book*: in the gatehouse — S6's scripted ALARM slips from turn 4 to turn 6. Opportunity — *the blivet*: siphon it (Interact 4 AP, +2 Supply) — or put fire in it: a fire marker, +3 Noise, and no siphon for anybody.

SPECIAL RULES. Season/light: *late autumn, night* (**Terrain Kits of the Eastern US** (p. 109)); floodlit pools as in S3. **The roar**: within 8 squares of the dam face, Sprint Noise is 0 and breach Noise -1 — the spillway swallows footfalls. **The line**: the gatehouse's landline runs down the spur; cut the pole at E14 (Interact) and the fixed set is furniture — every ALARM after that is a manpack call. **Static's night**: Petty's jammer runs as printed (**Jamming** (p. 61)) — RF drones in the bubble test at +4 and drift, his Ham skill auto-fails manpack ALARM attempts inside it, and while it is active the nearest Blip converges on it. The fiber FPV ignores all of it: fiber is the counter you shoot, dodge, or out-walk, never jam. His Intercept is live too — the top Directive, once, kept or buried (**The Directive Deck** (p. 71)).

CONSEQUENCES.

- Site destroyed → S6 fields no Warden drones. The sweep comes up the hollow blind.
- Site survives → S6 opens with the fiber FPV aloft from turn 1, plus the recon quad per the S3 line.
- Frequency book taken → S6's scripted ALARM moves to turn 6.
- Petty captured or dead → no Intercept, no jammer: every remaining ALARM roll in the campaign is the Warden's to make in peace.

SCENARIO 6 — THEY CAME AT DAWN

The district sign at the hollow mouth took new paint in the night, block letters over the census notice: NOTHING IS BEYOND OUR REACH. The trucks rolled past it at first light.

BRIEFING. WHAT: the sweep. Two ECA fireteams, the gun, the trucks behind — coming up Bray Hollow with the census ledger and a list. **WHY**: everything. The families go out over Chinquapin Gap while there is a hollow to leave from. **WHO**: everyone who can walk, and whatever the G-chief sends. **THE JOB**: the column moves north; nothing in a gray truck passes the creek line while it does. **OUT**: the gap, last, counting heads. **THIS IS THE NIGHT THE OTHERS WERE FOR.**

THE MAP. Standard board — Bray Hollow under first snow, mouth at the south, Chinquapin Gap at the north.

[ART TBD: MAPS/MAP-06-THEY-CAME-AT-DAWN.SVG]

Bray Creek runs the hollow's length — P1 down to M24 — crossed at the plank footbridge N10, the ford M18, and the culvert M21. The hollow road climbs the west bank from L24 to the churchyard at L6; the gap trail continues M4 to the north edge at L1–N1, through the conifer stand L1–P3 (canopy — drone-immune). Little Union Church, K4–M6, two Zones, High belfry at L4; the Creek School, P5–R6, two Zones; the Bray farmhouse F7–G8; the barn E10–F11, High loft. Stone fences — low Cover — line row 14 from H14 to R14 (gapped at road and creek) and the road at L16–L20. The Bottoms, rows 15–22, are open pasture: the Warden's approach, your killing ground. Both hollow walls are High benches — west A–C rows 2–20, east X–AD rows 2–18 — with a bench trail entering at AD8 and running to T6. The district sign stands at L23.

FORCES. Crew: up to 8, plus Guerrilla teams — up to two, 1 Capability each: 3 fighters apiece (Shoot 13/15, Grit 11, AP 8, carbines). At Capability 6+, the G-chief himself comes, free: Shoot 11/13, Grit 9, Leader — he may Rally. Deploy anywhere in rows 1–14. The column: 10 civilians at the churchyard, moving north up the trail from turn 2 at 2 squares a turn — 3 if S4 carried, two of them stretcher cases if it did not. A civilian within 6 squares of a revealed OPFOR figure, or touched by any attack, freezes until a Crew figure spends an adjacent activation to start them again.

The sweep (**The Authority** (p. 75)), from the south:

SRT OPERATOR

FACTION	authority
SHOOT	9/11
GRIT	8
ARMOR	2
DOCTRINE	Assault
WEAPON	carbine
SPECIAL	Elite - group morale at -2. Enters Zones with flashbangs (defenders do not fire first).
ELEMENT	team of 4, QRF/ALARM asset

ECA PROTECTED VEHICLE (MRAP-TYPE)

HANDLING	12
SPEED ROAD	2
SPEED ROUGH	1
ARMOR	2
SEATS	8
SPECIAL	The Pen cap bites - small arms cannot do more than Mobility damage. Turret MMG. Occupants dismount from the rear only (one per activation).
FACTION TYPICAL	authority, QRF

- **Turn 1:** Fireteam A (Team Leader + 3 Riflemen, Assault) at J24–L24; Fireteam B (Sweep) at Q24–S24.
- **Turn 2:** the MG team (Base-of-Fire) and the command element — Officer and RTO, manpack — on the road at L24; the Marksman at AD8, climbing to the east bench (Holding).
- **Turn 3:** a full COC squad — Boss and six — at AD8, **Cordon**, assigned the bench trail to T6: the hook at the head of the hollow. Somebody has to go stop it.
- **Drones:** per S5 — none if the site burned; else the fiber FPV from turn 1, the recon quad per the S3 line.
- **QRF:** the MRAP, SRT team of 4 aboard, turret MMG — enters L24 on the clock, dismounting one per activation (**QRF** (p. 70)).

PARAMETERS. The force starts **Alerted** — Directives from the first Warden Phase (**The Directive Deck** (p. 71)). Scripted **ALARM** at the start of the turn-4 Warden Phase (turn 6 with S5's frequency book); killing both the Officer and the RTO first delays it to a turn-7 fallback. Starting Noise 6. Insertion: deployment as above. Exfil: north edge, K1–P1 — the gap. Deadline: turn 14.

OBJECTIVES. Primary — *the column*: at least 8 of 10 civilians exit the gap by the Deadline (Rapport +2; each civilian lost, Rapport –1, whoever fired). Opportunity — *the church cache*: a crate under the nave floor, carried like a body (+2 Supply). Opportunity — *the mouth holds*: no OPFOR figure north of row 10 before the start of turn 8 (Capability +1 — the G-chief's people watched it done). **The valley holds** — special: if by the Deadline every Warden element is destroyed, Routed, or fallen back to Holding, and the MRAP is wrecked or off the board, the sweep is *turned*

back: score it in the epilogue (**After the Last Night** (p. 104)) and take Heat -2.

SPECIAL RULES. Season/light: *first snow, dawn* — tracks (+2 to spot any figure that moved outdoors last turn), all Noise -1, Sprint +1 AP in the drifts (**Terrain Kits of the Eastern US** (p. 109)). No darkness. The gap's conifer stand is canopy: the column under it cannot be swept from above. Everything the campaign taught is on the table — the Beaten Zone on the Bottoms, the Cordon on the bench, the Pen cap on the MRAP's hide (**The Pen Cap** (p. 55)) — and anyone not out the gap is lost (**The Exfil Rule** (p. 82)).

CONSEQUENCES. None. This is where the pencil lines were going. What remains is the reading (**After the Last Night** (p. 104)).

AFTER THE LAST NIGHT

Score Scenario 6 like any mission, run one last between-mission sequence for the wounded and the lost, then read the log front to back — tracks, roster, memorial page last, out loud if anyone is with you (**How It Ends** (p. 91)). The campaign does not grade you. It asks you to say, honestly, which season you just played:

- **The valley holds.** The sweep turned back and at least 8 came out the gap — or never had to leave. The Authority's winter map has a blank space with your river on it. If Rapport ends 8+, the ending is the one the motto promised: the hollows feed their own, the G-chief's cells stand their own watches, and the crew's next war is teaching. If Heat ends 8+ anyway, the blank space is a target — build the spring with **Stitching a Campaign** (p. 110).
- **The long walk.** The column made it out and the hollow did not: the crew bought the evacuation with the valley itself. Count the cost — the roster, the till, the names — and know this too is a win state: everyone the Authority never got is a line in a ledger they cannot balance. The

campaign continues in the north country if you want it: the winter camp, the ice road, the lake kits of **Terrain Kits of the Eastern US** (p. 109).

- **The ash reading.** Fewer than 8 out, or the crew broke before the column cleared. Read the memorial page, then read Rapport: at 2+, the valley still hides what is left of you, and spring starts from a cellar instead of a church — harder, colder, not over. At 0-1 it is over, whatever the roster says (**How It Ends** (p. 91)); write the final page and name where everyone lies.

Overlay the other two tracks on whichever season you got. **Capability** is the future tense: at 6+, the valley now holds people who can do this without you — say so in the ending. **Heat** is the past tense: the bill for every loud win, and it transfers to whoever stays.

Then, if the table wants more — tables usually do — the war has been leaving hooks all season: the lockup with a name in it, the works farm's census evaders, the Ferrymen's unpaid favor, the passes if TRIBUTE closed them, every asset lost with a location attached. Build the winter from them with **Mission Architect** (p. 105) at your final tracks. LEAF SEASON ends when the passes close. Nothing says the reach does.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

The finale's two win states are the design's whole thesis. A campaign about neighbors cannot end at "kill the sweep" — sometimes the sweep is simply bigger than the valley, and the honest victory is ten people over a gap in the snow, bought at retail. So S6 is built as a judgment scene, not a boss fight: the special win exists and is genuinely reachable off a well-run campaign (low drone coverage, a delayed ALARM, a paid-off Compact, a deep bench), but the mission's floor — the column, the counting of heads — is a thing you can hold even while losing the fight. Falling Skies taught the stakes; Robin Sage graded the relationship. The last night grades both, and the memorial page is the transcript.

MISSION ARCHITECT

Taped inside the back cover of the mission book, a half sheet in Deacon's block capitals, older than the war it now runs: HOW TO PICK A FIGHT. ONE — SMALL. IF THE PLAN NEEDS EVERYBODY, THE PLAN IS A FUNERAL. TWO — LOSABLE. KNOW WHAT WALKING AWAY LOOKS LIKE BEFORE YOU KNOW WHAT WINNING LOOKS LIKE. THREE — THEIR GROUND, OUR HOUR. FOUR — THE WAY OUT GETS PLANNED FIRST AND GETS THE BEST PEOPLE. Beneath it, Vasquez's small print: he wrote this for a hunting club in '09. we changed one word.

LEAF SEASON is six nights; the war is longer, and not confined to one corridor of the Carolinas. This chapter is the toolkit that builds every night after — anywhere in the East. It assumes the mission frame of **Running Missions** (p. 81) and the Warden's machinery of **The Enemy System** (p. 66), and changes neither: what you build here is a scenario sheet those chapters can run. Use it two ways: solo, roll the next mission your campaign demands and play it the same evening — or author a full set for another table that does not know what is on your page (**Stitching a Campaign** (p. 110)).

DESIGN BEFORE DICE

Four principles govern everything in this chapter. Hold to them and almost nothing else can go badly wrong.

Build small. The Crew is four to six neighbors, and the objective must fit in their hands: a transformer, a ledger, a prisoner, forty gallons, one culvert under one road. The Crew is never an army, and a mission is never a battle — if your idea needs a second crew, it is not a mission, it is an arc; cut it into missions. The Warden may field twenty figures. You field a raid party, every name on it mortal.

Build it losable. The Warden must be able to win, honestly and often — an OPFOR laid out to be beaten kills the campaign's tension on the table. And build it *walkable-away-from*: from every objective there is a route to the Exfil that does not cross the whole garrison, and scrubbing early is always a legal, survivable, priced choice (**The Exfil Rule** (p. 82)). The design failure is never a mission

that is too hard. It is a mission the Crew cannot leave.

Set the stage; do not write the play. The Warden does the heavy lifting — the Alert Ladder, the Doctrine scripts, the Directive deck, the dice. Your entire job is honest starting conditions: sentries posted where a competent garrison would post them, routes a real duty roster would walk, thresholds set to the site's temper. Set the stage honestly and the night writes itself, and it will surprise you both.

State every objective as a testable fact (**Mission Anatomy** (p. 81)) — *the charge detonated; the drums are off the east edge; the Crew was never Alerted*. If you cannot phrase it as true-or-false when the board ends, it is not an objective yet.

THE QUICK GENERATOR

Three d10s, one campaign track, one look at the calendar. Roll in order:

1. **Roll the mission.** One d10 on the Type table. The row's frame is the mission's skeleton — what the objective is shaped like and what the Warden is doing when you arrive.

TABLE: MISSION GENERATOR - TYPE (d10)

D10	MISSION	FRAME
1-2	Reconnaissance	Observe and record a site or route; exfil undetected. Bonus intel spend next mission if never Alerted
3	Link-up	Reach a contact or courier drop, authenticate, escort or receive; the contact may be a support unit
4-5	Ambush	Destroy or turn back a moving OPFOR element on a route; crew chooses the ground
6-7	Raid	Seize or destroy an objective at a garrisoned site; scripted sentries + Blips
8	Recovery	Extract a cache, vehicle, or person from a held area; the load slows you
9	Sabotage	Demolish or disable infrastructure; the charge placement is the objective
10	Defense	The Warden comes to you - hold or evacuate a site for the turn limit; Warden initiates Alerted

2. **Roll the ground.** One d10 on the Site table, then pick the regional kit the site sits in (**Terrain Kits of the Eastern US** (p. 109)). The site is the

board's center of gravity; the kit is everything around it.

TABLE: MISSION GENERATOR - SITE (d10)

D10	SITE	TERRAIN NOTES
1	Farmstead and outbuildings	2-3 small structures, fields, treelines
2	Church or school	one large multi-Zone building, open approaches
3	Crossroads hamlet	4-6 small buildings on a road cross
4	Bridge or ford	water barrier, chokepoint, Cordon country
5	Substation or relay site	fenced compound, wire, generator noise
6	Mill or small factory	one big building, many Zones, catwalk High level
7	Fuel depot or gas station	road frontage, fire hazards everywhere
8	Ridge observation post	High ground, long sightlines, thin cover
9	River landing	water edge, boats, marsh flank
10	Small-town main street	dense facing buildings, alleys, the hardest CQB

3. Roll the twist. One d10 on the Complication table. Apply one; a set you author may add a second, never a third.

TABLE: MISSION GENERATOR - COMPLICATION (d10)

D10	COMPLICATION	EFFECT
1	Civilians on site	6 civilian figures; hits on them cost Rapport -2
2	Weather turns	rain/fog all mission - the smoke modifier beyond 8 squares; drones grounded
3	Short window	Exfil Deadline -3 turns
4	Third party	a rival-faction element with its own objective enters turn d6
5	Compromised	the Warden expects you - all Contact rolls +1, one scripted sentry pair added
6	Thin kit	campaign Supply -1 before loadout
7	The stranger	a wounded unknown at the objective - carry them out (Rapport +2) or leave them
8	Eyes above	an OPFOR recon drone is aloft from turn 1
9	Bring them home	a body - one of ours - is at the site; recovering it is a second objective (Rapport +2 / -1 if left)
10	Hard Choice	draw a dilemma card at the mission's midpoint (turn 6)

4. Read the Heat. The campaign's current Heat (**The Three Tracks** (p. 85)) sets the enemy's density and quality — take the row as written, then build the roster in **Building the Other Side** (p. 108).

TABLE: MISSION GENERATOR - OPFOR BY HEAT

HEAT	FORCE	QRF
0-3	1 scripted sentry pair + 3 Blips; Contact Table favors patrols; militia-quality (COC or scenario faction)	No QRF - ALARM brings +2 Blips at edges instead
4-7	2 scripted posts + 4 Blips; mixed COC/ECA regulars; one crew-served weapon on the table	QRF: mounted COC technical element
8-10	2 posts + 5 Blips (+2 on Contact); ECA regulars with MG team + marksman; drone operator on site	QRF: ECA patrol truck or MRAP element; SRT under ALARM on d10 8+

Rival-faction missions swap the roster, not the structure. Defense missions start at Alerted - Directives live from turn 1.

5. Pick season and light from the Season & Light table (**Terrain Kits of the Eastern US** (p. 109)), following the campaign calendar. The chosen rows go on the sheet — they are rules, not weather report.

6. Write the page. One page, six blocks: objectives, primary and opportunity, each priced; the map sketch; the order of battle — scripted posts with facings, Blip count and routes, Contact Table, QRF and its edge; Alert thresholds, starting Noise, fallback timer; Insertion and Exfil with its Deadline; and the aftermath block — track and Supply deltas per outcome, plus any rider beyond the standing ones (**Aftermath** (p. 83)).

If the dice contradict each other or the campaign — a Defense at a ridge you have never held — reroll the worst-fitting die, once. The generator proposes. You dispose.

[ART TBD: DIAGRAMS/DIAGRAM-ARCHITECT-GENERATOR.SVG]

EXAMPLE

Rolling mission seven. The campaign stands at Heat 5, late October. Three dice: Type d10 = 8, **Recovery** — extract something heavy, and the load slows you. Site d10 = 7, **fuel depot or gas station**. Complication d10 = 4, **Third party** — a rival element enters on turn d6; roll it now and seal it: 4. Season and light: **late autumn, night**. Heat 5 reads the middle row: 2 scripted posts, 4 Blips, mixed COC/ECA, one crew-served weapon, QRF a mounted COC technical.

Now the page, block by block. **DRY COUNTY** — *Recovery, night*. **Objectives:** primary — four fuel drums loaded on the box truck and the truck off the east road edge (loading a drum: an Interact, two figures adjacent). Opportunity — the requisition ledger in the station office (+1 Supply, pre-resolve one Blip next mission). **Map:** 30×24, Piedmont kit. The station sits on a crossroads at center-east: canopy and pumps on a Clear forecourt — the killing ground; a two-Zone store; a two-Zone garage with catwalk High. A treelined creek crosses the north half — the covered approach. Site rule: any explosion or fire marker within 2 squares of the pumps ignites them — DR 3 blast, then a fire marker, permanent. **Order of battle:** a COC pair at the road barricade south of the pumps, facing south; an ECA MG team on the garage roof, gun laid on the forecourt. Four Blips: two on 8-square loops around the lot fence, one static in the store, one drifting the creekline. Contact Table default. QRF: COC technical, north road edge — it enters behind anyone working the creek. **Third party:** turn 4, three Ferryman Gunhands enter at the west-edge river landing, Doctrine Holding, objective the same drums. They shoot anyone who touches fuel. So do the guards. **Thresholds:** 3/7, starting Noise 0, fallback timer turn 8. **Insertion:** north or west edge, player's choice. **Exfil:** east road edge, Deadline turn 12 — the truck exits there too. **Aftermath:** primary done, Rapport +1, Supply +3 — winter is a number of gallons. If the pumps burned, Heat +1 — a column of flame files its own report.

First die to finished page: about twenty minutes. The Warden handles the rest at the table.

BUILDING THE MAP

The board is the standard grid of **The Outdoor Grid** (p. 8), buildings Zoned by the conventions of **Indoors: Zones and Portals** (p. 10). Draw the map as a sketch with a legend; it need not be pretty, only unambiguous about terrain type, elevation, and every Portal.

Size. Default 30×24 squares. Shrink to 24×18 for a Reconnaissance that is one approach, one perch, and one way home — the full board only adds walking. Keep CQB sites (main street, the mill) tight the other way: same or smaller board, its squares spent on structures and alleys rather than fields, so the mission is fought through Portals, not across distance.

Terrain density — three rules of thumb. First: **every map gets a covered approach AND an open killing ground** — one route the Crew can walk in Concealment, and one space the Warden's guns own utterly, usually in front of the objective. A map that is all cover has no fear in it; a map that is all field has no plan in it. Second: **High ground somewhere** — a ridge bench, a catwalk, a roof. Decide who starts closer to it, and know you are deciding something. Third: **never a single viable route**. Two ways in, two ways out, always — one may be slower, wetter, or overlooked, but it exists. One-route maps do not create tension; they create a queue.

Scripted sentries. Post them where a garrison that expects nothing but has standards would: watching the road, the gate, the widest lane — the killing ground, not the creek. Print each post's position *and facing*: facings make the Blind Arc real and the quiet game solvable (**Spotting** (p. 19)). Overlap arcs across the objective's front, and leave one honest seam — the flank a lazy sergeant discounted. Mark where the fixed comms live: ALARM is a human act, and the player is owed a target list (**ALARM Is a Human Act** (p. 67)).

Blip routes. Draw each patrol route as a loop of 8–16 squares touching every viable approach at least once — including the seam. Blips walk routes at 2 squares a turn while the force is Unaware (**The Warden's Hidden Hand** (p. 72)), so a drawn loop is a timetable: check that a walking Crew can slip a gap, and that waiting for it costs turns the Deadline will miss. Take the Blip count from the Heat row and resist adding more — the Contact Table already makes some of them nothing and some worse (**Blips** (p. 18)).

The QRF edge. Name the edge the QRF enters (**The QRF Clock** (p. 68)). Pick a road edge that threatens the *Exfil*, not the objective — by the time the clock runs out the objective is usually decided, and the QRF's real job is the door. If the map's roads make

that impossible, that is information too: this is a site the Authority cannot reinforce, and its thresholds should say so.

THRESHOLDS, CLOCKS, AND THE STEALTH WINDOW

Alert thresholds default to 3/7 — Suspicious at Noise 3, Alerted at Noise 7 (**The Alert Ladder** (p. 67)). Move them to change the site's temper, not its difficulty. A sleepy backwater — low Heat, a bored COC detachment — plays at 4/8 or even 5/9: the quiet game breathes. A taut garrison — a high-value site, a district raided last week, any Defense — plays at 2/5: one Sprint is a risk, one shot is a fight. Widen the *gap* between the numbers to lengthen the investigating phase where Blips drift and one figure comes looking; narrow it to make the site binary. Set **starting Noise** above 0 only when the fiction is already loud — a market day, a storm, a generator hall. Print the **fallback timer** (the missed check-in that triggers ALARM on its own — usually turn 8); pull it earlier at hard sites, and delete it only for enemies with nobody to call (**Building the Other Side** (p. 108)).

Turn limits. The Exfil Deadline defaults to turn 12 (**The Exfil Rule** (p. 82)). By mission type: Reconnaissance and Link-up run tight at 10 — light footprints have no business lingering. Ambush runs 10, the quarry entering on turn 2–3: after the kill window closes, staying is greed. Raid and Sabotage keep 12. Recovery runs 12–14 when the load is heavy and the route long — the load slowing you is the drama; do not double-punish it. Defense inverts the clock: the limit is the objective — hold through turn 8–10 — and the mission starts Alerted, the Directive deck live from the first Warden Phase (**The Directive Deck** (p. 71)).

The stealth window is arithmetic, so budget it. Walking is free; the quiet game spends Noise only on Sprints, suppressed shots, and breaches (**The Noise Pool** (p. 17)). At 3/7 a Crew can afford two points of Noise and still be nobody; the first turn of open gunfire adds up to +3, and clear contact makes the pool academic. A default mission therefore has three acts: a quiet approach that can last six or more turns if the player pays for it in patience, a loud middle of three or four turns before ALARM's consequences land, and an exfil leg that must fit in whatever the Deadline has left.

Check your build against that shape: count the walking distance from Insertion to objective, add the deed's cost in turns, add the carry back. If the legs do not fit inside the Deadline with two turns of slack, move the Insertion, the Exfil, or the number — a mission that can be done neither quietly nor quickly is not hard, it is broken.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

The pacing dial is calibrated, not vibes — the design bible's simulation targets pin both ends: loud-from-turn-1 play reaches Alerted by turn 2 and a median ALARM by turn 4; walk-only stealth stays below Alerted through turn 6 with at least 80% probability. Against a Deadline of 12, that is the design in one sentence — roughly six quiet turns to spend, three or four for the fight, the rest for the ford. Every threshold or Deadline you move slides those thirds, which is exactly what moving them is *for*. Just never move them so far that one of the three acts disappears.

BUILDING THE OTHER SIDE

Assemble the enemy from the cards of **Forces of the Fall** (p. 75), by the drill printed there (**Assembling the Enemy** (p. 79)): every card's **element** line is the unit — a pair, a fireteam, a gun team, a technical and crew — and the element is what activates, tests morale, and dies as a group (**Elements** (p. 68)). Your Heat row gives the structure: how many scripted posts, how many Blips, whether a crew-served weapon, a marksman, a drone operator, or a vehicle belongs on the table at all. Fill the structure with faction cards, give every element whose card reads *per element* a Doctrine and a post or route, and stop. The row is the difficulty dial, and the campaign turns it — not you. Adding “just one more team” because the mission feels important is how architects quietly break their own game.

Doctrine assignment is where a mission type starts to sing (**The Six Doctrines** (p. 68)):

- **Reconnaissance** wants Holding and Sweep only — nothing hunts, and the tension is the routine itself. An Assault element on a recon map answers a question nobody asked.
- **Link-up** wants Sweep patrols crossing the Crew's likely route, plus one Cordon checkpoint on the obvious road — the mission is threading traffic, not surviving pursuit.

- **Ambush** builds the quarry as a moving column — vehicles and mounted escorts (**Vehicles** (p. 52)) walking into ground the Crew chose. On contact, dismounts run Assault while a trail element goes Base-of-Fire: the counter-ambush drill, scripted.
- **Raid** is the full grammar: Holding posts on the objective, one Sweep patrol as the wandering variable, Base-of-Fire on the widest lane, Assault arriving only with the QRF or an SRT team — the garrison defends; the *response* attacks.
- **Recovery** wants Holding around the load plus Cordon: this enemy would rather trap you than trade with you, and the Cordon's printed route belongs across your best way home.
- **Sabotage** wants Holding and Base-of-Fire packed tight on the target with thin edges — the mission is a lock to be picked, not a line to be broken.
- **Defense** points the machine at you: Assault and Base-of-Fire on the axis, a Sweep element feeling for the flank, Directives live from turn 1.

Rival factions swap the roster, not the structure — take the Heat row's shape and deal different cards (**Forces of the Fall** (p. 75)). A **Compact ambush** puts Woods-wise bands in Concealment-heavy kits where their halved spotting distances bite, and the Headman's parley special is a door worth leaving open: some fights in this war are conversations with rifles present. A **Ferryman escort** guards cargo with Holding pairs that are paid, not devoted — they break at half strength, never pursue, and nobody avenges hired guns: delete the QRF and the fallback timer both. A **marauder pack** is all Assault, all appetite: no posts, every Blip moving, the Chief's death ending everything at once (**Breaking the Warden's People** (p. 44)). For factions without a district radio net, re-skin ALARM rather than deleting it: the Compact's version is signal shots bringing extra Blips at the board edges — the low-Heat row's answer — and a marauder ALARM is the whole pack converging on the noise. The trigger stays a human act; only the machinery answering it changes.

Three-way fights — the Third party complication, or your own design — stay small: one element and a leader, never a second army. Run the third force

as its own force: its own Alert state, its own Doctrine, the same shared Noise pool. Factions treat each other exactly as they treat the Crew — a figure of another faction seen in LOS becomes Known to that force, and target priority runs unmodified: nearest Known, whoever's war it is (**The Good-Faith Clause** (p. 4)). Design the third party's objective to *cross* the Crew's, never to mirror the Warden's — the fuel both of you want, the prisoner only one of you can walk out. Two sides that simply hate the player are one enemy with extra bookkeeping.

TERRAIN KITS OF THE EASTERN US

Five regional kits cover the East from the sound country to the lakes: a character sketch, a mix recipe for the standard board, and one signature seed apiece. Whichever you build, finish with the season pass below — the same hollow is four different missions across that table's rows.

Appalachian hollows. LEAF SEASON's home ground (**Pineland Burning** (p. 93)): creases in the map where one road follows one creek and everything else is slope. Sightlines live and die by the leaves; strangers are noticed; the high benches see everything and say nothing. *Recipe*: both long flanks High (ridge benches), 40% hardwood Concealment, two or three conifer stands to break the long looks, Rough slopes between levels, one Water line with a ford, three structures at most. *Seed*: an Authority census team overnights at the schoolhouse at the head of the hollow — Raid it before the trucks come back, on a board where the only road out is theirs.

Piedmont farm country. Rolling open ground from the Carolinas to Virginia: fields that are killing grounds by another name, treelines and hedgerows that are highways for the patient, farmsteads like moored ships. High ground is scarce and man-made. *Recipe*: 60% Clear fields, Concealment strips one to two squares wide along fences, a farmstead cluster of two or three buildings, a pond, dirt roads; one barn-loft High. *Seed*: a Link-up gone stale overnight — a COC checkpoint moved onto the crossroads store at dawn (Cordon), the courier still inside, fields on all four sides.

Coastal lowland and tidewater. Black creeks, marsh grass, pine flats, causeways — ground half

water, and fog that erases the difference. Movement is channeled and quiet is cheap; the Water rule does the map's fighting. *Recipe*: a tidal creek across a third of the board, one causeway or bridge chokepoint, marsh as Rough-plus-Concealment, open pine flat, almost no High — a steeple or a duck blind if any. *Seed*: a Recovery at a Ferryman river landing — the flatboat arrives two turns before the Deadline, the fog row is in effect, and everything on the dock belongs to somebody armed.

Post-industrial river town. Fall-line mill towns from Georgia to New England: the mill a many-Zoned hulk with catwalk High, a main street of facing brick, a rail spur, one bridge that explains the town. The Zone game's home field — fights are decided at Portals, and the street is the killing ground (**Indoors: Zones and Portals** (p. 10)). *Recipe*: one multi-Zone mill, six to eight small structures, alleys, high Block density, a bridge or lock as Cordon country, the rail embankment High. *Seed*: the district lockup two doors off main street — the rescue the campaign has been owing somebody (**Stitching a Campaign** (p. 110)), fought room by room with the QRF clock running.

Northern hardwood and lake country. Granite, birch, blowdown, and water in lobes; logging cuts and cabin camps; winter arrives here first and stays longest. Boulder fields slow every flanking dream, and lake edges make half the compass a wall. *Recipe*: one lake lobe, a logging road, a cabin cluster, boulder-field Rough, conifer belts, one hardwood ridge High along a flank. *Seed*: a Defense in the first snow — a marauder pack has found the winter camp, the tracks rule punishes every move, and the families leave across the ice road or not at all.

Season and light are the last pass on any kit, and their rows are rules text:

TABLE: SEASON & LIGHT (MISSION ARCHITECT)

CONDITION	TABLE EFFECTS
Early autumn (full canopy)	Concealment blocks LOS 1 square deeper; canopy squares common (drone-immune)
Late autumn (leaves down)	Concealment spotting envelopes +2 squares; canopy sparse - the LEAF SEASON default
First snow	Tracks: a figure that moved outdoors last turn is spotted at +2; all Noise -1 (snow damp); Sprint costs +1 AP in drifts
Hard rain	Smoke modifier beyond 8 squares; drones grounded; Noise -1
Fog	No LOS beyond 8 squares for everyone; Blips resolve at 6/3
Night	Darkness modifier without lights; NV gear negates; OPFOR posts use lights (revealed, immune to the modifier in their arc)

STITCHING A CAMPAIGN

A mission set is not a playlist; it is a chain of consequences, and the generator is built to listen. **Heat is the feedback loop**: a loud win raises it (**The Three Tracks** (p. 85)), and the next generator roll reads a heavier row — the war answering. **Losses write missions**: anyone lost alive at the Deadline is captured, and a rescue becomes a mission you build — a Raid or Recovery at the lockup, the site chosen by where they were taken (**1. Recover** (p. 86)). Lost network assets, unpaid debts, and several Hard Choice options do the same — this one hands you a convoy fight in the first snow if you let it:

TITLE	TRIBUTE
SITUATION	The Compact's headman sits across the fire and names his price for the winter passes - a working technical, or your MMG's spare barrel and half your belted ammunition. He is not bluffing, and the passes are the only way the buses of evacuees get out before the snow.
OPTION A	Pay. Lose the vehicle OR 3 Supply. The evacuation runs; Rapport +2.
OPTION B	Refuse. The passes close - the next campaign mission MUST be the convoy fight (Mission Architect, escort template) with Compact as OPFOR, in the first snow.

The chain rule: after each aftermath, before touching the dice, ask what the last mission made true. If the answer names a mission — a prisoner in a lockup, a pass closed, a Ferryman owed — it outranks the generator. Roll only for what the war has not already decided (**7. The Next Mission** (p. 90)).

Place Hard Choices deliberately. The complication table drops one at a mission's

missions, or the weight becomes noise. Place it at the point of maximum leverage: before the exfil decision, not after; while the person the card is about is standing on the board. Draw from the deck (**Hard Choices** (p. 90)) or write your own to its pattern — both options cost something real, no option is mechanically correct, and at least one cost lands somewhere other than tonight.

The 4–6 mission set wants an escalation spine — one pressure that visibly worsens every mission while the rest follows the campaign honestly. The reliable skeleton: (1) open quiet — a Reconnaissance or Link-up that teaches the region's map; (2) first blood — the Ambush or small Raid whose win raises Heat; (3) the answer — the Warden's response, a Defense or a sweep against something the player loves; (4) the big one — the arc's true target, Raid or Sabotage, at the heaviest row yet; (5) the price — the mission the arc's costs demand, usually a rescue or recovery; (6) a finale keyed to the tracks — high Heat points at a Defense, high Capability at the Guerrillas' first led night (**The Network** (p. 85)). For the spine, pick one dial and step it every mission: the Heat band, the season row, or the fallback timer arriving one turn earlier each night. LEAF SEASON's spine is the leaves; yours can be anything the table can see coming.

Writing for other players. A set authored for someone else must be complete on paper, because you will not be there to remember it. Each briefing sheet writes down: title, date, and the season/light rows; the map — a drawn sketch or a kit-plus-site recipe, every Portal, elevation, and terrain type unambiguous; objectives as testable facts, opportunities priced; the Insertion and its

alternates; the full order of battle — scripted posts with positions *and facings*, the faction roster by card name, Blip count with drawn routes, the Contact Table (default or replaced), each element's Doctrine, the QRF's composition and edge; thresholds, starting Noise, and the fallback timer; the Exfil and its Deadline; the aftermath block — deltas per outcome, loot lines, riders; and at most one special rule. If a fact is not on the sheet, it does not exist — the player at that table is the Warden's hands, and the sheet is everything the Warden knows.

The Warden is your co-designer. Half the mission is written by the machine after the dice hit the table; the strongest thing an architect can do is leave it room. Do not script enemy decisions — no “*on turn 4 the patrol returns*”, no “*the sergeant flees when cornered*”: Doctrines, Directives, the Interrupt Die, and the Contact Table will produce patrols returning at worse moments than you would have dared write. Do not script reactions to the player, and never script an outcome. Script only what a garrison could have decided *before* the night began — posts, routes, clocks, thresholds — and make all of it discoverable: things a player can learn and plan against are tension; things that merely happen to them are weather. The test is simple: if a line on your sheet begins “when the player...”, delete it. The Warden already knows what to do when the player.

The generator, the map doctrine, the pacing dial, the enemy shop, the kits, the stitching — that is the whole toolkit, and **Pineland Burning** (p. 93) is six of these pages filled in by the same method. The Uwharries were never the point. Pick a river you know, an autumn you remember, and build the seventh night yourself: the motto was always a promise about reach.